

Usage of Artificial Intelligence by Students in Assessment

Updated: May 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru

Azim Premji University expects unwavering integrity from the students in their academic work. This is important on two counts. Academic integrity is a central value intrinsically important to any learning process founded on trust and cooperation between the learner and teachers. Secondly, the efficacy and effectiveness of any assessment for learning and its fairness are crucially dependent on the student's willingness to adhere to norms. The norms attempt to ensure that the students are indeed presenting evidence and occasion for the instructor to assess their work and provide feedback.

All Schools have taken adequate measures to orient and clarify expectations related to academic integrity. There is no denying that Artificial Intelligence tools can serve as useful pedagogical and learning resources and an easily accessible aid in making sense of ideas, translation etc. However, our policy on academic integrity is based on the principle that content submitted by students for assessment should be authored by them, and any external tools or content, including AI, should be explicitly cited and acknowledged. In accordance with this principle, students using content created by AI tools in graded submissions where this has been explicitly prohibited, will be treated as a violation of academic integrity.

University is adopting a "No tolerance to AI misuse" policy and hence all students must read and acknowledge the following:

- a. University strongly disapproves the use of AI tools for any purpose in graded assessments, especially in assessments where the instructor has explicitly prohibited AI usage.
- b. In case there are disagreements on the conclusions of AI usage, students will have to furnish evidence of original work.
- c. Students must maintain first drafts (digital or hardcopy) of all written assignments. Absence of the draft version will be considered as absence of evidence to justify adequate effort towards producing original work.
- d. If AI use for content generation is ascertained, instructors can use their discretion and award "U" grade for the assessment.
- e. All instances identified by faculty will be reported to the Programme Coordinator and Programme Office. Repeat instances of violation will be dealt with as per the guidelines in FoSQ section 7.4.
- f. In case of a dispute between a student and an instructor on decisions about unfair usage of AI and its extent, the matter shall be reported to the Academic Affairs Committee.

Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Policy

Updated: May 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru Campus

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1. Introduction:

Azim Premji University is committed to fostering an inclusive and equitable educational environment. Furthermore, upholding the values and the spirit of the Indian constitution are central to the University's educational goals and practices. In this context, the University recognizes that any form of discrimination based on gender, disability, caste, ethnicity, religion, or any other marginalised socio-economic backgrounds goes against the values of the University, the Azim Premji Foundation and the Constitution of India. Discriminatory acts create an inequitable environment for those employed by the University (members) or enrolled in the University's educational programmes (students).

The University has formulated this Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Policy in compliance with the Constitution of India and various legal safeguards put in place to protect the dignity of and provide equal opportunities to those belonging to marginalised groups. The University has also constituted the **Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Centre (ADEEOC)** that will ensure the implementation of the policy (Section 2).

The Policy is enacted to uphold the spirit of the following laws/regulations and guidelines:

1. Scheduled Caste and Schedule Tribe (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989
2. The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016
3. Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019
4. The University Grants Commission (Promotion of Equity in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2012.
5. Guidelines to Provide Equitable Opportunity for the Socio-Economically Disadvantaged Groups (SEDGs) in the HEIs, 2024

2. Scope and Applicability

1. The University prohibits discrimination at the work/learning place. In case discrimination occurs, the University will act to stop such behaviour, prevent its recurrence, and take appropriate action against those responsible.
2. Discrimination refers to unfair, biased, prejudiced and/or humiliating treatment of an individual due to their social background or identity such as gender, caste, disability, religion, ethnicity and any other socio-economic background. A list of such behaviours are provided in the **Annexure** to this document.
3. Discrimination can occur as a result of both *explicit* and *implicit* biases (see **Annexure** for definition of both).
4. The Policy and Guidelines apply to acts of discrimination carried out by:
 - a. any member (full time or part time employees) against a student,
 - b. any student against a member or another student.
5. For the purpose of this policy, definition of members include all persons employed by the University, and also consultants, part-time, temporary, contractual employees.
6. The Policy applies to instances of discrimination occurring between aforementioned members and students at the following locations:
 - a. On the premises of the University, and
 - b. at the extended workplace, e.g. during field practice and work-related events.
7. Out of scope:
 - a. Member on member discrimination cases do not fall under the scope of this policy and such complaints will be taken up by People Function (human resources) of the University.
 - b. Third party discrimination cases (that is, those not involving university members or students) do not fall under the scope of this policy. However, the **ADEEOC** can assist university members and students to file a complaint against the aggrieved party under existing the anti-discrimination laws of India.
 - c. The **ADEEOC** shall not entertain complaints of a general nature, without mentioning specific incidents, and/or involving specific individuals, shall not be entertained.
 - d. Design of programs, curricula, courses and pedagogy are outside the purview of **ADEEOC** and will be referred to the appropriate university academic bodies.

3. Mandate of the Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Centre (ADEEOC)

The mandate of the **ADEEOC** is as follows. The University will review these guidelines periodically and communicate any changes.

The **ADEEOC** will:

1. Create awareness and sensitize students, faculty, staff, and other stakeholders on the importance of following anti-discrimination, equal opportunity and equitable practices to the University's work.
2. Investigate and redress grievances related to any instances of discrimination occurring on campus. Other student grievances not related to discrimination will be addressed by the Student Grievance Redressal Committee (SGRC).

3. Collect data related to anti-discrimination policies and practices and report to competent internal and external authorities .

4. Composition and Responsibilities of the ADEEOC

A. Composition of the ADEEOC

The **ADEEOC** will be composed of the following members:

1. Convenor
2. Three members drawn from teaching and/or non-teaching roles
3. Member Secretary (selected from among the above three members)

The **ADEEOC** shall report to the Registrar and Vice Chancellor of the University.

The **ADEEOC** shall be reconstituted every two years. Members will be confirmed or changed, as appropriate.

B. Responsibilities of the ADEEOC:

The **ADEEOC** will:

- a. spread awareness about the Policy within University members on a regular basis by conducting sensitization workshops for all members.
- b. hold orientation sessions for all incoming students and new members joining the university.
- c. conduct refresher modules on anti-discrimination policies and awareness, as needed
- d. receive complaints of discrimination and conduct inquiries on such complaints in the manner prescribed in this Policy.
- e. assist victims of discrimination and eyewitnesses through the process of inquiry.
- f. recommend necessary action to protect victims/eyewitnesses against any instances of retaliation or threats of retaliation.
- g. ensure that all discussions as part of inquiries are kept confidential, and only those details which are necessary for taking action and/or appeal, are released to relevant authorities, such as the Vice Chancellor, Registrar, Registrar's Office, School Directors, Associate Directors, Function Heads or other relevant authorities
- h. collaborate with PoSH and DC as and when necessary.
- i. Collect data related to anti-discrimination cases, events and practices and report to competent internal and external authorities

5. Grievance Redressal Processes

A. Complaints:

1. Any person to whom this policy is applicable may submit a complaint by email to adc.blr@apu.edu.in or directly in writing to any of the **ADEEOC** members. As mentioned above, general complaints which do not mention specific incidents or individuals will not be entertained.
2. The complaint must be registered within a period of 90 days from the date of the incident or, in the case of a series of incidents, within a period of 90 days from the date of the last incident. The complaint must involve incidents which directly affect the complainant; complaints from unaffected parties, or general complaints, will not be accepted.
3. After registering a complaint, the complainant will be required to (a) submit a detailed written record of the date, time and nature of the incident/(s); (b) the names of the person against whom the complaint is being registered; (c) names of witnesses, if any; (d) any document or other

evidence the complainant may wish to submit in support of the complaint, (e) The nature of impact of the aforementioned incident on the complainant's work/ studies.

4. Any person may approach the members of the **ADEEOC** to clarify whether or not a particular act is discriminatory without registering a formal complaint.
5. An eyewitness to any conduct amounting to or implying discrimination may report the incident in the manner prescribed under this Policy. However, the affected party must agree to take forward the complaint, otherwise, the **ADEEOC** will not consider it a formal complaint.
6. Anonymous complaints will not be accepted.

B. Assessment and inquiry:

1. After a complaint is received, the **ADEEOC** will first assess the nature and context of the complaint to determine whether the alleged incident falls under discrimination based on implicit bias or explicit bias as defined in the annexure of the document.
2. If a complaint is found to be a case of implicit discrimination, the **ADEEOC** will initiate a structured awareness building on anti-discrimination for the individual(s) involved.
3. If a complaint is found to relate to explicit discrimination, the **ADEEOC** will either proceed with a process of conciliation or an inquiry.
4. Conciliation: If the complainant seeks conciliation, **ADEEOC** will attempt to settle the matter between the complainant and the respondent through conciliation prior to initiating an inquiry. If this is successful, the **ADEEOC** will forward the conciliation arrived at to the Registrar for implementation.
5. If the complainant reports to the **ADEEOC** that the terms and conditions of the conciliation arrived at have not been complied with by the respondent, an inquiry will be instituted. Such a report must be submitted within 90-day of completion of conciliation process.
6. Inquiries will be based on the following principles:
 - a. **ADEEOC** will provide an opportunity to both parties to be heard and record all relevant information.
 - b. **ADEEOC** will collect and weight evidence regarding the allegations from both parties as well as relevant witnesses. It may call witnesses and record their statements, if needed.
 - c. Inquiry must be completed
 - d. within 90 days of receipt of the complaint, unless due to unavoidable circumstances the complainant, the respondent, or some witnesses are not available (e.g., due to absence from campus due to field practice components, etc.).
7. Actions pending Inquiry: During the pendency of an inquiry the **ADEEOC** shall have the discretion to make appropriate interim recommendations:
 - a. Transfer the complainant or respondent to any other class/section in case of students or other team in case of members.
 - b. Grant such other relief to the complainant as may be necessary.
 - c. Recommend counselling and mental health support.
8. If required, **ADEEOC** may consult with the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (PoSH) Committee and Disciplinary Committee (DC) and other relevant authorities before reaching a decision.
9. Retaliation: Any retaliation or threat of retaliation by either of the parties concerned is strictly forbidden, and disciplinary action will be initiated against the offending party.
10. Confidentiality: The identity of the complainant, respondent, witnesses, statements, and other evidence obtained during the inquiry process, recommendations of the **ADEEOC**, or action taken by the University are considered confidential. Information will be shared with the actioning authorities for actioning recommendations of the **ADEEOC**. Information collected during complaints and inquiries will not be disclosed by any member or discussed publicly or shared on any media. The complainant, respondent, witnesses, **ADEEOC** members, and person/s who act on the recommendation are bound by this obligation. Any breach of confidentiality is subject to penalties,

including but not limited to those mentioned under the section on 'Penalties', and may involve disciplinary action.

11. Completion of Inquiry: The **ADEEOC** on completion of an inquiry shall provide a report of its findings within 10 days from the date of completion of the inquiry to the Registrar. Necessary action based on the report must be taken within 60 days of receipt of the report.

C. Penalties and Action

1. Depending on the gravity of the situation and offence, the **ADEEOC** may recommend to the Registrar one or more of the following illustrative penalties on any individual/s found guilty on the charges of discrimination:
 - a. Written apology.
 - b. Warning or reprimand.
 - c. Counselling
 - d. Completing a structured remedial module on anti-discrimination.
 - e. Transfer to another section/ class/ team (with or without a change in role).
 - f. Withdrawal of residential facilities/ academic honours (in case of students).
 - g. Suspension/Dismissal/ Rustication/Expulsion.
 - h. If an alleged instance amounts to a cognizable offence under the Indian Penal Code or any other applicable law, the University may, in addition to imposing one or more of the above penalties, initiate appropriate proceedings according to law. For example, if the **ADEEOC** finds that the nature of the reported discrimination violates the Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, it may support the complainant to file a case with the police.
2. The **ADEEOC** has no jurisdiction to take action against non-members/non-students of the University. However,
 - a. the **ADEEOC** may support the aggrieved party, who is a University member/student, to initiate action, if they wish to, under the applicable laws of India, before the appropriate legal forums.
 - b. in the case of a visitor to the University engaging in discriminatory behaviour, the ADC can consider demanding an apology for the act of discrimination and/or restricting further entry into the University.
 - c. in case the visitor is a participant in an event held on University premises, disqualification of participation in such event, etc.
3. After a preliminary internal investigation, if **ADEEOC** concludes that further police investigation and action are required, a case may be reported to the police with the approval of the complainant.

D. Appeal

If any of the parties to the complaint is/are dissatisfied with actions taken for resolution of a complaint, they can file a written appeal with the Ombudsperson, within 30 calendar days of the communication of the decision to the parties. The Ombudsperson will review the details of the case and determine whether any change in decision is warranted. The decision of the Ombudsperson will be final.

1. The **ADEEOC** has no jurisdiction to take action against non-members/non-students of the University.
2. However, the **ADEEOC** may support the aggrieved party, who is a University member/student, to initiate action, if they wish to, under the applicable laws of India, before the appropriate legal forums.
3. in the case of a visitor to the University engaging in discriminatory behaviour, the **ADEEOC** can consider demanding an apology for the act of discrimination and/or restricting further entry into the University.

4. in case the visitor is a participant in an event held on University premises, disqualification of participation in such event, etc.

5. ANNEXURES

Annexure A

The Azim Premji University has its processes to use the socio-economic disadvantage index in order to provide equitable financial and admissions support. The UGC guidelines 2024 identify certain groups as socio-economically disadvantaged; from that list, the University acknowledges specific kinds of disadvantages and groups that need equitable opportunities in higher education.

1. Gender Identity:

- Female (Girls and Women make up about half of all SEDGs and, in particular, those belonging to underrepresented groups have multiple disadvantages)
- Transgender

2. Social Backwardness Identity:

- Scheduled Castes (SCs)
- Scheduled Tribes (STs)

3. Educational and Economic Backward Identity:

- Non-Creamy Layer among Other Backward Classes (OBCs)
- Economically Weaker Sections (EWSs)
- Students from the vernacular medium schools
- First Generation Learners

4. Minority Identity:

- Religious Minorities
- Linguistic Minorities

5. Persons with Disabilities:

- A person with long-term physical, mental, intellectual, or sensory impairment,
- A person with not less than forty percent of a specified disability as certified by the certifying authority.

6. Vulnerable and Low Socio-economic conditions:

- Migrant communities, Denotified and Nomadic Tribes
- Low-income households Below Poverty Line (BPL)
- Children in vulnerable situations such as without known parents
- Any other group of low socio-economic conditions

7. Less-developed, poor-access, and disadvantaged locations:

- Villages and towns
- Tribal Areas /Scheduled Areas as mentioned in the V and VI Schedule under the Constitution of India
- Slums
- Aspirational Areas with Special Educational Zones (SEZs)
- North East States
- Islands
- Conflict Prone Areas
- Disaster-prone areas, including flood, drought, earthquake, etc.
- Border Areas

Annexure B

1. Discriminatory acts may include one or more (but not limited to) the following:
 - a. Derogatory or demeaning comments about people's social background, particularly of those coming from marginalised groups in India.
 - b. Derogatory or demeaning comments about people's bodies/clothes
 - c. Graffiti, cartoons, jokes, and songs meant as an insult to marginalised social groups.
 - d. Verbal abuse or comments that put people down because of their social background.
 - e. Hate speech, specifically against marginalised communities. (See point 3 below)
 - f. Implied or explicit promise/threat of preferential/detrimental treatment based on social background
 - g. Excluding individuals from certain activities based on their social background
 - h. Creating an intimidating, humiliating or offensive, or hostile work/learning environment due to a person's social background.
2. Discrimination can be based on (a) implicit bias and (b) explicit bias.
 - a. Explicit Bias: Explicit bias refers to cases where individuals are aware of the social, economic or any other kind of prejudice, exclusion or marginalization experienced by societal attitudes toward certain social groups, and their actions directly or intentionally contribute to or adhere to those prejudices, exclusions, or marginalizations.
 - b. Implicit Bias: Implicit bias involves perceptions, attitudes, and stereotypes that develop in a person due to social conditioning, vis-a-vis ignorance/unawareness that is typically associated with social privilege. Unlike explicit bias, individuals acting on implicit bias may not actually have a hostile attitude towards a specific social group and yet end up acting in a way that amounts to discrimination.
3. Definition of Hate Speech: This policy adopts the U.N. definition of hate speech, which is offensive discourse targeting a group or an individual based on inherent characteristics (such as race, religion, or gender) and that may threaten social peace.

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Biometric Registration for Access to Campus and Student Residences

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Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru Campus

The University is committed to ensuring the safety and security of all students and members on campus. Students also share the responsibility of contributing to a safe and secure environment on campus and in the residences. To support this, the University has put in place mechanisms for access control, physical security, and preventive measures such as CCTV surveillance. A key component of this system is biometric-based entry and exit. Please read the following information regarding the biometric data collected by the University:

1. The UGC guidelines recommend biometric entry and exit as an effective method for access control.
2. The University uses biometric systems installed at the campus main gate as well as at all student residences to monitor and manage student movement.
3. Students are therefore required to provide their biometric data at both the residences (if staying in the University residence) and the main gate. This system is essential for the University teams to efficiently manage student safety.
4. The biometric data collected is strictly used for access control and security purposes only.
5. The University respects the fundamental rights of all students as guaranteed by the Constitution. The biometric data is stored only on the biometric readers (controllers) and the University's internal server. It is not stored on any external server or cloud-based system. Access to this data is strictly limited, ensuring protection against unauthorized access or misuse.
6. The server is managed and maintained internally by the University's IT team. The team follows defined data management protocols, which include deleting student data after a specified period following the student's exit from the programme.
7. All students are therefore required to provide their biometric details during the registration process. The University will not be able to make any exemptions, as this directly affects the overall safety of students on campus.

Students will be required to sign an undertaking form to accept the terms listed in this document.

Campus Guidelines

Academic Year 2023-24

Azim Premji University



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Welcome

For new students, a warm welcome to Azim Premji University! Congratulations on joining our community after the admission process. We look forward to working with you over the coming years.

For returning students, welcome back! We are excited to see you again, and are eager to continue engaging and working with you.

As students, you play a very important role in creating the culture of campus life at the University. Many of the things that you do will directly or indirectly influence your experiences and those of future students. This document will help you work with your peers and with staff to create an educational environment that promotes learning, personal growth and well-being of all University members. We strongly encourage you to re-read this document from time to time because as you spend more time in the programme, your capacity to think about it, discuss it, and act upon it will keep getting refined. Do not hesitate to ask questions in case you need any clarifications.

This document must be read in conjunction with the Code of Conduct.

About the University

Azim Premji University was established in Karnataka by the Azim Premji University Act, 2010, as a not-for-profit University. It is recognized by The University Grants Commission (UGC) under Section 22F. The University offers undergraduate, postgraduate, and continuing education programmes that are aimed at making significant contributions to the fields of education and development. The University is a part of the Azim Premji Foundation, and is influenced by its experience of more than two decades of social work in India.

Various programmes at the University are housed in the schools listed below.

- School of Education (SoE)
- School of Development (SoD)
- School of Policy and Governance (SPG)
- School of Arts and Sciences (SAS)
- School of Continuing Education and University Resource Centre

Educational Aims

The University's programmes are designed to help you become a motivated, socially conscious and reflective citizen. Our curriculum, ideas about teaching, assessment and grading, and ethos of working well, feeling well, and relating well are all based upon these educational aims:

- Preparing you to become an active, self-directed learner with the capacity for critical thinking that is the foundation of social and personal flourishing.
- Encouraging you to engage with the challenging social realities in India to understand your education not simply as a path to personal achievement but also as preparation to contribute meaningfully to society.
- Providing you with opportunities to create a community of learning with people from diverse cultural and socio-economic backgrounds.

As educators, we will work with you to create a vibrant, caring, safe and inclusive environment for learning and living. As teachers, we offer you our time and support both inside and outside the classroom to help you understand your coursework and broader issues in your field of interest. As mentors, we will get to know you informally outside the classroom to find out what interests you or what bothers you, and to offer suggestions to help you resolve disputes and disagreements.

University Culture

When you graduate from this programme we hope that you will be 'educated' in the widest sense of the term. By this we mean that you will not only be someone who has acquired knowledge and skills but is also someone emotionally more mature, unafraid to question and doubt, and a responsible citizen. This is easier said than done! In order to achieve these goals, it is important that students and staff work together to create a caring, supportive and pro-active environment in which everyone can grow and succeed. But what does this involve and how do we do this?

This part of the document describes some ideas that we think should influence how you should behave and relate to each other. We recommend different ways to study well, feel well, and relate well at the University.

We recommend that you:

1. Work towards your own well-being, and actively contribute to the well-being of others.
 - Talk to someone if something is bothering you. Listen to others if something is bothering them.
 - Be mindful of how your peers are feeling and respond appropriately if you think something is wrong (not everyone speaks up when something is bothering them).
 - Get active - take up some form of physical activity every day, and encourage your peers to do the same. Play a sport, dance, go for a run.
2. Engage with different ideas and get to know people.
 - Spend time with your peers and your teachers and find out who they are.
 - Read books, watch films, listen to music that you haven't before. Share your experiences with others.
 - Talk about and try to understand why there are similarities or differences between you and others at the University. This may lead you to examine your own beliefs, values, and understanding.
3. Take initiative.
 - Organise activities and clubs with others.
 - Participate in workshops, seminars and events.
4. Be respectful, kind and fair to all members of the University community.
 - Treat all people the way you would like them to treat you. Be aware of how your actions affect those around you, and let this awareness guide your behaviour.
 - Resolve differences through dialogue and negotiation. You do not have to agree with everyone about everything, and not everyone has to agree with you. Even in disagreement, be civil and friendly, and make an effort to understand others and to make yourself understood. This is of particular importance when speaking with the security, housekeeping or other support staff.

Some concepts are of particular importance and warrant further emphasis. These are ideas that we believe are essential for the University community to be able to achieve its educational goals and vision.

- **Inclusion** - The University is a space in which everyone can interact with others freely and openly. We discourage any behaviour that excludes other people such as speaking in a language that someone doesn't understand, deliberately excluding people from activities, and making fun of others with the intention to exclude. Furthermore, inclusion is not just the mere absence of exclusion. It involves making active efforts to work out truly inclusive ways of organizing our social environment, and living with others. It becomes the responsibility of every student and member of the University to ensure that spaces, activities, events, classes etc. are as inclusive as possible. Inclusion must be looked at from various angles, including, but not limited to, gender, caste, region, religion, language, socio-economic situations etc.
- **Respect and Tolerance** - In any community as diverse as ours, disagreements and disputes will arise from time to time. While this is inevitable, what can set us apart as a community is the way that we respond to these situations. Courtesy, respect and a genuine desire to listen to and understand each other has to form the basis of any dispute resolution. Making this type of response a default takes time and practice, but the process starts with intent.
- **Safety and Well-being** - You are responsible for conducting yourself in ways that support the safety and well-being of every person in the community. This includes taking care of your health, not harming yourself or others, speaking up when you feel distressed, supporting others when they need help, and holding yourself and others accountable for abiding by norms and following rules.
- **Engagement and Participation** - A large part of your learning will happen outside of the classroom. At the University, we have the added advantage of a very diverse community that you can interact and engage with. However, while opportunities are plenty, your learning is directly proportional to your level of participation and contribution. Being an active part of clubs and committees, spending time with those who have had very different lives from yours, actively teaching others what you know or are good at etc. are just some of the ways in which you can contribute to the community.

Important Contacts and Links

This section specifies some of the offices that you may need to contact during your time on campus. This is not an exhaustive list. You will be given other email IDs to contact for specific issues or tasks. We expect that in any communication to these offices, you are clear and concise, and use language that is appropriate for official university communication. Please also ensure that you provide identifying details about yourself so that further communication or action is easy.

Registrar's Office

The Registrar's office can be contacted via email (registrar.office@apu.edu.in). This office is to be contacted only if there is prior communication from them, or if there are certain appeals to be made directly to the Registrar.

Programme Offices

The programme offices are to be contacted for academic-related matters. These are different for each school and the email IDs are listed below. All the programme offices are located in B3 3rd floor.

SAS PO - sas.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in
SPG PO - mpg.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in
SoD PO - madev.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in
SoE PO - maedu.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in

Student Helpdesk

The student helpdesk is located in B3 3rd Floor. They can be contacted by email (studenthelpdesk@apu.edu.in) for issues related to scholarship, fees and payments, food scholarships etc.

Student Affairs

The Student Affairs office is located on the 6th floor of B3. The team can be contacted by email (studentaffairs@apu.edu.in) for matters related to non-academic activities and events on campus, including sports.

Security Team

The security team can be contacted via email (security@apu.edu.in). In case a phone conversation becomes necessary, the security phone number at Gate 1 is (9606666800).

Infrastructure Team

In case there are any infrastructure related issues or requests, the IMF team can be contacted via the Catalyst app. The app allows the team to monitor the process, ensure its completion, and coordinate with you. The app can be accessed via the play store on Android, the app store on iOS, or on the web at the link below

Web link: <https://catalyst.azimpremijifoundation.org/s/>

Medical Team

The medical team consists of a doctor and a team of nurses. The doctor is available to consult with during the day at the medical room in B5. The medical room moves to Floor 2 at SR-1 at night, between 11.00 PM and 6.00 AM. An ambulance is available at all times.

The medical room can be contacted via email (medical@apu.edu.in) or phone (7022139139). The phone is functional 24/7.

The Conversations team (conversations@apu.edu.in) may be contacted in any situation where you or others around you are in mental distress.

Emergencies

General Emergencies

The university-wide emergency number is (9606668855). This number is manned 24/7 and can be contacted for any type of emergency. The team will be able to assist you and contact other functions and response teams as necessary

Medical Emergencies

In an emergency requiring medical assistance (including mental health emergencies), please follow the procedure below:

1. Contact the medical room (7022139139).
2. Give clear details on who the patient is, what the situation is and where the patient is located within the building.
3. Follow instructions that the doctor or nurses give.
4. In case you know of any regular medication that the patient takes, please specify that to the doctor on call.
5. Do not attempt to move people who are injured or those with special needs unless you are specifically trained to do so. You may cause more harm.

In non-emergency situations, if you need medical assistance, please go to the medical room (B5-01) during the day, or SR1-02-09 at night (11:00 PM to 06:00 AM). The doctor is available during the day, and the nurses are available 24/7. If you are not in a situation to go to the medical room, you can call the team (7022139139) and they will guide you on further procedures. Basic medicines are also available at the medical room.

Fire

In case you see a fire, please follow the steps below:

1. Immediately alert the general emergency number (9606668855), specifying the exact location of the fire. Information about the size and nature of the fire will be helpful if you are able to provide it.
2. Alert those immediately around you, without causing panic. Some locations have a fire alarm that can be activated with the instructions printed on the alarm.
3. Use the closest emergency staircase to exit the building and retreat to the nearest safe assembly area.

Specific do's and don't's:

1. Familiarize yourself with the buildings and spaces that you commonly use. You should know the location of the nearest staircase, fire extinguishers etc. Each floor of every building has the fire escape route and floor plan displayed clearly.
2. Do not use the lift in an emergency.
3. Do not attempt to douse the fire or use the fire extinguishers unless you have been specifically trained.
4. Do not attempt to move people who are injured or people with special needs, unless you have been trained. Without training, you may cause them further harm.

Code of Conduct for Students - 2026

Updated: May 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru

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1. Ethos and Purpose

- 1.1. Azim Premji University's programmes are designed to help individuals become socially conscious, reflective citizens with the capacity for critical thinking. This requires individual responsibility, collective cooperation, intellectual openness, mutual respect, and responsible participation in academic and residential life.
- 1.2. University life provides a variety of structured activities and unstructured opportunities for different kinds of learning to take place. The university aims to create a community of people from diverse cultural and socio-economic backgrounds who will be active participants in fostering a learning environment rooted in principles of equity, justice, and humaneness.
- 1.3. The university firmly believes this learning culture can be created only when students and university members interact freely and respectfully within the classroom and beyond, building and sustaining meaningful relationships with people who are different from themselves.
- 1.4. The autonomy and freedoms encouraged by the university are inseparable from accountability, restraint, mutual respect, and responsibility for the foreseeable consequences of one's acts or omissions.
- 1.5. Every student is under a continuing obligation to ensure that equal learning opportunities, safety, dignity, and access to institutional facilities are not impaired for any other student or member of the university community.
- 1.6. The Code of Conduct is thus designed to create and maintain a safe learning environment for all. Compliance with this Code is a condition of enrolment, residence, participation in academic and co-curricular activities, use of university facilities, and continued association with the University.
- 1.7. The University's commitment to liberal education, inclusion, diversity, public purpose and academic freedom shall not be construed as permission or waiver in respect of conduct that disrupts academic life, residential life, institutional functioning, order on campus, or the dignity and safety of others.
- 1.8. Academic freedom and freedom of expression shall be exercised subject to applicable law of the land, university rules, academic norms, professional ethics, the dignity and safety of others, and the University's obligation to maintain an inclusive educational environment. In cases of uncertainty, the decision of the university in all such matters shall be final, conclusive, and binding upon all students and members of the university community.

2. Scope and Applicability

- 2.1. This Code of Conduct applies to all students enrolled in the university programmes (Undergraduate, Postgraduate, Diploma, Certificate, and Professional Development programmes).

- 2.2. This Code of Conduct applies to all physical and online locations relevant for university programmes. This includes:
- 2.2.1. All physical spaces on the university campus, including but not limited to, classrooms, seminar halls, office spaces, meeting rooms, cafeteria, sports facilities, residences, etc.
 - 2.2.2. All field practice/ research project locations which are part of university's academic programmes.
 - 2.2.3. Tournaments and other events where students are officially representing the University
 - 2.2.4. All online spaces provided by the university, including but not limited to, email accounts, email distribution lists, learning management systems such as Moodle, Tribyte, etc.
- 2.3. Academic integrity and other academic violations are governed by FOSQ and other academic policies of the university. Please refer to those policies for reference.
- 2.4. However, certain types of violations of Code of Conduct in academic spaces (e.g. disrupting class learning and environment) are covered by Disciplinary Action or Administrative Action, described in this document.
- 2.5. This code shall be read with all applicable university policies as notified by the Registrar's office. Where the same conduct may fall within the scope of more than one policy, the university may proceed under one or more applicable processes, either simultaneously or sequentially, subject to the discretion of the Registrar based on the gravity of the conduct.

3. Student Responsibilities and Obligations

- 3.1. Students shall comply with all university rules, instructions, notices, policies, undertakings, agreements, directions and decisions issued by competent university authorities from time to time. (Policies such as: Residential norms, Campus guidelines, PoSH guidelines, Anti-Ragging policy, social media guidelines, fee policy, financial assistance agreement etc.)
- 3.2. Students shall not, by act or omission, cause or facilitate harm, disorder, intimidation, discrimination, harassment, reputational injury, unauthorised occupation, misuse of resources, damage to property, breach of confidentiality, violation of law, or disruption of university functioning.
- 3.3. Students have an obligation not to engage in any act of retaliation, intimidation, obstruction of inquiry, suppression of evidence, or failure to comply with directions issued by the university or its authorised functionaries.
- 3.4. Every student is expected to read, understand, and follow this Code, University policies, official directions, and applicable law. A student cannot avoid responsibility by claiming ignorance, misunderstanding, or failure to read them, especially where the rule or expectation is documented. .

4. Violations of the Code of Conduct

- 4.1. Violations are classified as major and minor to ensure effective, fair and expeditious resolution of cases involving breach of norms, rules and regulations.
- 4.2. Certain violations come under statutory regulations such as POCSO, POSH, Anti-Ragging, Anti-Discrimination and other laws. These are handled by respective committees and processes. Please refer to relevant sections in this document.
- 4.3. Minor violations are ordinarily those that involve breach of routine norms, first-time or low-risk non-compliance, or conduct capable of correction through administrative action, provided there is no serious harm caused to an individual or institution.
- 4.4. Major violations are those involving (but not limited to) serious misconduct, violence or threat, safety risks, disruption of academic or institutional functioning, damage to property, misuse of university resources, political party activity, fraud, intimidation, retaliation, serious breach of residential or field rules, or repeated minor violations.
- 4.5. The lists of violations in this code are illustrative and not exhaustive. University reserves the authority to determine whether any act, omission, attempt, facilitation, conspiracy or pattern of conduct constitutes a violation, even if not expressly listed herein. A repeated minor violation, a pattern of non-compliance, or minor violation committed may be treated as a major violation
- 4.6. Without prejudice to the generality of above clauses, the following may be treated as minor violations, unless the facts disclose circumstances warranting treatment as a major violation:
 - 4.6.1. Failure to comply with semester and break start and end dates, including arriving at the residences before the dates and times specified by the residences team members, or remaining in the residences after the indicated dates and times once the semester finishes;
 - 4.6.2. Staying away from the residences during the semester without informing and/or seeking permission from the concerned office;
 - 4.6.3. Keeping hostel rooms, shared facilities or assigned spaces unclean, unhygienic or in a condition contrary to norms specified in residences manual;
 - 4.6.4. Making private arrangements with the housekeeping staff to clean rooms or possessions
 - 4.6.5. Using classroom audio-visual facilities for personal use without prior permission from the faculty/Schools

- 4.6.6. In the case of non-resident students, remaining on or accessing campus beyond the designated time.
 - 4.6.7. Cross-access to rooms or areas outside assigned or designated sections where the facts do not compromise safety or amount to a major violation (Refer to the Residence manual for information on designated areas);
 - 4.6.8. Accessing unauthorized spaces not meant for student use;
 - 4.6.9. Other breaches of routine administrative, residential or campus norms that the competent authority determines to be minor in the circumstances.
- 4.7. The following categories of misconduct shall ordinarily constitute major violations. The University may treat any comparable conduct as a major violation based on seriousness, impact, recurrence, risk or legal obligation.
- 4.7.1. **Violence, Threats, Intimidation, Vandalism and Damage**
 - a) Violence, threat of violence, intimidation, coercion, bullying or conduct creating apprehension of harm;
 - b) any act resulting in or likely to result in physical injury, mental distress, humiliation, intimidation, threat, fear or compromised safety;
 - c) vandalism, defacement, destruction, tampering with or damage to university property, including vehicles or transport provided or arranged by the University;
 - d) vandalism, defacement, destruction, tampering with or damage to property belonging to students, members, visitors or third parties;
 - e) unauthorised access to or interference with university digital systems, data, networks, platforms, accounts or devices.
 - 4.7.2. **Weapons, Dangerous Objects and Hazardous Materials**
 - a) possession, storage, carrying, display, threat or use of weapons, explosives, ammunition, gas, corrosive substances, chemicals, fireworks, sharp objects or any item capable of causing harm;
 - b) bringing, storing, using or facilitating access to any hazardous, inflammable or prohibited material.
 - 4.7.3. **Narcotics, Tobacco, Alcohol and Prohibited Substances**
 - a) Engaging in smoking, vaping, or chewing tobacco within the University premises is a violation of Indian law.
 - b) Presence of cigarette stubs or throwing cigarette stubs out of windows will be treated as a major violation.

- c) Possession of cigarettes, beedis, or tobacco products may be treated as a major or minor violation depending on circumstances.
- d) Consumption, storage, exchange, sale, or possession of alcohol, including empty alcohol bottles.
- e) Possession, cultivation, consumption, purchase, exchange, or sale of narcotic drugs and other illegal substances, including vapes.

4.7.4. **Safety, Security and Emergency Violations**

- a) wilfully or negligently endangering the safety, health or security of any person;
- b) failure to comply with evacuation, security, health, emergency or safety instructions issued by competent authorities;
- c) withholding credible information about any threat to safety, health, security or order;
- d) tampering with, disabling, misusing or obstructing safety or security equipment, including fire alarms, CCTV systems, emergency exits, refuge areas, emergency stairwells, electrical shafts or communication shafts;
- e) raising a false alarm regarding fire, medical emergency, security incident or other safety issue;
- f) possession or use of lighters, matchboxes, agarbattis, candles, firecrackers or objects posing fire hazard in student residences or other prohibited areas;
- g) Unauthorised storage and/or use of inflammable materials on campus
- h) Tampering with safety or security equipment on campus, including setting off the fire alarm. Raising false alarm regarding any emergency or safety issue such as the fire alarm
- i) Unauthorised or inappropriate use of the safety systems or equipment on campus
- j) Using electrical equipment such as induction cook tops, electric kettles, iron box, washing machine, etc. in the room.
- k) Use of pressure cookers or other heavy appliances like mixers in the room, pantry or any common area.
- l) Cross-access to rooms outside designated segregated section, if safety of a student is compromised.

4.7.5. **Discriminatory Conduct**

- a) Conduct through words, actions, digital communication or other means, that demeans, excludes, humiliates, ostracises, threatens, harasses or disadvantages any person or group on the basis of caste, religion, gender, sexual orientation, language, region, class, race, disability, ethnicity, nationality, socio-economic background or any other protected or analogous ground

4.7.6. Sexual Misconduct, Sexual Harassment and Sexual Violence

- a) Engaging in conduct that constitutes sexual harassment as defined by the PoSH guidelines

4.7.7. Ragging

- a) conduct constituting ragging under applicable UGC regulations, law or university policy

4.7.8. Disruption and public disturbance in university and extended spaces

- a) disrupting, obstructing or preventing classes, laboratories, libraries, examinations, evaluations, seminars, university events, meetings, field practice, residences or routine university operations, whether online or offline;
- b) preventing or obstructing others from using authorised common spaces or institutional facilities;
- c) wilfully restraining, blocking, gheraoing, confining or obstructing the movement of any student, member, visitor or others;
- d) unauthorised recording, photographing, streaming, circulation or publication of classroom interactions, meetings, guest lectures, University events, inquiry proceedings or other restricted interactions;
- e) failure to adhere to classroom, laboratory, field, residence, transport or event etiquette where the conduct affects learning, safety, dignity or order.

4.7.9. Unauthorised Events, Gatherings and Use of Spaces

- a) All programme related events organized by students require explicit permission from the respective Programme Coordinator
- b) Other events organised by students require explicit permission from faculty mentors of respective clubs or Student Affairs. Requests for approval must be sent 48 hours in advance.
- c) In circumstances where a 48-hour notice period is not available, permission will have to be sought from the Registrar's Office. Contravention of these conditions or organising events without

permission/when permission has been denied, will be considered a major violation.

4.7.10. Trespass, Unauthorised Access and Harbours

- a) allowing any unauthorised person, including alumni, former students, suspended students, rusticated students or outsiders, access to any part of campus or University residences without permission;
- b) allowing day scholars, outsiders, family members or unauthorised persons to stay in University residences or rooms;
- c) accessing residences, rooms, offices, meeting rooms, conference rooms, laboratories, technical spaces, service areas or restricted areas without permission;
- d) accessing spaces meant for technical or service purposes, including IDF rooms, generator rooms, electrical rooms, shafts or other restricted areas.

4.7.11. Residential Violations

- a) any act contributing to fire, safety, security, hygiene or privacy risk in residences;
- b) any act of theft, including taking or attempting to take another person's belongings or University property without permission;
- c) switching hostel rooms without prior permission;
- d) misuse of one's own room, another student's room, shared facilities, residence corridors, terraces, windows, stairwells, lifts, refuge areas or common spaces;
- e) throwing articles, liquids, waste or objects from windows, balconies or other elevated areas
- f) unauthorised use of emergency stairwells, fire refuge areas, electrical/communication shafts or other restricted residential areas.

4.7.12. Posters and Communications

- a) sticking posters or send emails that violate Code of Conduct
- b) unauthorised use of the name, logo, branding, institutional identity, or reputation of the university or any related institution.
- c) producing or disseminating any communication, whether oral, written, printed, or digital, that is defamatory, threatening, intimidatory, discriminatory, misleading, obscene, unlawful, or disruptive of the academic, administrative, disciplinary, or institutional functioning of the University or any related institution.

4.7.13. Social Media, Digital Conduct and Technology Misuse

- a) any conduct constituting violation of the University's Digital Conduct and Media Engagement Policy and/or IT policy;
- b) use the university's name, logo, branding, or any other element of its institutional or related organisations' identity to represent, speak on behalf of, or claim affiliation with the university in any digital platforms.
- c) creating or operating any social media page, handle or other digital property using the university or related institution's name, acronym, or institutional identity in a manner that may create an impression that such platform is official or affiliated with the University.

4.7.14. Financial Violations, Theft and Misuse of Assistance

- a) theft of money, property or personal belongings;
- b) misappropriation of funds;
- c) falsification, fabrication, or misrepresentation of records, bills, documents, accounts, medical documents, insurance claims/documents, or declarations for financial or any other gain.

4.7.15. Fraud, Misrepresentation and Unauthorised Representation

- a) making fraudulent, inaccurate, misleading or incomplete claims in official records, medical documents, educational records, identity documents, applications, declarations or any other document;
- b) unauthorised use of the university's name, logo, acronym, letterhead, email domain, identity, affiliation or reputation;
- c) sharing university data, documents, internal communications, logos, records, photographs, videos or materials with external organisations, media, institutions or individuals without prior authorisation;
- d) entering into contracts, commitments, negotiations, representations or public statements on behalf of the University without authorisation;
- e) impersonating another person or permitting another person to impersonate oneself in any university-related process.

4.7.16. Political Activity on Campus

- a) The University does not permit student groups with political party and/or organisation affiliation to operate on campus. Engagement in or facilitation of such groups on campus shall be treated as a major violation.

- b) Students shall not organise, support, campaign for, raise funds for, or act on behalf of any political party, electoral candidate, or political organisation on campus and no university space shall be used for the same.

4.7.17. Violations Relating to Administrative or Disciplinary Inquiry

- a) making false, misleading, incomplete or evasive statements in an administrative, disciplinary or other inquiry;
- b) failing to cooperate with an inquiry committee;
- c) failing to comply with instructions issued by the University through Student Affairs, Registrar's Office, Inquiry Committees or other offices;
- d) publicising or disclosing the identity of complainants, respondents, witnesses, committee members or the details of complaints, evidence, inquiry proceedings, findings or decisions except as authorised;
- e) threatening, pressurising, retaliating against, harassing or victimising any complainant, respondent, witness, committee member, official or anyone associated with proceedings;
- f) destroying, concealing, fabricating, altering, withholding or tampering with evidence, records, devices or information relevant to an inquiry.

4.7.18. Miscellaneous Major Violations

- a) harassment of students or members through physical, verbal, or electronic means that might be intimidatory, humiliating or harmful in any manner.
- b) not following health protocols, isolation requirements, quarantine directions, medical instructions or public-health directions issued by competent medical authority or the University;
- c) Not using the biometric system when leaving/entering the campus;
- d) aiding, abetting, facilitating, encouraging or concealing any minor or major violation;
- e) any conduct that the University determines to be inconsistent with safety, dignity, institutional functioning, public purpose, University values or applicable law.

4.8. Violations related to Field Practice

- 4.8.1. All provisions of this Code of Conduct shall apply during field practice, including internships, practicum, immersion programmes, research placements, and any other University-approved external

engagement. Students shall additionally comply with the rules, regulations, policies, protocols, and lawful directions of the host organisation or institution. In addition to other violations, the following field-related conduct may constitute violations:

- a) diverting, misusing, withholding or failing to account for the University financial aid, advances, reimbursements or field funds;
- b) failing to settle financial accounts with the host organisation or University before leaving;
- c) consumption, possession or facilitation of alcohol, narcotics, tobacco, vapes or prohibited substances in field;
- d) failing to treat host organisation members, community members, colleagues or University representatives with dignity and respect;
- e) not reporting on the start date of the field component, being absent without permission, leaving the field site without permission, or failing to follow approved leave procedures;
- f) violating host organisation policies relating to working hours, confidentiality, physical intimacy, housing, safeguarding, data collection, documentation or community engagement;
- g) any conduct creating reputational, ethical, legal, financial, safety or safeguarding risk for the University, host organisation, community or any person.

4.8.2. Categorisation of violations during field practice as major or minor will be based on the assessment carried out by the appropriate authorities at these host organisations in coordination with the university and handled appropriately.

4.8.3. For minor violations, administrative action will be initiated by Student Affairs, Schools or the relevant Field practice team depending on the nature of violation. All conversations (formal or informal) related to any violation will be documented and may be used during the violation's inquiry process.

4.8.4. Disciplinary action will be initiated by a Disciplinary Committee for all major violations.

4.9. The violations listed in this Code of Conduct are indicative and not exhaustive. The University reserves the right to determine and take appropriate disciplinary action for any behaviour that it deems inconsistent with the values, rules, and regulations of the University, even if such behaviour is not explicitly listed in this document.

5. Disciplinary and Administrative Action Procedures

- 5.1. Violations of University policies, regulations, norms, guidelines, or the Code of Conduct may be reported by students, faculty members, staff members, University functionaries, Field Practice host organisations, or any other concerned person.
- 5.2. The University may also initiate *suo moto* action based on information received through observations, reports, or other sources.
- 5.3. The University may conduct a preliminary assessment to determine whether the matter should be handled administratively, referred to disciplinary committees, reported to law enforcement, or addressed through any other appropriate mechanism.
- 5.4. Depending on the nature and seriousness of the matter, cases may be reviewed and acted upon by one or more of the following:
 - 5.4.1. Disciplinary Committees
 - 5.4.2. Student Affairs
 - 5.4.3. Registrar's Office
 - 5.4.4. Schools
 - 5.4.5. Field Practice host organisation(s)
 - 5.4.6. Any other special/adhoc committee constituted by the University
- 5.5. Minor violations which attract administrative action may, in the first instance, be dealt with administratively by Student Affairs, the Registrar's Office, a School, the Field Practice team, residence authorities, or any other competent authority designated by the University. Where a student is alleged to have committed a repeated minor violation, whether of the same or of a different nature, the competent authority may refer the matter for disciplinary proceedings.
- 5.6. Major violations shall ordinarily be referred to a Disciplinary Committee or such other committee, or body as may be authorised by the University. The Disciplinary Committee may conduct the inquiry itself or constitute a Fact Finding Team to collect information, obtain statements, examine documents and digital material, and take a decision on appropriate disciplinary action.
- 5.7. Students will be provided a reasonable opportunity to present their case, explanation, or response before a final decision is made, except in situations requiring immediate interim action. Based on the inquiry, the Committee will decide on the appropriate action. If penalties are imposed, they will be recorded by the Registrar's Office and implemented by the relevant University authorities.
- 5.8. Where required, the student may be issued a show cause notice outlining the alleged violation and seeking an explanation within a specified time. Failure to

respond within the specified time may result in the matter proceeding ex parte on the basis of available information.

- 5.9. During the pendency of any inquiry and/or until a final decision is issued, the University may, at its discretion, impose interim measures or administrative directions necessary to protect safety, maintain order and institutional functioning, protect the interests of individuals or the University community, or facilitate a fair proceeding.
- 5.10. Interim measures may include but not limited to residence suspension, campus access restrictions, no-contact directions, temporary academic restrictions, removal from a field site, withdrawal of event permission, restriction of access to facilities (including digital), direction to vacate premises, or any other temporary and proportionate measure considered necessary in the circumstances.
- 5.11. Proceedings under this Code are internal University processes intended to preserve safety and welfare of the university community. Accordingly, the University may adopt procedures and processes that it considers fair, reasonable, proportionate, and appropriate to the educational and residential context of the institution.
- 5.12. In proceedings under this Code, the concerned authority may consider any material it regards as relevant and sufficiently reliable, including but not limited to oral or written statements, documents, emails, messages, photographs, videos, CCTV footage, digital logs, circumstantial material, and reports of Field Practice host organisations or other third parties.
- 5.13. In the event of a mala fide or intentionally false complaint, appropriate action may be taken against the complainant. This Clause shall be applied cautiously and shall not be interpreted so as to deter or penalise bona fide complaints or statements made in good faith but not ultimately substantiated.
- 5.14. The Registrar / Deputy Registrar may, in instances of certain severe violations or repeat/multiple violations, choose to handle the case directly and bypass administrative or disciplinary processes mentioned above in the interest of safety of students and order on campus.

6. Potential Penalties

- 6.1. Depending on the nature and seriousness of the violation, one or more of the following penalties may be imposed:
 - 6.1.1. Written warning
 - 6.1.2. Handwritten apology (ink-signed hard copy)
 - 6.1.3. Mediation
 - 6.1.4. Measures to prevent repeat violations
 - 6.1.5. Residential suspension for a specified duration

- 6.1.6. Academic suspension for a specified duration
- 6.1.7. Suspension from the programme for a specified duration
- 6.1.8. Expulsion from the University
- 6.1.9. Handing over the matter to the police or judicial authorities
- 6.2. The penalties awarded could involve either one or a combination of penalties indicated. The list of penalties is illustrative and not exhaustive. The competent authority may impose any proportionate penalty, restriction, condition or corrective measure not expressly listed where the circumstances warrant it.
- 6.3. Likewise, the Disciplinary Committee / Administrative body is authorised to determine the penalties in case of specific violations that are not mentioned in the document but is referred to it for adjudication.
- 6.4. The penalties in the case of field practice may be higher since the risks are considered to be higher. The standard of conduct expected will also be higher since reputational risk is higher and risk of harm arising from engagement with children, vulnerable communities etc. is also higher.
- 6.5. The Disciplinary Committee, Student Affairs or other administrative bodies can issue orders of 'suspension pending inquiry' if it is assessed that the violator is likely to threaten the safety of others, cause disruption/disorder, influence witnesses in the aftermath of any violation and/or potentially destroy, or tamper with, the evidence. The order may include residence suspension and / or academic suspension with immediate effect.
- 6.6. Any action which requires vacating residences and campus, will specify a time frame. The students are to ensure that these timelines are adhered to. In exceptional cases, the students will be ordered to vacate residences or university premises with immediate effect depending on the severity of the violation.

7. Appeal Process

- 7.1. A student against whom any penalty has been imposed pursuant to a Disciplinary Committee hearing or administrative action shall have the right to appeal against such decision to the Registrar, who shall be the authorised appellate authority under this Code.
- 7.2. Unless otherwise specified in writing, every appeal under this Clause shall be made within forty-eight (48) hours from the time the penalty is communicated or otherwise awarded to the student.
- 7.3. The Registrar will also be the final appellate authority in cases other than those which require police or judicial action. The Registrar may enhance, uphold, reduce, or dismiss the penalties awarded by the DC or Student Affairs/Schools depending on the nature of violation, mitigating circumstances or lack thereof.

- 7.4. Any student 'suspended pending inquiry' from the residence (including the residential arrangements provided during field practice) during the period of the inquiry/trial will not be permitted inside the residence while the appeal is under consideration by the Registrar.

8. Confidentiality

- 8.1. All complaints, preliminary assessments, fact-finding, disciplinary proceedings, records, statements, evidence, deliberations and decisions shall be treated as confidential and shared only on a need-to-know basis.
- 8.2. Students shall not disclose, publish, circulate or discuss confidential information relating to complaints, witnesses, respondents, complainants, committees, evidence, findings or proceedings with uninvolved persons, media, social media or external entities
- 8.3. In the event of any actual or suspected act of self-harm or harm to others, the University may inform the student's parents or guardians and such relevant University authorities as may be necessary, including the Programme Coordinator, School Director or Associate Director, Programme Office, Conversations Team, Faculty Mentor, Resident Mentor, Registrar, Deputy Registrar, Student Affairs Convenor, Vice Chancellor, or any other designated person, for the purpose of coordinating self-harm care, academic support, and residential arrangements.
- 8.4. The inquiry committees of the university may break confidentiality or use any information to make its decision if the committee or administrative body is convinced that the situation involves a risk of significant harm to any university member or student.
- 8.5. CCTV cameras are installed in common areas and residences of the campus. In any administrative or disciplinary inquiry, the competent authority may examine and rely on relevant CCTV footage and shall have access to such footage for the purpose of investigation.
- 8.6. The Disciplinary Committee, Student Affairs and other administrative bodies will maintain records of its investigation as per the university's rules. Such records may be considered in future proceedings where relevant.
- 8.7. Parents/guardians may be informed in cases involving suspension, expulsion, or where the student is referred, reported, or handed over to police, law enforcement, or other state authorities.

9. Expectations from Students During Inquiry and Hearing

- 9.1. Students who are complainants, respondents, witnesses or otherwise involved shall cooperate fully and truthfully with the University during any inquiry, administrative process or disciplinary proceeding.

- 9.2. Students are expected to respond promptly to inquiry summons or instructions issued by the relevant Disciplinary Committee or the Administrative body, failing which the inquiry may proceed without waiting for the student concerned.
- 9.3. Students are expected to be truthful in their statements to the administrative bodies and Disciplinary Committees. Providing false or misleading statements or failure to cooperate may result in further disciplinary action.
- 9.4. The complainants and defendants are required not to disclose any information to uninvolved parties during the inquiry process. Publicising or disclosing the names of the complainant/s, defendant/s, witnesses, the committee members, or the verdict to any external parties will be considered a major violation.
- 9.5. Due process will be followed to arrive at a resolution in the most expeditious manner possible and demands for circumventing due process to conclude the proceedings will not be entertained.

10. Statutory Committees and Procedures

- 10.1. Cases involving ragging, PoSH, POCSO and discrimination related offences will be separately inquired into and appropriate penalties will be imposed in accordance with established University rules, norms and procedures. All violations deemed criminal offences under applicable laws will be treated as major violations. Further, when obligated by law the University shall report the matter to the appropriate authority.
- 10.2. In addition, under the law certain acts of violation are required to be reported to the police and the university will be obliged to act accordingly. The record of all violations will be maintained by the Registrar's Office and be used as applicable.
- 10.3. **Anti-Ragging Committee (AC)**
 - 10.3.1. Ragging is a specific form of intimidation and bullying, most often targeting students of junior cohorts, that is completely unacceptable in the university. It is also unlawful. Any student who is found guilty of ragging will face immediate consequences and may be subject to legal processes.
 - 10.3.2. Any ragging-related complaints can be submitted to the Anti-Ragging Committee via email (antiragging@apu.edu.in)
 - 10.3.3. <<[Click here](#)>> for Anti-Ragging Policy
 - 10.3.4. <<[Click here](#)>> for information on the members of the anti-ragging committee
- 10.4. **Prevention of Sexual Harassment (PoSH)**
 - 10.4.1. Sexual harassment is any unwelcome sexual behaviour, act of physical contact, verbal or textual requests for sexual favours, sexual

images and other visual, verbal, or physical conduct of a sexual nature.

10.4.2. Any PoSH-related complaint may be reported to the PoSH Committee via email (posh@apu.edu.in)

10.4.3. <<[Click here](#)>> for PoSH policy

10.4.4. <<[Click here](#)>> for information on the members of the PoSH committee

10.5. **Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Centre (ADEEOC)**

10.5.1. A discriminatory act refers to any action, behaviour, or communication - whether verbal, written, or symbolic - that demeans, excludes, threatens, or disadvantages an individual or group based on their social background.

10.5.2. Any incident of discrimination may be reported to the Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Centre via email (adc.blr@apu.edu.in)

10.5.3. <<[Click here](#)>> for Anti-Discrimination, Equity and Equal Opportunity Policy

10.6. **Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO)**

10.6.1. Please note that in accordance with the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act (POCSO), 2018, the university is obliged to report any instance of sexual activity involving students aged under 18 to the local police.

11. Complaint Submission Template

The complaints must be submitted to the Disciplinary Committee via email (dc@apu.edu.in)

A. Details of the Complainant:

Name of the Complainant:

Admission Number / Member ID:

Room Number (if available/applicable):

B. Details of the Accused:

Name(s) of the person(s) committed the violation:

Admission Number(s):

Room Number(s) (if available/applicable):

- C. Complaint Details: Detailed description of the incident / violation:
- D. Date and time of the Incident:
- E. Location where the incident occurred / was witnessed:
- F. Any Other Remarks: (Additional information, witnesses, or relevant context, if any):

Digital Conduct and Media Engagement Policy

Updated: May 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru, Bhopal and Ranchi Campuses

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Social media and other digital communication platforms play an important role in how students communicate, learn and collaborate with one another, the University and with the wider society.

1.2 While these platforms create valuable opportunities for learning, sharing and community engagement, they also carry responsibilities. Content shared online can have lasting consequences for individuals, communities, and institutions, and may affect privacy, safety, reputation, and academic integrity.

1.3 This policy outlines expectations regarding safe and responsible usage of social media and other digital communication platforms by students of Azim Premji University and is designed to promote respectful engagement, protect privacy, prevent misuse and safeguard the interests of students, the University and its members.

1.4 For the purpose of this policy, “social media” includes social networking sites, content-sharing platforms, blogs, online forums, messaging applications, and other digital

communication channels that enable users to create, share, comment on, or distribute content. This includes but is not limited to Instagram, X, LinkedIn, Facebook, Telegram, Reddit, YouTube and Whatsapp.

1.5 This policy also applies to all University provided digital communication tools, including University email accounts, Moodle discussion forums and any other platforms made available by the University for academic, administrative or communication purposes.

1.6 **Media Enquiries:** Please note that the University has an authorised spokesperson for any media enquiry. Students who are approached by members of the media regarding University-related matters must refer such enquiries to the University's designated spokesperson, Sudheesh Venkatesh (sudheesh.venkatesh@azimpremjifoundation.org).

Unless expressly authorised by University authorities in writing, students must not represent themselves as speaking on behalf of the University in response to media enquiries. If students need information or resolution to any concerns, please reach out to the relevant team mentioned on RO website.

2. General Principles For Responsible Social Media Usage

2.1 Students are expected to exercise good judgement and act responsibly when using social media and other digital communication platforms.

2.2 Communicate respectfully: Treat others online with the same respect and consideration as expected in face-to-face interactions.

2.3 Exercise caution before posting: Consider the potential impact, including possible physical, emotional, or reputational harm to yourself, others, and the University, before posting, sharing, commenting on, or forwarding content. . If in doubt about whether a post is appropriate, it is best not to share it.

2.4 Be discreet: Exercise care when sharing personal information online, including photographs and location information relating to yourself or others, and respect the privacy and consent of others at all times.

2.5 Assume permanence: Most social platforms are public, and content can remain accessible long after being deleted—even in private or closed groups.

2.6 Protect your digital footprint: Consider carefully decisions to post content, follow others, or allow access to personal content. Online activity can shape long-term personal and professional reputation, including with future employers.

2.7 Be accountable: Do not post unverified information from others. The responsibility of ensuring the veracity of what you post, say and share lies with you.

2.8 Use appropriate channels: For addressing University-related concerns, seek accurate information and pursue clarification through the appropriate University channels rather than resorting to social media.

In addition to observing the general principles outlined above, students are required to comply with the following provisions governing the use of social media and other digital communication platforms.

3. Privacy and Consent

3.1 Students shall respect the privacy and dignity of others when using social media and other digital communication platforms.

3.2 Students shall not post or share photographs, videos, messages, recordings, personal information, or other content belonging to another student or member of the University without their consent.

3.3 Unauthorised circulation or publication of classroom interactions, meetings, guest lectures, University events, inquiry proceedings or other restricted interactions on social media platforms is a major violation of the Code of Conduct.¹

3.4 If a student is photographed or recorded by the University or fellow students for potential external publication, they have the right to withhold consent for public use.

4. Information Sharing and Responsibility

4.1 Students shall publish and share content that has been verified or approved by the designated authority. If not sure about the veracity of the content, it should not be shared.

4.2 Students shall not knowingly create, share, or circulate false or misleading information about other students, University members, or the institution itself.

4.3. Students are responsible for the content they create, share, forward, endorse, represent, or distribute online and cannot disclaim responsibility once it has been shared or circulated, irrespective of its source, and such content remains subject to the University's Code of Conduct.

5. Social Media Accounts Of Authorised Student Clubs

5.1 University-approved student clubs and groups may create and operate social media accounts to support their activities and engagement. Such accounts must be used responsibly and in a manner consistent with the University's values and policies. All content shared through club accounts must receive prior approval from the designated Club Mentor.

5.2 Official club platforms shall be used only for communication relating to approved activities, events, announcements, promotions, collaborations, achievements, or other authorised institutional purposes.

¹ Refer to section 4.7.8. of the Code of Conduct for Students, 2026

5.3 Personal opinions, political views, interpersonal disputes, anonymous allegations, or private grievances must not be communicated through official club platforms.

5.4 The University reserves the right to require removal of content or suspend access to any official club or associated platform found to be in violation of University policies or directives.

6. Unauthorised Representation of the University

6.1 Students shall not create or operate any unauthorised social media page, handle or other digital property using the university or related institution's name, acronym, or institutional identity in a manner that may create an impression that such platform is official or affiliated with the University.

6.2 Students shall not use the university's name, logo, acronym, branding, or any other element of its institutional or related organisations' identity to represent, speak on behalf of, or claim affiliation with the university on any digital platforms without prior authorisation.

6.3 Students shall not share or publish content that falsely suggests endorsement, sponsorship, approval, or representation by the University.

6.4 Any violation of the above will be considered a major violation under the University Code of Conduct.²

7. Classroom and Academic Content

7.1 Material discussed or shared in class — such as lecture recordings, presentations/ documents/ videos, guest sessions, or forums — is intended solely for students and faculty. Students shall not record, copy, or distribute such content to external individuals or post it on public platforms without prior written permission from the instructor and Programme Coordinator.

7.2 Moodle and other learning management systems used by the University are not public platforms; all content shared on these spaces is private and intended solely for classmates and faculty. Students shall not record, copy, or share any material from these platforms with external individuals or on public forums.

8. Respectful and Safe Online Conduct

8.1 Students must not engage in harassment, bullying, or threatening behaviour: Includes use of abusive or demeaning language, online harassment, threats to individual safety, or sharing others' personal content (e.g. photographs, messages) without consent.

8.2 Students must not share inappropriate or harmful content: Posting material that is defamatory, offensive, hateful, threatening, retaliatory, sexually explicit, obscene, or likely to damage the reputation of other students, university members or the University.

² Refer to section 4.7.13. of the Code of Conduct for Students, 2026

8.3 Students must not engage in disruptive online conduct: Repeated posts or actions on social media that interfere with the academic engagement or safety of other students.

8.4 The University has zero tolerance for conduct prohibited under this section and by Indian law. Any violation will be considered a major violation under the University Code of Conduct.³

9. Use of University Provided Digital Communication Tools

9.1 University email accounts and other University-provided digital communication tools are intended primarily for academic and official University communication only.

9.2 Students must not use them to i) harass or intimidate others; ii) circulate spam, promotional material, chain messages, or unauthorised advertisements; iii) download software onto their personal devices; iv) register on social media platforms, or for non-academic activities; v) impersonate the University, its officers, departments, faculty, staff, or student bodies; vi) share confidential, sensitive, or restricted University information without authorisation; vii) share any content which violates Indian law.

10. Penalties

10.1 Failure to comply with this Policy constitutes a violation of the Code of Conduct and would result in disciplinary action. Any violations of laws of India will be dealt with in accordance with relevant laws and regulations.

10.2 The examples and prohibitions contained in this Policy are not exhaustive.

10.3 The University reserves the right to take appropriate action under the University's Code of Conduct in relation to other forms of online conduct that adversely affect members of the University community, the academic environment, or the legitimate interests of the University.

³ Refer to section 4.7.1 and 4.7.5 of the Code of Conduct for Students, 2026

Azim Premji University
Four Year Undergraduate Programmes
Summary of Academic Rules & Regulations
Version 2.3 July 2025

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VERSION HISTORY

[illegible]

VERSION NO.	DATE	CHANGE	REMARKS
1.0	June, 2023	First version	
2.0	January, 2024	Sec 4.7.1	Added
2.1	February, 2024	Sec 8.4	Updated to include exception in reassessment and repetition of Supporting courses

1.0 Introduction

1.1 About this document

This document summarises the rules and regulations that govern the various academic processes and decisions in the four year undergraduate programmes, relevant to teaching, learning and administration. This document draws its authority from various documents approved by the Academic Council, including the Framework of Standards for Qualifications (see the SAS Webpage for the latest version), the four year undergraduate programme document and other curriculum documents and conforms to the key guidelines in those documents.

1.1 Applicability

The Rules and Regulations mentioned here are applicable to and binding on all students registered currently (from 2023 onwards) in the Four Year Undergraduate programmes, offered in the University, including the four year Teacher Education programme. These may be modified from time to time and the most current version will be applicable at any time. Students are required to refer to the current version and may obtain it from the SAS webpage (<https://sites.google.com/apu.edu.in/sas/home>).

1.2 Whom to contact

The Registrar's Office of the University is responsible for obtaining approvals, finalising and administering all the Rules and Regulations relating to Programmes. The students may contact the Programme Office (sas.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in) for clarifications and administrative support.

2.0 The Curriculum

2.1 Goals of Undergraduate Education in the University

Undergraduate education at Azim Premji University supports the development of capabilities for meaningful work and livelihood, and for thoughtful responses to social and personal goals and challenges. These capacities are the foundation for flourishing and hopefully allow students to pursue particular interests and projects in an ethical and socially meaningful manner.

Towards this goal, the programme will:

- Help students achieve their potential in their areas of study through committed teaching and cooperative and self-directed learning.
- Encourage students to use their capacities to engage with the issues that communities face locally and globally.
- Emphasise questioning and open-mindedness as critical values in the student.
- Nurture and support the capacity for reflective self-understanding and dialogue.

2.2 Broad academic expectations from students

Students are active participants in the educational processes of the programme, not passive recipients of knowledge or information. Towards this, they are expected to:

- Take responsibility for their own learning and help support the learning of others.
- Be prepared for class, participate in discussions, and learn to ask questions.
- Be respectful while sharing thoughts and listen respectfully to others.
- Collaborate when encouraged to do so – share ideas, work in groups, and not hesitate to receive help from others where appropriate.
- Adhere to the norms of academic integrity specified in the FOSQ and by the course instructor in class and while participating in assessments of learning.

3.0 Calendar

The Programme Office will publish and circulate the official academic calendar for the programme every semester. Students are required to access the published calendar and familiarise themselves with the important dates. It is available on the [SAS webpage](#).

4.0 Registration

4.1 What is Registration?

Registration is the process where students admitted to the programmes of the University are formally entered in the records of the University as having met the conditions of entry, as having personally reported to the University and if applicable, to the residences on the dates notified. While admission is offered for the entire programme, registration is valid only for the relevant semester and must be renewed subject to the student meeting all academic and non academic requirements. The Registrar's Office will be responsible for administering the process of registration.

4.2 Information about Registration

The Programme Office will inform students of the date of Registration to the Programme and in the case of intermediate semesters, the date on which students are required to report to the University or Residences.

4.3 Late registration

Students who do not report to the University ready to join the programme may lose their right to be registered in the programme that semester unless they have obtained prior permission from the School (School of Arts and Sciences).

4.3.1 Permission for late registration

In general, students will not be permitted to register on a date other than the date specified in the University's calendar except under circumstances of personal ill health or a verified family emergency. The decision of the University in this matter will be final and binding.

4.3.2 Process

A student who is unable to report on the specified date should write to the Programme Office in advance and seek a leave of absence. Applications for delayed registration after the date specified in the calendar will not be accepted.

4.4 Registration required before use of facilities

Only registered students will be allowed to use the campus, stay in the residences, access the course websites, the learning management system and the University's email facilities. Unregistered students and students who leave the programme at any stage before graduation will be automatically delisted from these without notice. Any exceptions to the Rule regarding using University resources by unregistered students or alumni must be specifically approved by the Director or the Registrar's Office.

4.5.1 Duration of B.A. and B.Sc. (Hons.) Programmes

The Four Year Undergraduate Programme for the cohorts registering from 2023 that leads to B.A. (Hons.), B.Sc. (Hons.) and B.Sc B.Ed. degrees can be completed after registered full-time study for not less than eight semesters of approximately 15 weeks each. The programme design will allow for flexibility and provide multiple exit options with a 1-year certificate, a 2-year diploma, a 3-year degree and a 4-year degree with honours. The basic programme for which all students must apply is the 4-year honours programme. Exits are provided as an exception rather than as standard practice.

Students are expected to complete their programme qualifications in the stipulated duration mentioned above. The duration of study can be extended by a maximum of one year. Otherwise, students will be asked to leave the programme with the qualification for an earlier eligible exit point.

Extensions to the overall duration of study will entail additional fees.

For all requirements for the award of a qualification, please see section 7.6.1.

4.5.2 Duration of four year Teacher Education Programmes

The four year dual degree teacher education programme (B.Sc. B.Ed.) can be completed in not less than eight semesters of registered full time study. A student who fails to obtain the required credits by the end of the fifth academic year from the year of admission will not be awarded the degree.

4.6 Break in Study

Students may be allowed to take a break in study, without being registered in the programme, for no more than two semesters. The break may be permitted either due to ill-health or other reasons. A student who rejoins the programme after a break will have to satisfy the regulations and guidelines prevalent at the time of registration. Permission is not automatic and will require application to the Programme Office, which will consider each case on merit.

4.7 Academic Progression¹

Students are required to complete the courses of the earlier semesters and obtain the associated credits before they can move to a subsequent semester. However, they will be permitted to register in the subsequent semester if they are eligible to take at least two courses as part of the requirements of their specific programme.

If they are ineligible for entry into at least two courses in the subsequent semester (either on account of pre-requisite criteria or other relevant administrative constraints), they may have to be deregistered for a semester and repeat the courses when they are available next. This automatically extends the duration of the student's programme.

Additionally, if the total number of U's in a student's transcript exceeds 5, then the student is ineligible to pursue the programme further for the award of a degree and degree with Honours. In such cases, the student is asked to leave the programme and will be awarded the highest eligible qualification.

4.7.1 Notifying parents/guardians about academic progression

The university communicates directly only with students in all matters relating to academics including but not limited to semester registration, course enrollment, attendance percentages and course grades.

The university will make an exception to the communication policy stated above and reserves the right to inform students' parents/local guardians in the following situations:

¹ See also Rules 7.5.5 and 8.4

- If a student does not meet the eligibility criteria for progressing to the next semester or graduating.
- Additionally, if a student is on a significantly reduced course load in a particular semester, owing to academic backlogs.

5.0 Residential Facility

5.1 Residential nature of the Programmes

The Undergraduate Programmes are fully residential. Students are required to stay in the University's student hostels for the duration of the programme. However, in some cases, either due to unavoidable personal considerations or due to the residential facility being withdrawn for whatever reason, the University may allow or require students to stay outside.

5.2 Residential life

The University will publish the rules and norms of residential life, as modified from time to time. The students must familiarise themselves with the rules and are required to adhere to these, in letter and spirit, to make the programme and residential life conducive to their learning and wellbeing. Violations may lead to disciplinary action as per the University's policies. Students who violate residential norms but are allowed to continue to be registered in the programme may be asked to withdraw from the residences. The Resident Mentors are responsible for all residence related matters.

5.3 Residential facility for students who extend study

Students who apply to extend their study under Section 4.5 or 4.6, and those whose duration of study is extended due to Section 8.4 or due to disciplinary action are not guaranteed residential accommodation. They may apply for residential accommodation, and may be provided the facility at the University's discretion.

6.0 Use of computers and other educational technology

6.1 Use of computers is mandatory

The Programme requires the use of personal computers by students and faculty for teaching and learning. All students in the UG Programme are *required* to have access to laptops for their academic work. The University may loan laptops to students on scholarships who cannot afford to procure one of their own. Students are also initially assisted by the IT Helpdesk to get familiar with the use of laptops, if they need such support.

6.2 Learning Management System

The UG Programme uses a Learning Management System for facilitating teaching and learning in the courses that form part of the programme. Moodle, a free and open source platform, is currently the system in use.

7.0 Credit structure and requirements for graduation

7.1 Curriculum and Credit Structure

The University uses a system of Academic Credits to quantify and recognise learning achievement. Credits are indicators of the learning that students are expected to have achieved on successfully completing different courses in the programme. Typically, students need to spend about 40 hours (unless specified otherwise), including both guided and self-directed study to obtain 1 academic credit. Guided study includes classroom instruction, tutorials and assessment activities.

Students will need to complete around 120 hours of study in a semester for a 3-credit taught course – typically, this will include a minimum of 45 hours of guided study, and approximately 75 hours of self-directed study over the semester. 5-credit taught courses will additionally include around 30 hours of academic support sessions and/or office consultation hours. For a 5-credit course that is based on laboratory/studio work, students will approximately spend 70 of the 120 hours of study working in the laboratory/studio over the semester.

The credit requirements and time budgeted for courses involving fieldwork and independent study are indicated in the FOSQ.

7.1.1 Applicability

The University may modify, through approved procedures, the structure of the curriculum and credits at any point in time. Normally, all important changes go through approval processes including discussion in the School, the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee (CPC) of the University and where necessary, the Academic Council. The current approved version of the programme and credit structure will be applicable to all students registered in the programme, unless explicitly indicated. The approved course structure can be obtained from the Programme Office.

7.1.2 Extra courses

Students may enrol in courses beyond the required number of credits, provided that they meet the prerequisites. The extra courses and the grade the student gets in those courses will reflect in the student's grade statement.

7.1.3 Change of courses after the beginning of the semester

A student may drop, add or change a course on their own only within the first two weeks after the start of classes in a 15-week semester via the process stipulated by the Programme Office.

In exceptional circumstances, students who wish to drop a course later than two weeks after the start of classes, may do so by approaching the Academic Advisor or Disability and Inclusion Team, as applicable. The Academic Advisor or Disability and Inclusion Team will review the students' application to drop the course beyond the deadline and may recommend any one of the following to the Programme Coordinators for approval:

1. Drop the course without the penalty of a U appearing on the transcript
2. Move the assessment criteria in the course to an S/U (see Sec. 8.3.2 for guidelines governing the S/U grade)

The final decision to permit dropping courses beyond the deadline stipulated above rests with the Programme Coordinators.

7.2 The B.A. and B.Sc. (Hons.) Curriculum

Students are requested to refer to the latest curriculum document for the B.A. and B.Sc. (Hons.) to familiarize themselves with the various required curricular components and credit structures. The current approved version of the programme and credit structure will be published and updated periodically on the SAS webpage.

7.2.1 Sections of the curriculum

The five major components of the 4-year programme's curriculum are as follows and elaborated in section 2.5 of the UG curriculum document v 1.3:

- a) Common Curriculum
- b) Disciplinary or Interdisciplinary Major
- c) Occupational Track (Minor)
- d) Internship or Research Thesis
- e) Flexible Credits

Each of these components may have internal regulations regarding enrolment, attendance, modes of assessment and completion that will be specified in the curriculum/course documents relevant to each. Students must abide by these and other academic regulations published in the most recent course and curriculum documents and complete specified components to be eligible for exit criteria in the four-year programme.

The school will lay down the overall procedure for entry into (d) Internship or Research Thesis in the four year programme and for exercising choice under (e) Flexible Credits. Individual Majors and Occupational Tracks may also publish discipline-specific criteria for entry. The University does not guarantee that every student will be allotted the Honours track of his/her choice.

7.2.2 Creative Expressions

As a part of the Common Curriculum, students joining from 2023 onwards are required to obtain six credits from CRX (three for the certificate qualification). This section elaborates on the criteria relevant to these courses:

- a. The credits under CRX must be obtained by the end of the stipulated duration of study by successfully completing the workshops or equivalent activity listed under the CRX course list, each carrying three credits.
- b. Students can register for only one CRX activity/workshop in any one semester.
- c. All CRX activities will be assessed and graded.
- d. Attendance and participation norms apply to CRX activity/courses².

² See also section 8.2 on additional participation considerations

7.2.3 Occupational Minor

The Occupational Minor (for those enrolled from 2023) will start in the third semester. Students will need to choose one of the Occupational Minors available. The choice must be made during the second semester. The school will lay down the procedure for the announcement of Occupational Minor and for exercising choice. The University does not guarantee that every student will be allotted the stream of his/her choice. Once chosen, students may be permitted to change their choice of Occupational minor before the end of the second week of the 3rd semester, on approval from the PO, if there are vacancies in the Occupational Minor the student wishes to join. No changes will be permitted subsequently.

The University does not guarantee that a specific area will be available or be offered as an Occupational Minor in any given year. The streams on offer will depend on the University's programme strategy, availability of faculty and other academic or administrative considerations.

The details of the credit structure for Occupational Minor are available in Sec. 2.5.3 of the four year programme document, v. 1.3 and will be published and updated periodically on the SAS website.

7.3 The B.Sc.B.Ed. Curriculum

The B.Sc.B.Ed programme is a dual degree, dual major undergraduate level programme of study that should be completed in 8 semesters running over 4 years. Students are admitted to study either Biology, Chemistry, Mathematics or Physics as their first major. The second major will be Education. For students joining in 2023 and after, 180 credits must be obtained to graduate. The curriculum is divided into four broad areas – the two majors mentioned above, the common curriculum and flexible credits.

7.3.1 The Common Curriculum

The structure of the Common Curriculum is the same as the B.A./B.Sc. programme.

7.4 Majors

The Programme requires students to graduate with a Major specialisation. Students are admitted with a specific major allotted. The list of Majors on offer in any academic year will be available in the University's website. The B.Sc.B.Ed. is a dual major, dual degree programme.

7.4.1 Change of Major

Students in the first year of their undergraduate programme can request a change in their major/programme using the procedure outlined in section 7.4.2. The Programme Coordinators will evaluate every request and take an appropriate decision. Their decision in response to applications will be final and binding.

Students can change their major/programme only once. After a change request is approved, the decision is irreversible. Any credits acquired in their original major/programme will remain on the transcript and may be used to satisfy requirements for flexible credits. Grades for courses in the original major/programme will also remain on the transcript.

After the first year, any requests for change in major/programme will be considered only under exceptional circumstances. Such requests must be accompanied by the recommendation of a faculty member.

7.4.2 Procedure for application for Change of Major

First semester students: Students can change to a different major after the first semester provided they have taken the first course in their preferred major through flexible credits. Such requests should be received before the mid-term break of the first semester. Students should apply for a change of major by applying through a form sent by the Programme Coordinators. The form will include details such as Student ID number, the current major/programme, the desired major/programme and the reasons for requesting the change.

Second semester students: Students can also request a change in major/programme in their second semester by sending an email to the Programme Coordinators before the mid-term break of that semester. The email should include the ID number of the student, the desired major/programme and the reasons for requesting the change. Students should also acknowledge in their email that their request may result in an increase in the duration of study and that they are prepared to pay applicable fees for the extra terms (scholarship students should also request an extension in scholarship). If a change request is approved, students will be considered part of the next batch of students of the new major/programme and will have to meet the programme requirements of that cohort of students to graduate. Students would be expected to complete all second semester courses in their original major/programme even if their request is approved.

For students wanting to shift in their second semester from a B.Sc. programme to the corresponding B.Sc. B.Ed. programme or vice versa, the process is simpler and will be done through a form (similar to the process in the first semester).

Change of major after the second semester: In most cases, requests made by students in third or later semesters will be declined. In these cases, students would be advised to graduate with a certificate or a diploma. However, under exceptional circumstances, programme coordinators can consider requests for change of major/programme if accompanied by a strong recommendation from a faculty member.

All change requests will be evaluated based on capacity considerations and/or a suitability assessment for the new major/programme conducted by associated faculty members. The overall duration of the programme is always calculated from the date of joining to the original major.

7.5 Courses

7.5.1 Definition

A course involves teaching, learning and appropriate assessment and grading, designed around a set of connected activities and content expected to achieve specified learning objectives. It is the smallest unit of study for which academic credit can be obtained and is usually offered for a term or semester.

7.5.2 Courses in the Undergraduate Programme

The smallest unit of study in the UG Programme is a course carrying not less than 3 credits for those registering from 2023 (with the exception of a single one-credit course for those who want to exit with a certificate at the end of the first year).

7.5.3 Course Levels

Every course will be identified by a name and an alpha-numeric descriptor. In addition, the University's courses may be classified and identified by an identifier that signifies the academic level that the course represents, with an increasing degree of academic difficulty or demand. There will be FIVE such levels from 1 to 5. The undergraduate programmes will have courses at levels 1, 2 and 3. A few courses at level 4 may also be listed for honours pathways.

7.5.4 Design and Approval of courses

Any course in the UG programme will be designed by one or more faculty members and will go through the University's process of evaluation and approval by the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee (CPC) and the Academic Council (AC). Every course will have an approved course document or course specification. The course document will be usually available in the Learning Management System and/or on the School website.

7.5.5 Prerequisites

Some courses may require the registering student to have prior preparation or understanding that should have been acquired earlier in the programme. Such requirements will be specified in the ERP or in Moodle. These will usually be in terms of the student having obtained credits from one or more prior courses³. In cases where specific prerequisites are not laid out, faculty may require students to demonstrate an understanding of certain areas or concepts.

7.5.6 Permitted courses in a semester

A registered student from the 2023 cohort onwards may enrol in a maximum of six courses in a semester. The Programme Office, in consultation with the Programme Coordinator may however make exceptions and permit a student to register for additional credits with sufficient reasons.

7.6 Requirements for award of qualifications

Students must obtain, within the stipulated duration, all the credits assigned to required courses and programmatic components to exit with a degree from the four year undergraduate programme:

³ In cases where students are eligible for reassessment as specified in Sec 8.4, progression to the next semester may be permitted even when prerequisites have not been successfully completed

- a. A total of at least 160 credits must be obtained with a minimum CGPA of 4.0 at the end of four years for the award of a degree with honours with not more than FIVE (5) U's in the transcripts issued during the programme.
- b. A total of at least 125 credits must be obtained with a minimum CGPA of 4.0 at the end of three years for the award of a degree with not more than FIVE (5) U's in the transcripts issued during the programme.
- c. A total of 180 credits with a minimum CGPA of 4.0 and with not more than FIVE (5) U's in the transcripts issued during the programme for students enrolled in the B.Sc.B.Ed. programme from 2023 onwards.

8.0 Guidelines and Requirements for Active and Responsible Participation in Academic Activities

The university expects all students to be active and responsible participants in their education. All formal activities (timetabled sessions, field visits, special guest lectures, etc.) are mandatory and active participation is expected. This policy outlines what is considered to be active and responsible participation both in individual sessions and for a course as a whole and the consequences for failing to meet these requirements.

8.1 Active and responsible participation in individual sessions

All timetabled sessions of a course are considered compulsory unless explicitly indicated as optional by the instructor. Attendance in compulsory sessions is recorded and the instructor will mark a student as present or absent. The minimum requirement to be considered an active participant in a session is physical presence. However, physical presence is not sufficient for being recorded as present in class. Instructors have the right to mark a student as absent if they deem that the engagement was insufficient or inappropriate. Some scenarios in which this may happen include:

1. Late arrival or early departure without adequate justification
2. Inattentive or disruptive behaviour including sleeping or an inability to respond when called upon to do so
3. Use of laptops, mobile phones or other electronic devices in violation of policies specified by the instructor
4. Inadequate preparation for class including failure to review specified readings or completing pre-class tasks
5. Showing up to class in inappropriate attire in situations where a dress code is prescribed (see also Sec 8.7.1).

The absences will be subject to consequences outlined in Section 8.1.3. The reason for absence will have no bearing on how the attendance is recorded and on the consequences. As a courtesy,

students are advised to send an email to their instructors if they are going to miss a class. However, there is no expectation to provide any supporting documentation to instructors.

8.1.1 Active and responsible participation in a course

The final grade that appears on the transcript not only certifies the extent to which the learning objectives of the course were fulfilled, but also the commitment shown by the student to participate in an active and responsible manner. Consequently, students are not eligible to receive a passing letter grade (O, A, A-, B, C, D, E, S) if their attendance percentage is lower than the threshold specified below even if they have done reasonably on assessments. Students should be aware that some courses may have a stricter attendance threshold (see Section 8.2). The thresholds are independent of the course levels.

- Attendance Threshold in Absence of Special Leave: **75%**
- Attendance Threshold with Special Leave: **68%**

Attendance percentage is the ratio of the number of sessions in which the student was marked as present and the total number of sessions in the course expressed as a percentage. As a rough guide, for a 15-week semester, students should be able to meet the 75% threshold even after missing three weeks of classes in a typical course with three mandatory contact hours per week. The special leave provisions (described in 8.1.2) lower the minimum attendance requirements by approximately a week. It should be noted that the threshold specified in the table will be followed strictly. Public holidays may reduce the total number of sessions in a course resulting in a below-threshold attendance after three weeks of absence. Moreover, in summer and winter terms which are of shorter duration, students may be unable to meet the attendance threshold if they are absent for a few days.

Students are responsible for monitoring their attendance and ensuring that their attendance is recorded accurately. Failure to meet the attendance threshold will result in a U grade for the course without the scope for reassessment. Unless one of the scenarios mentioned in Section 8.2.2 applies, the participation requirement will be enforced strictly.

8.1.2 Special Leave

For courses taught in 15-week semesters, students are eligible for relaxation in the attendance threshold through special leave under the following circumstances:

1. Illness or a medical condition requiring hospitalization or bed rest for a period of five working days (excluding Sunday) or more.
2. Participation in an extended event (sports, cultural event, conference) as a representative of the university or in which the student is scheduled to present work carried out in the university. An extended event is one which requires full-time participation for five or more working days.

Special leave will not be granted for personal or family events though exceptions can be made in cases of bereavement or when the student has to provide care to close family members.

Eligible students can apply for special leave by following the protocols specified by the Programme Office and the Programme Coordinators. Requests should be accompanied by appropriate documentation. It should be noted that the attendance threshold specified in the table above will be followed even if the student is eligible for more than one instance of special leave, i.e., the criteria is not relaxed by 7% for every eligible circumstance.

Students must apply for special leave in advance or as soon as their condition permits. If a request is made fourteen or more days after the last day of leave, it will not be considered.

Special leave will not be granted for summer and winter term courses as well as field practice courses. For courses in these terms or field practice courses, students may appeal to the programme coordinators as described in section 8.2.2.

8.1.3 Consequences of insufficient participation

Since active participation in mandatory academic activities is a requirement, failure to do so can have grade consequences. These include:

1. Reduction in class participation or similar grade component
2. Missing an in-class assessment and receiving a zero in it
3. Penalty for insufficient contribution to an in-class group activity
4. Inability to complete an assessment related to the class activity that was missed (for example, a lab report related to a lab activity)

Students should recognize that instructors are not obliged to conduct any make-up assessments or grant extensions for submissions. In most situations, students would be better off putting extra effort in the remaining assessments instead of trying to finish more of them in a shorter period of time as would be the case if make-up assessments were administered or extensions were granted.

Students have the primary responsibility for catching up with any content they have missed due to absences. Extended absences may result in a poor grade due to inability to catch up with course content. Moreover, if the number of absences results in the attendance falling below the threshold (8.1.1) at the end of the course, then the final grade will be overridden to a U grade irrespective of the performance in course assessments.

8.2 Additional considerations for participation requirements

8.2.1 More Stringent Participation Requirements

In some educational contexts, it is not feasible for the student to make up for missed engagements. These include courses with significant fieldwork, those requiring guided practice or embodied

learning and basic skill courses (for example, supporting courses in English and Quantitative skills) recommended for the completion of the programme. In these contexts, instructors can specify stricter participation criteria than those mentioned in Section 8.1.1. These courses typically do not have provisions for reassessment and failure to meet the participation criteria will result in a U grade. However, students can file an appeal to the programme coordinators (as mentioned in Section 8.2.2) if the failure to meet participation criteria was due to unavoidable circumstances.

Many students will undertake internships or other external engagements for academic credit. In such scenarios, students must adhere to the professional requirements of the external organization, which are likely to be more stringent. The external organization may report students who are not engaging appropriately or sufficiently. Apart from grade reduction, such reports may also invite disciplinary action.

8.2.2 Relaxation in Participation Requirements

Students should be aware of institutional mechanisms that can facilitate a relaxation in participation requirements.

1. **Disability and Inclusion Team:** The University is committed to providing an enabling educational environment for a diverse student body. There is a recognition that meeting our participation requirements would be onerous for certain students and that they will need support in the form of academic accommodations⁴. The Disability and Inclusion Team works with such students and facilitates their academic engagement. At the moment, The Disability and Inclusion Team will only case manage and provide disability support services, following a specified application and review process, to students with physiological impairments or neurodivergence in the following categories:

(1) Blindness

(2) Low Vision

(3) Deaf/Hard of Hearing

(4) Locomotor

(5) Locomotor high support - CP/Muscular dystrophy

(6) Specific Learning Disability

(7) ADHD (not a disability but we are limited support services are provided for these students)

(8) Autism Spectrum Disorder

⁴ Refer to the latest version of the FoSQ for a description and guidelines for what constitutes 'academic accommodations' in the context of student support

Any applications to receive accommodations should be made within the first fifteen days of the semester. Once accommodations have been granted, students will be responsible for sharing the details of these with their respective course instructors within two weeks. Academic accommodations will not be granted retroactively.

Relaxation in participation requirements is not a part of academic accommodations granted to students in the above categories whose cases are being managed by the Disability and Inclusion Team. However, in the event of a severe medical emergency, students in the above categories may be granted flexibility in participation requirements by the Disability and Inclusion Team in consultation with the Programme Coordinators.

2. **Extended absence for medical reasons:** Students who have had to miss three or more weeks in a semester for medical treatment would be unable to meet the attendance thresholds specified in Section 8.1.1. In these cases, the students should write to the Programme Coordinators with appropriate documentation of their treatment. The case will be reviewed by the Programme Coordinators and any other relevant support functions like the Disability and Inclusion Team or the Conversations Team and the student will either be allowed to complete courses for a Sufficient (S) grade or be deregistered from courses. In case the medical condition is chronic or there is a possibility of it affecting participation in future semesters, then the student will be referred to the Disability and Inclusion Support Team.
3. **Appeal to the Programme Coordinators:** Students can write to the Programme Coordinators and request a relaxation in the participation requirements if they feel that they are facing a situation that is not covered by Special Leave provisions (Section 8.1.2) or the ones listed earlier in this section. The appeal should be filed only after due consideration (it is advisable to consult one's mentor before writing to the Programme Coordinators) and should make a strong case that the student has tried to meet the participation requirements in good faith. It should be submitted in a timely manner (within a week of the occurrence of circumstances necessitating the appeal). In particular, an appeal beyond the first three weeks of the semester will only be considered in exceptional circumstances. If the appeal is viewed favourably, the Programme Coordinators will specify one of three outcomes: (i) a relaxation in the attendance threshold while retaining eligibility for a passing letter grade, (ii) a relaxation in the attendance threshold with a Sufficient (S) grade for passing the course, or (iii) deregistration from the course to avoid a U grade. The outcome need not be the same for all courses for which an appeal has been submitted. In all circumstances, the decision of the Programme Coordinators will be final.
4. It should be noted that a student cannot receive an S (Sufficient) grade if their attendance percentage is below 50% even if they are eligible for the relaxation provisions listed in this section.

8.3 Assessment and Grading

8.3.1 Assessment in courses

Assessment activities in courses are intended to aid learning. Instructors will publish rubrics of criteria that lay out the indicative levels and quality of responses to questions and tasks. The assessment activities will be graded, and students will be awarded grades for all courses that carry credit. The Programme will adhere to the University's approved grading system. The University uses eight letter grades from U (Unsatisfactory) to O (Outstanding) to indicate assessment outcomes. Grade points obtained in a semester are aggregated to calculate Grade Point Averages (GPA). GPA is recorded for every semester (SGPA) and also cumulatively for the programme (CGPA).

8.3.2 S (Sufficient) grade

The school, under special circumstances, uses the letter grade S (Sufficient) to indicate that a student has been able to obtain a passing grade. These circumstances include those outlined in Sec. 8.2. The S grade, when granted, will not impact the CGPA and as such, enables students facing unanticipated distress or adverse circumstances in a particular semester to progress to the next one.

Students may also choose to convert grading for any of their courses in the programme to S/U if they are at significant academic risk: being at risk of getting a low CGPA is an example. In such a situation, students are expected to file a request to convert their grading in the specific course/courses to an S/U with the Programme Office no later than three weeks before the end of the assessment week. Students are encouraged to consult course instructors and their mentors before filing a request to be assessed as S/U so that they gain a comprehensive understanding of their current academic performance.

The mode of grading for the thesis component required for completion of requirements for an Honours degree cannot be converted to S/U.

All requests for converting the mode of grading in courses to S/U are subject to Sec 8.1.1 and 8.2 above and Sec 8.3.8 below. Students can convert grading to S/U in a maximum of 4 (FOUR) courses during the four year undergraduate programme. An exception will be made in the case of students who take the English and/or Math support courses in the summer term. These students will be allowed to take these support courses for an S/U grade, without it counting towards the maximum of 4 S/U grade options stated above. Other exceptions to this limit may be granted only with the approval of the Programme Coordinators.

8.3.3 Grading in courses

The structure of assessment for grading in a course will be as per the approved course document. Minor changes in the grading pattern in a course, if any, will be announced by the instructor in the first week of the course and published on Moodle.

8.3.4 Responsibility for assessment

Course instructors will be solely responsible for assessing student performance. All appeals about grades in a course and for individual assignments must be made to the instructor. Students must send their appeals for revision or correction of errors, if any, to the instructor within the grade clarification period stipulated by the Programme Office.

8.3.5 Appeal

Notwithstanding the above, students may approach the mentor for advice if they think grades awarded indicate bias or failure to account for all information. The mentor may, after due consideration, report the matter to the Programme Coordinator/s if deemed serious. The Academic Affairs Committee, on reference by the PCs may review the case. The decision of the AAC after discussion with the instructor will be final.

8.3.6 Deadlines

Course Instructors will announce deadlines for submission of assignments at appropriate times during the semester. See also Sec. 8.4 (b). Students must complete and submit all assessment tasks before the assessment week ends.

8.3.7 Extension of deadlines

Even as there are permitted relaxations for participation requirements if the student has leave of absence or has been certified unwell, instructors are not obliged to conduct any make-up assessments or grant extensions for submissions. However, the instructor may, after evaluating the student's request, extend the deadline for submission of assignment by individual students by up to 48 hours.

8.3.8 Penalty for delayed or missed submission

Repeated application for extension of deadlines is discouraged. Students who fail to submit an assignment will receive a U for that assignment. A student who does not submit gradable work in a course worth at least 65% of the total assessment weight will receive a U in the course subject to the FoSQ. Instructors may also specify certain assignments or groups of assignments to be compulsory. Failure to submit or complete compulsory assignments or absence without leave during those assignments will also entail a U grade in the course.

8.3.9 Grade Point Average

The Programme Office will calculate the Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA) and Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) from the grades obtained by students in all courses that carry credit. Students must obtain a CGPA of at least 4.0 at the end of the programme to graduate successfully.

8.4 Reassessment or repetition of courses on account of U Grades

1. **Courses with reassessment:** In the undergraduate programme, reassessment (subject to the eligibility criteria specified later in this section) will be applicable ONLY to all first-year courses, including courses in the major and common curriculum courses. All students taking first-year courses (as defined here), even if they are seniors, will be allowed reassessment. Among first year courses, supporting courses in the Summer/Winter Term, CRX courses and non-major-flexible courses (like Spoken Kannada) will not have reassessment. No reassessment will be available for courses beyond the first year.
2. **Timeline and procedure for reassessment:** Reassessment will be conducted each year only in the period between July end and the beginning of August, before the start of classes for eligible students. Students will be provided with some form of support before

reassessment - this may be reading material, online support, in-person workshop depending on the course. The schedule and structure for reassessment will be announced by the Programme Office in consultation with the school.

3. **Reassessment grading guidelines:** Reassessment grading criteria will be an S/U system. A student who successfully completes reassessment tasks will be awarded an 'S' and the previous U obtained in the course for which reassessment was successfully completed will not appear in the transcript. Students will not be permitted to repeat the course in a subsequent semester to improve their grades and CGPA. A student who receives a U in a core or required course following reassessment must repeat the course when offered next. Only the final grade on comprehensive reassessment will appear in the transcript issued at the end of the semester when the reassessment is done.
4. **Repeating first-year courses offered in the Summer Term:** If a first-year course (Introduction to Economics 1, for example) is offered in the summer again, the student (who has failed this course earlier) can choose to take the course, in which case, they can obtain a letter grade, but their previous U remains. Some students may not take the course (or just audit it), in which case they can straightaway appear for the reassessment and be graded with an S/U criterion.
5. **Reassessment eligibility:** Students in the following categories are not eligible for reassessment as described above, unless specific exceptions are approved under extenuating circumstances. These students will be required to repeat the course when offered next.
 - (i) Students who do not meet attendance requirements (see 8.1.3 above)
 - (ii) Students awarded a U due to violations of academic integrity (see 8.6.2 below)
 - (iii) Students who do not complete and submit assessment tasks that total at least 65% of the assessment weightage in a course (see 8.3.8 above)
6. **Special considerations in courses eligible for reassessment:** If the first-year course in which a U is awarded has a significant laboratory/practical component, the instructor can designate one of the reassessment tasks as a practical examination. If a student receives a U in a field-based project, no reassessment will be conducted. The project will have to be repeated in full.
7. **Possible outcomes following unsuccessful reassessment:** If the final grade, in the case of first-year courses, is a 'U' again (after the reassessment process specified in this section), the following outcomes will apply:
 - (i) Only the grade U received again in the course will appear on the transcript issued for the relevant semester and will be used in calculating the GPA.
 - (ii) In cases where students need to repeat a core course, if the course is no longer in the list of courses offered in the programme, the programme office may offer an alternative, on recommendation from the programme coordinator.

The Programme encourages discussion, dialogue and cooperative learning among students. The Faculty believe that such cooperative learning is important for the enhanced academic performance of individual students and for raising the performance of the whole class or cohort. However, such cooperation should be within the norms of academic integrity and should not extend to preparation of assignments and reports, unless such cooperation is required as in the case of group assignments.

8.6 Academic Integrity

8.6.1 Importance of academic integrity

The University expects unwavering integrity from the students in their academic work. This is important on two counts. Academic integrity is a central value intrinsically important to any learning process founded on trust and cooperation between the learner and teachers. Secondly, the efficacy and effectiveness of any assessment for learning is crucially dependent on the student's willingness to adhere to norms that ensure that the students are indeed presenting evidence and opportunity for the instructor to assess their work and provide feedback.

There are many ways in which academic honesty may be violated. The Regulations do not purport to identify and detail all such cases and the likely responses to them. However, this section lays down the norms and rules that apply to specific examples of violations that would clearly entail consequences or specific punitive measures. Examples of violations of academic integrity include but are not limited to:

- a. Cheating and/or malpractice in academic activity
- b. Misrepresentation or fabrication of information or evidence
- c. Participation in or facilitation of dishonest or detrimental practices with or without benefit to oneself
- d. Plagiarism
- e. Misuse of AI tools in assignments

The norms of the University laid down in the latest version of the FOSQ will apply. If detected, the University will apply penalties and also adopt any other steps required. In cases where specific penalties are not listed in this document, the School Head and the Registrar may impose appropriate penalties after an enquiry by the Academic Affairs Committee of the School.

8.6.2 Violations

Violations of academic integrity, including but not restricted to the instances mentioned above, will invite punitive action. The judgment that such violations have happened will be, in the first instance, made by the course instructor based on available evidence. If the instructor believes that a student has violated the norms, he or she may impose penalties, depending on the severity and frequency of violations, ranging from

- (a) Warnings for first violations
- (b) Withholding or cancelling grading of specific assignments leading to loss of grades/marks, for first violations
- (c) Allotting a U for the entire course, in the case of repeated or severe violations

8.6.3 Process

1. In the case of a violation, the instructor will inform the student by email and report the violation to the AAC with the recommended penalty, also via email.
2. The student will have the chance to appeal, and must do so via email to the AAC within 5 working days of receiving the penalty. In the case of a first violation, if there is no appeal then the penalty recommended by the instructor will stand. If it is not the first violation, the AAC is empowered to recommend further penalties and will take the final decision.
3. In the case of an appeal, the AAC will determine the facts, examine the case, and talk to the student/s if needed and compile a report. The AAC, in consultation with the PCs will consider all these facts of the case including committee findings and take the final decision. The AAC will then communicate the decision to the student, cc, PCs, PO, as well as the instructor.
4. The student can make a second appeal to the Director. The Director, if a second appeal is received, will discuss it with the Registrar and take the final decision on the appeal.

8.6.4 Repeated violations

The AAC will keep a record of all past violations and if a student has been reported for frequent violations in more than one course over one or more semesters then this will attract stricter penalties as mentioned in the latest version of the FOSQ.

8.7 Expectations of conduct in academic settings

Students are expected to abide by the regulations and guidelines that govern campus and residential life, the latest version of which will be published by the Student Affairs Committee.

8.7.1 Dress

The University does not have a formal dress code for students. However, students are required to be adequately dressed in clothing devoid of offensive symbols and messages and be respectful of others' sensibilities while in public spaces in the University, including classrooms. Faculty or other responsible officials may require students to change their attire if in their judgement the students are inadequately or inappropriately dressed. Instructors may prescribe specific clothing for occasions or activities such as Creative Expressions, Laboratory work, Field visits or Sports.

8.7.2 Speech

All communication in the University, including all academic settings, is expected to be respectful of others, and their points of view and conducted with civility. Students are not permitted to use language, imagery, manner of speech or gestures in any interaction that are intended to offend,

intimidate or to inappropriately target specific groups or individuals explicitly or indirectly. Students are encouraged to be respectful while communicating with, and in particular, emailing instructors and other University members.

8.7.3 Respect for classroom processes

Students are required to interact with instructors, facilitators, and fellow students courteously and with civility. Instructors are responsible for and have the authority to guide classroom interactions, to set expectations and call out situations that need correction. Rudeness, disruptive behaviour, intemperate language, or refusal to comply with reasonable instructions will result in disciplinary action.

8.7.4 Use of gadgets and other instrumental aids

Instructors may stipulate or prohibit the use of personal computers, calculators or other aids in the classroom.

8.7.5 Use of phones

Use of mobile phones in the classroom is prohibited unless the instructor specifically permits or requires such use. Mobile phones should be kept silent and stowed away in the students' bags while in class.

9.0 Guidelines for course or project related field work and travel

9.1 Field work

Students should keep in mind that fieldwork that is part of the academic programme may require them to visit public places, communities and other organizations in many parts of the country. Behaviour and conduct while on fieldwork will be subject to the same academic regulations and rules of residence while at the University. Violations of integrity, propriety, norms governing bullying and harassment and sexual activity while on fieldwork will invite punitive action under Academic Regulations, PoSH or Rules of Residence. Fieldwork undertaken as a part of required components of the programme like Understanding India or the Occupational Minor may have additional guidelines, which will be shared by the Programme Office/Course coordinators.

9.2 Institutional Review Board approval

A student undertaking fieldwork as part of their Honours/Independent Study needs to fill out the IRB application form available with the Honours mentor and submit it to the mentor for approval. Faculty mentors will further process applications as per the guidelines circulated by the School IRB committee.

9.3 Travel

Any within-city travel done as part of a course or fieldwork for a project should only use public transport. Exceptions will be made on a case-by-case basis.

10.0 Scholarships

Scholarships are awarded to undergraduate students only for a duration of four years. Any extension or provision of scholarship for a longer period will require review and is entirely at the discretion of the University. Continued scholarship support to students requires maintenance of academic performance, and adherence to standards of integrity and probity. The following outcomes may jeopardise scholarship support in addition to other measures.

- a. Failure to maintain a CGPA of 4.0.
- b. Repeated inability to fulfil registration criteria (see Sec. 4)
- c. Any disciplinary action due to violations of residential rules or rules of academic conduct.
- d. Any disciplinary action due to being guilty of hate speech, bullying, or harassment.

11.0 Miscellaneous

11.1 Clarifications

Where rules are not explicitly stated in these Regulations the Director may take decisions in consultation with the Registrar's Office, consistent with the University's policies.

11.2 Records

All records pertaining to academic activity, timetables, violations of rules and norms will be maintained by the Programme Office.

AZIM PREMJI UNIVERSITY
FRAMEWORK OF STANDARDS FOR QUALIFICATIONS
VERSION 9.2

VERSION HISTORY

VERSION NO	DATE	CHANGE	REMARKS
VER 1.0	July 29, 2011	First Version	Academic Council Meeting, Jul 2011
VER 2.0	June 26, 2012	Section VII – Assessment and Grading revised	Academic Council Meeting, June 26, 2012, Annexure 1
VER 3.0	Dec 17, 2012	Section IX – Guidelines and procedures on plagiarism added	Academic Council Meeting, Dec 17, 2012, Annexure A
VER 4.0	Dec 24, 2013	Section I to Section IV – revised: Definition of credit, credits required for Master's.	Academic Council Meeting, Jan 3, 2014
VER 5.0	July 31, 2015	Various Sections	Academic Council Meeting, Jun 24, 2015
VER 5.1	July 5, 2016	Section 2, Section 6.8.5, 6.8.2, Section 7	Academic Council Meeting, July 5, 2016
VER 5.2	January 5, 2017	Section 2.5.2, 2.6, 6.8.2 (e) Section 7 – Academic norms	Academic Council Meeting, July 2017
VER 6.0	June 2018	Added sections for Integrated B.Sc.B.Ed and M.Ed. Programs Changes to sections on plagiarism General language changes to other sections for clarity	Academic Council Meeting, June 14, 2018
VER 7.0	August 2020	Changes to Sections 6.8 and 6.9 pertaining to continuation and graduation Minor changes in text to improve readability – various sections	
VER 8.0	September 2022	Changes across document to include diploma programmes Included section 5.3 on Academic accommodation Changes to Section 6.6 on grading systems	Academic Council Meeting, Dec 2022
VER 9.0	September 2023	Changes to the document to align with NEP FY UG requirements	Academic Council Meeting, November 2023
VER 9.1	June 2024	Minor changes to Sections 2.5.3, 3.2.5, 6.5, 6.6, 6.8.2, 6.9.1, 7.5 to improve the process of academic administration Minor changes in text to improve readability – various sections	Academic Council Meeting June 2024

VER 9.2	June 2025	Major changes to Sections 2.6.2, 6.8.2, to improve the process of academic administration Minor changes in Section 2.12, 2.5.2, 2.5.3, 2.7, 2.8, 6.4, 5.3, to improve the process of academic administration and changes in text to improve readability.	Academic Council Meeting June 2025
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1.0 Introduction

Azim Premji University's programmes of study are informed by the urgent need to educate students, in the broadest sense of the term, to be reflective and skilled learners and practitioners, animated by the knowledge and values that encourage life-long learning and an ethic of social responsibility. This requires the University to provide learning experiences that are responsive both to the lives and concerns of students and to the vision of justice and equity that the University contributes to. All programmes of the University including undergraduate, post-graduate, doctoral and continuing education will be informed by this vision.

This mandate requires that we define standards that help the formulation of policies and processes that enable the achievement of relevant goals in all academic areas of interest to us – programme and curriculum design, pedagogy, assessment and grading and care and support. **This Framework of Standards lays down the norms for all activities connected with the above and will be applicable to all programmes of study in the University that lead to qualifications. In addition, the FOSQ indicates the criteria for award of credit even though no final qualification may be involved.**

1.1 Objectives of the Framework

- i. Set standards and guidelines for creation of programmes that lead to award of qualifications
- ii. Specify the academic policies to direct and guide programmes with a focus on the quality of student attainment
- iii. Specify the nature and features of learning, pedagogic practice, assessment and support for students to facilitate the preparation of the curricula, and the courses that comprise them and actualise the goals of the programme
- iv. Outline the processes and indicate the standards for review and revision of programmes, curricula and courses at appropriate frequency

1.2 Scope

This framework (FOSQ) will outline policies and processes for:

- i. Programme, Curriculum and course design and related matters
- ii. Academic practices applicable to all programmes
- iii. Learning, pedagogy and assessment

1.3 About the document

The Framework of Standards for Qualifications (FOSQ) is the University's core document on academic policy and practices and will be approved by the Academic Council on recommendation by the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee.

2.0 Academic Framework

2.1 Educational vision

Azim Premji University's educational programmes aim to prepare graduates with great competence, integrity, and social commitment. These qualities are the necessary foundation for flourishing and a life of informed and ethical action. The above mission obviously requires us to respond to the question, "What is good Education?"

It is well established that Education is an important contributor to livelihood and economic opportunity. However, it also has a larger and equally important role in human development and flourishing. There is no trade-off between these two aspects. Good education must attend to both. This is central to the University's educational philosophy.

Understanding and action

Students in the University will be helped to achieve the capacity for understanding and action appropriate to their potential. The programmes of study in the University will therefore focus on building knowledge, critical reflection, values, and skills that underpin such capacity. It is in questioning established understandings and developing new perspectives based on rigorous research and dialogue that this intent is brought to fruition. It is recognised that academic freedom and integrity are indispensable for this. Faculty and students will be part of a community that actualises this vision in the light of the University's values and goals.

A social purpose

The Constitution emphasises the dream of building a nation and society founded on principles of justice and equity. The University will strive to develop a deep understanding of the role of education in constituting human development and realizing this vision of Indian society. This will be reflected in the design of the University's curricula, practices, and research priorities.

The learning individual

The third and equally central concern of the University's educational vision is with the learning individual. One of the key preoccupations of education is with its impact on attitudes, values, and the capacity for self-understanding. This is a product not of intellectual learning alone. It is a result also of the development of sensibilities that enhance and support the individual's ability to discover well-being and to contribute to society. An environment that values learning in this manner must actively promote an ethic of care that reaches beyond the academic curriculum.

2.2 Definitions

Qualification – is certified academic accomplishment made by the university under applicable rules after successful completion of programmes of study (see 2 below) that meet the university's academic requirements. The university may award qualifications as

approved by current regulations and as detailed elsewhere in this document and may include degrees, diplomas, and certificates.

1. Programmes – programmes of study, in the context of the FOSQ involve teaching and learning academic material designed and approved by the university, with the express purpose of meeting the requirements of certification. By their nature programmes are intended to be designed towards a coherent set of goals and learning outcomes. In general programmes will comprise courses organised into a curriculum.
2. Curriculum – a curriculum is an overall academic plan that specifies the objectives, structure, constituent elements and processes of teaching and assessment involved in organising and completing a programme of study.
3. Courses – A course involves teaching, learning and appropriate assessment and grading, designed around a set of connected activities and content expected to achieve specified learning objectives and is an important constituent of the curriculum. It is the smallest unit of study for which academic credit can be obtained. Courses used in programmes that lead to qualifications must be designed for at least 2 credits.
4. Units – or academic units are elements of courses that comprise its syllabus for study and will specify the themes and teaching and learning material that the instructor will use to constitute the course. Completion of a unit will not result in award or accumulation of credit.

2.3 Programme selection

Successful completion of programmes of study in the University will result in qualifications such as degrees, diplomas, and certificates. A programme of study provides systematic opportunities to students to learn and be introduced to fields of knowledge and practice. The choice of programmes to be offered and the qualifications they lead to are not purely an academic but also an institutional choice. This is understandable as the University may have a much larger number of possible programmes from which a more desirable and feasible sub-set has to be chosen. Thus, programmes may be offered by any of the Schools in the University, or other authorised academic units taking into consideration factors relating to the University's strategic vision, strengths, and opportunities.

The programme of study, once identified and specified, involves a process of teaching and learning that is informed by certain forms of educational thought and aims, organised in a curriculum. It is important to reflect on and articulate these concerns during the process of programme design, whatever be the particular area of study that is intended. That is to say, every programme of study be it in Physics, Education or Development must identify and specify a rationale for offering the programme, appropriate educational concerns, and the profile of student that it is intended for and must result in the design of a curriculum that specifies and organises practices of instruction and learning. The relevant concerns and questions here may include:

- The University's educational vision and the social concerns that inform it
- The rationale and goals for the programme of study that reflect this vision. This may include the specification of the need that prompts the choice of programme, the number and profile of students that may join, the prior capabilities and background of students who may join the programme of study and finally, the broad capabilities that the students may acquire through the study.

- The sources, nature and scope of the knowledge and understanding available in the field of study and the normative issues within which the production and adoption of such knowledge takes place.
- The manner in which such knowledge can be made accessible to students. In other words, the links between the above choices and the curriculum and the learning experiences that it mediates.
- A framework that specifies a set of approaches, themes and elements that may be relevant to translate the above concerns into the details of the curriculum and the pedagogic processes related to it.

It should be evident from the above that the specification of the programme leads to and informs the curriculum without uniquely determining its content or the pedagogic practices adopted. The view taken here is that more than one approach or perspective is potentially available to choose from in arriving at a curriculum. However, the faculty and curriculum designers have to examine and reflect on the range of approaches available and then make informed choices. Such an exercise is inevitably a process that requires careful dialogue and sometimes difficult trade-offs.

2.4 Programme Development

Once a programme of study is identified, the development and specification of programme will go through at least the following steps and processes.

- a) Preparation of a “Programme Document” that specifies the features of the programme including (i) its rationale – the statement of reasons that lead to the launch of the particular programme (ii) the description of the qualification that the programme leads to and the profile of students that the programme is oriented towards and (iii) the curriculum, which includes elements indicated in more detail in Section 3.1 below. The University will specify permitted durations (minimum and maximum) and permitted exit points for every programme of study.
- b) The programme of study, as an overall experience, is structured by the curriculum and the resultant processes of teaching and learning. The curriculum helps the student integrate learning that happens in various ways and contexts and is therefore more than the sum of its parts. This requires a high degree of coordination and dialogue between faculty members in designing courses that integrate well, specifying the range of pedagogic practice that is relevant and also in helping students navigate the study effectively.
- c) Design of courses as described in Section 3. The term course is intended to be used generally, including practical and field-based work and not limited to academic or taught units alone. Students may receive and accumulate academic credit through successfully completing courses. However, the University will award qualifications only if the accumulated credits meet the requirements of a programme, as explained below.

2.5 Classification of Programmes

2.5.1 Mode and Level

The segmentation of the University’s programmes of study has two dimensions: **Mode and Level**. **Mode** refers to the kind of engagement the students have with the programme. There could be

three different modes of engagement:

- M1. Regular mode, full-time study. Full-time study is expected to involve 40 hours of study (“study” is defined in the next section) in a week under normal circumstances. Students are not expected to be registered for other programmes or be otherwise employed while registered for a programme in this mode. The courses in this mode may also use internet, software applications and other communication technologies to assist learning.
- M2. Regular mode, part-time study. This is intended for students who are unable to live in the location of the University but travel at designated occasions for contact classes. Such students may include those who may be employed during the programme of study. The courses in this mode may also use internet, software applications and other communication technologies to assist learning. The programmes will meet requirements stipulated by the Academic Council.
- M3. Distance mode, where the student is not expected to attend the programme full-time and can fully participate from remote locations. In addition, the mode of instruction could use alternative technologies to deliver materials and mediate interaction.

The second dimension of qualifications is **Level**. Level refers to the location of the qualification in the academic progression route and the sophistication of content and expected outcomes.

The National Higher Education Qualifications Framework (NHEQF) levels represent a series of sequential stages expressed in terms of a range of learning outcomes against which typical qualifications are positioned/located. NHEQF level 4.5 represents learning outcomes appropriate to the first year (first two semesters) of the undergraduate programme of study, while Level 8 represents learning outcomes appropriate to a doctoral degree.

Course levels: This document uses the notion of Level also to describe the academic sophistication and demand of particular courses. This use of the term is described in Section 3.2.2.

2.5.2 Classification of programmes

The classification of programs below is based on the levels defined in the NHEQF. The certificate courses that the University offers are pitched at NHEQF Level 4.5 or above.

QUALIFICATIONS	NHEQF Level
Undergraduate Certificate. Programme duration: First year (first two semesters) of the undergraduate programme, followed by an exit 4-credit skills-enhancement course(s).	4.5
Undergraduate Diploma. Programme duration: First two years (first four semesters) of the undergraduate programme, followed by an exit 4-credit skills enhancement course(s) lasting two months.	5
Bachelor’s Degree. Programme duration: First three years (Six semesters) of the four-year undergraduate programme.	5.5

Bachelor's Degree (Honours/ Honours with Research). Programme duration: Four years (eight semesters).	6
Post-Graduate Diploma. Programme duration: One year (two semesters) for those who exit after successful completion of the first year (two semesters) of the 2-year master's programme.	6
Master's degree. (e.g. M.A., M.Com., M.Sc., etc.) Programme duration: Two years (four semesters) after obtaining a 3- year Bachelor's degree (e.g. B.A., B.Sc., B.Com. etc.).	6.5
Master's degree. (e.g. M.A., M.Com., M.Sc., etc.) Programme duration: One year (two semesters) after obtaining a 4 -year Bachelor's degree (Honours/ Honours with Research) (e.g. B.A., B.Sc., B.Com. etc.).	6.5
Master's degree.(e.g. M.E./M.Tech. etc.) Programme duration: Two years (four semesters) after obtaining a 4-year Bachelor's degree. (e.g. B.E./B.Tech. etc.)	7
Doctoral Degree	8

2.5.3 Categories of qualification

All academic certification and qualifications awarded by the university will conform to the following categories.

- (i) Certificate Programmes for working professionals: These are intended to be short-cycle programmes of study of less than a year's duration that comprise at least two courses that lead to award of total of four to ten credits. Certificate programmes are generally intended for focused study of thematic areas that involve conceptual and practical competencies. These programmes can be at introductory, intermediate or advanced levels and can be offered in any of the modes listed under section 2.5.1.
- (ii) Diploma for working professionals: A diploma is a qualification awarded on completion of a programme of study that may vary in length from six months to eighteen months. These programmes can be in any of the modes listed under section 2.5.1 and may comprise courses that lead to a total of not less than 12 credits and not greater than 48 credits. Diplomas are qualifications that indicate more comprehensive introduction to or advancement in specific fields of skills and knowledge than certificate programmes. The university may permit the design of diplomas by combining multiple certificate programmes.
- (iii) Degree: A degree is a comprehensive qualification that serves to certify accomplishment after completion of study. Awards of degrees is required to comply with norms specified under law and is subject to regulation by bodies such as the University Grants Commission.
 - a. Three-year UG degree programme
 - b. Four Year UG Honours programme
 - c. Two Year PG programme
 - d. One Year PG programme
- (iv) Transcripts of credit – this is not a complete qualification but will certify award of credits at various levels that can be used for meeting credit requirements for qualifications. Any credit awarded can be used only once towards a qualification, unless specifically permitted. Since credits may be accumulated from courses at any level, transcripts of credits may be used to build qualifications or programmes of study at any level mentioned in the table under section 2.5.2.

2.5.4 List of approved programmes

The university will publish the list of programmes that have been approved under these rules and are offered for enrolment and study in every academic year. In addition, details of eligibility to be admitted to each programme and the criteria for successful graduation will also be published.

2.6 Master's Degree Programmes

2.6.1 Two-year Master's Programmes

The University will select and admit eligible applicants to its Master's programmes of Level 6.5 that require them to complete their study, obtaining a minimum of 80 (eighty) credits and a maximum of 88 (eighty-eight) credits, through full time study in Mode M1 and in not less than four and not more than six enrolled semesters. The student must meet the requirements of the degree in a maximum of three academic years beginning from the year of first registration.

Students will normally be permitted to register for and obtain up to 20 (Twenty) credits from taught courses in a semester excluding field-related courses and projects. Students who wish to register for additional courses and obtain the credits must apply to the respective Programme Coordinators for permission.

Specializations: The Master's curriculum may allow students to specialize in particular areas of focus relevant to the core themes of the programme. All specializations should be developed by authorised faculty groups and must follow approved guidelines. All specialisations within programmes leading to Master's degrees must require the student to obtain credits from a list of courses approved for inclusion in the specialisation. The specialisation may require the student to choose one or more courses compulsorily from those listed to meet the requirements. In addition, some specializations may require that the students engage with specified field work. Apart from this, the specialisations should not require that students focus on other courses such as independent study on the themes of the specialization.

Programmes may organise and offer courses in groups created according to specific criteria. However, such options will not be certified as formal specialisation or by any other name in the transcripts. There may be courses that are taught completely in a workshop mode.

Students will be permitted, on application to the University to extend their duration of study for accruing further credits. However, these credits will not result in any additional qualification. These additional credits will reflect in the transcript.

2.6.2 One- year Master's Programmes

The University will offer one-year master's programmes at Level 6.5 to eligible applicants who meet the academic and professional criteria as defined in UGC regulations. These programmes are designed for mid-career professionals and graduates with relevant academic backgrounds and work experience, and are structured to be intensive, interdisciplinary, and application focused.

Eligible applicants must have either:

- A four-year undergraduate degree (Honours/Research), or
- A master's degree in any discipline

Students will be required to complete a minimum of 40 credits through full-time study in Mode M1 (on-campus) over a period of not less than two semesters, or four terms. The student must meet the academic requirements of the degree within a maximum of two academic years from the date of initial registration.

The programme structure may include a mix of:

- Core courses, covering foundational and thematic areas,
- Electives, offering domain-specific or skills-based learning,
- Internships and projects, designed to integrate learning with field application.

The curriculum may also allow students to pursue areas of focus or thematic groupings of electives, though these will not be formally recognized as specialisations on the degree or transcript. Such course groupings must be designed and offered by authorized faculty teams and should follow established academic guidelines.

The programme may include practice-based courses where appropriate, and students may also be encouraged to participate in field-based or applied learning modules as part of their capstone requirement.

2.7 Undergraduate Programmes

The University will admit students who have completed a recognised twelfth standard qualification from India or abroad to an undergraduate degree programme in Mode M1 and of NHEQF Level 4.5. University's undergraduate four-year multidisciplinary programme is aligned to the National Education Policy, 2020 (NEP). While the base programme offered is the 4-year honours programme, the programme design will allow for flexibility and provide multiple exit and entry options with 1-year certificate, 2-year diploma, 3-year degree and a 4-year honours programme.

Entry Criteria and Exit Criteria

Programme	Entry Criteria	Exit Criteria	Credits
Undergraduate Certificate (NHEQF Level 4.5)	Certificate obtained after successful completion of Grade 12 or equivalent state of education.	The successful completion of the first year (two semesters) of the undergraduate programme	40
Undergraduate Diploma (NHEQF Level 5)	Continuation of study or lateral entry in the second year of the undergraduate programme will be possible for those who have met the entrance requirements, including specified levels of attainment, specified in the programme regulations.	The successful completion of the first two years (four semesters) of the undergraduate programme	80
Bachelor's Degree (NHEQF Level 5.5)	Continuation of study or lateral entry into the third year of the undergraduate programme will be possible for those who have met the specified levels of attainment, specified in the programme admission regulations.	The successful completion of the first three years (six semesters) of the undergraduate programme	120
The Bachelor's degree (Honours/ Honours with Research) (NHEQF Level 6)	Should have completed all requirements of the relevant 3- year Bachelor's degree. Continuation of undergraduate programme leading to the bachelor's degree (Honours/ Honours with Research) will be open to those who have met the entrance requirements, including specified levels of attainment, in the programme admission regulations.	Successful completion of the 4- year (eight semesters) undergraduate programme involving a minimum of 160 credits, with a minimum of 40 credits each at level 4.5, 5, 5.5, and 6 of the NHEQF.	160

Students will be permitted, on application to the University to extend their duration of study for accruing further credits. However, these credits will not result in any additional qualification.

Students can apply for a change of programme only before the beginning of the second year (third semester). The Academic Regulations document will detail the criteria and process of selection to the new programme

2.7.1 Four Year Undergraduate Programmes Teacher Education Programme

The University will admit students who have completed a recognized twelfth standard qualification from India or abroad to a four-year undergraduate degree programme in Mode M1 leading to dual degrees in the Sciences (Bachelor of Science) and in Education (Bachelor of Education). Students who successfully complete the requirements of the programme will be awarded the degree of B.Sc., B.Ed on obtaining 180 credits with at least eight semesters of full-time study and a maximum of ten semesters. The programme should be completed in a maximum of five academic years from the year of first registration.

2.8 Diploma Programmes and Certificate Programmes for working professionals

The University's professional diploma and certificate programmes are meant for practicing professionals in areas directly relevant to their field of work. These programmes are part-time programmes offered in 'Blended mode' with a blend of online work and in-person classroom mode.

Since these programmes require considerable flexibility in the curriculum, structure, attendance norms, assessment and grading, exceptions have been made to the standard rules (followed for full-time programmes) and are specified in the respective sections of this document.

2.9 Review of programmes and curricula

Periodic review and evaluation of programmes and their components is an important part of ensuring their effectiveness. A programme of study or a qualification, conceived in the above manner is likely to have features and design that have a longer "life cycle" than the details of the curriculum or courses that implement that programme. It may require review and, if necessary, revision at least once every five academic years. Programmes may get reviewed and revised within five years to align with any revision to the Government policy and guidelines. Programme review is a comprehensive exercise that includes a review of the experience of the University in conducting it, a review of faculty needs and availability, review of the characteristics of the students entering the programme, the performance of the students in the programme, an examination of the occupational choices made by successful graduates, and feedback from students, faculty and employers.

A curriculum may be more dynamic. Some elements of the curriculum such as the content of the courses, reading lists and patterns of assessment may undergo changes every semester. Other features, such as the mix of courses that comprise the curriculum may change less frequently. In any event a curriculum may be reviewed comprehensively at least once every three academic years.

A programme review may begin after the norms and guidelines for the review and the structure of the review committee are approved by the Vice Chancellor. The outcome of the review will be

presented to the Academic Council and the Council will accord approval to the revised document.

2.10 Medium of Instruction

The medium of instruction and assessment in all the programmes will be English, unless otherwise specified. The university may launch and offer programmes in other Indian languages and in bilingual modes in consonance with its future strategy.

2.11 Break in Study

Students may apply to take a break in study without being registered on the programme, of not more than two semesters. The break may be permitted either due to reasons of ill health or for any other reasons of emergency. A student who re-joins the programme after a break will have to satisfy the regulations and guidelines prevalent at the time of re-registration. Permission is not automatic and will require application to the University which will consider each case on merits.

Extension to the maximum time allowed for completion of the programme may be done for medical reasons and in other personal emergencies. Extension if granted should be approved by the Registrar and the respective School Director.

2.12 Transfer of credits

Credits awarded by the university are in consonance with the definition of credit as specified by the regulatory body and where appropriate the university may certify accumulation of credits by issuing transcripts of credit that may be used by other institutions to recognise academic achievement. The University may allow transfer of credits from other institutions to be recognised as part of the credit requirements for qualifications here, subject to certain conditions.

3.0 Curriculum design and course specification

3.1 Curriculum review

Curriculum Review may also be part of a programme review, or a review initiated as indicated in section 3.4. In general, curriculum review can be proposed by the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee (CPC), or the School responsible for the programme. The CPC, after taking into account the feedback mentioned above, may approve a process of review and also specify the guidelines for the same. The guidelines may specify, for example,

- a) The composition of the review group and its coordinator
- b) A brief for the review to be considered by the review group
- c) A timeline and schedule for review

The review group will be expected to keep a record of the discussions in the review process. At the end of the review process the School responsible for the programme should present a draft curriculum document to the CPC with the following sections.

- Rationale and objectives
- A description of the manner in which the design of the curriculum follows from the goals of the programme
- The credit and course structure within the curriculum including the distribution of core and elective courses
- Description of other elements such as fieldwork and special units, if any (e.g. courses of independent study, if included)
- A discussion of the pedagogic and student support issues that may be relevant or specific to the particular curriculum
- The detailed course list and specification of courses

The CPC will review the draft curriculum document and suggest revisions or modifications. The draft curriculum should also be circulated to all faculty and comments invited. The final draft of the curriculum document will be presented by the CPC to the Academic Council for approval.

The review process and outcomes may be recorded in online systems or in documents.

3.2 Courses, course design and teaching

3.2.1 Definition

A course involves teaching, learning and appropriate assessment and grading, designed around a set of connected activities and content expected to achieve specified learning objectives. It is the smallest unit of study for which academic credit can be obtained (see Section 4).

Most *courses* in the University are designed as parts of a collection of courses and other learning experiences within a *curriculum* to constitute a *programme* of study. A course, therefore, is not just a convenient selection of content from a subject or field organized appropriately; its design and syllabus will also reflect the goals of the programme. While it is thus true that most courses may be part of larger programmes, the University may also offer courses as stand-alone units of study as workshops, professional development courses and so on.

3.2.2 Course Levels

While courses may be, in theory, offered as single modules, most courses will be associated with at least one curriculum. Every course will be identified by a name and an alpha-numeric descriptor. In addition, the University's courses may be classified and identified by an identifier that signifies the academic level that the course represents, with an increasing degree of academic difficulty or expectations. It is expected that multi-semester programmes may comprise courses of varying levels with increasing academic complexity and achievement. There will be FIVE such levels from 1 to 5, associated with the programmes as below:

- 1, 2, 3 & 4 - courses at these levels will be offered in short cycle programmes such as diplomas
- 1, 2 & 3 – these courses may be offered in Undergraduate programmes

- 1, 2, 3 & 4 – these courses may be part of post-graduate programmes – e.g. Master’s level degrees or post-graduate diplomas
- 3, 4 & 5 – will be part of coursework for doctoral programmes

3.2.3 Course Design

A course is designed by one or more members of the faculty; and when it is part of a qualification or where credit accrues, it is reviewed and approved as specified in this document. The design and teaching of a course involves the integration of a syllabus organized into units of study and appropriate pedagogy, both supporting a set of learning objectives. The University’s detailed guidelines for course design are stated in the document “Course_Design_by_Objectives”. The guidelines stipulate that close attention be paid to intended learning outcomes, and the use of these ILOs to choose content and the way assessment tasks are identified and the rubrics for use in grading are designed. Learning in this view is a continuous process that does not end in the classroom or with a particular course. Courses may initiate learning about a specific domain, but if understanding and the capacity for self-directed learning are key goals, then the quantum of content covered is rarely the most critical issue in course design. In addition, CBO is more likely to result in more egalitarian outcomes, especially when the classroom has a significant number of disadvantaged students.

3.2.4 Process of course design

1. Proposal – by a curriculum design team or a member of faculty who specify the relevance of the course within the curriculum of a particular programme; or a member of faculty may propose the creation of a course based on interest or experience. The School or its Programme Committee will review the proposal and authorise course development.
2. Specification – a faculty member or a small group of faculties may develop the course specification, based on the proposal.
3. Review – every course specification must be reviewed through a process approved by the academic council.
4. Courses that fall into the category of open courses/creative expressions/ online courses designed and offered by external agencies will be considered and approved by the respective bodies where applicable or the Registrar and School Director concerned.

3.2.5 Course specification

A course specification must include –

- a) A *header* that contains basic information such as the name of the course, the curriculum that it serves, its credit value, the names of the course designers and if applicable, the names of the instructor.
- b) A clearly stated *Introduction and Rationale* that provides the rationale for its inclusion in the curriculum and a brief description of the course.
- c) A set of *Intended Learning Outcomes* that state the changes in students’ understanding and competences, articulated in cognitive and normative terms.
- d) A set of connected ideas, concepts and skills consonant with the objectives organized into *Units of study* including readings and other resources that form the syllabus and is expected to be the focus of teaching and learning.

- e) A choice of pedagogy appropriate to the syllabus, the objectives of the course and the context of the particular class.
- f) A coherent plan for assessment consistent with the objectives that ideally is a feedback for the learning process and also serves as a basis for grading.
- g) These specifications are featured in the Curriculum Design Application which is used for course creation, review and approval.

3.2.6 Further note on course design

It is extremely important that faculty members designing courses pay particular attention to ensuring that there is a balance achieved between instruction, assignments (including reading and written submissions) and the demands of evaluation. A demand on student effort at the extremes of the spectrum (excessive or too lean) is highly likely to impair the quality of student engagement. In addition, the overall demand on student effort should keep the cumulative demand from all courses the student attends at a given time in mind. Appropriate norms for this may be developed by the faculty, the programme coordinators and the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee (CPC) in consultation.

3.2.7 Guidelines for teaching

- a) A course is best designed to be taught by a single instructor responsible for teaching and assessment with pedagogic autonomy. Thus, a course is designed as much around teachability as it is around content, and an instructor is expected to have content knowledge and the pedagogical content knowledge to go with it.
- b) Co-teaching (a form of collaborative instruction) in the University is the situation of not more than two faculty members being jointly and fully responsible for the conduct of a course in its entirety. Co-teaching as a practice requires careful planning as it demands the simultaneous engagement of more than one instructor in the same classroom.
- c) Co-teaching is essentially a pedagogic practice and the justification for it must be pedagogical.
- d) Co-teaching may be used also in situations where the instructors and the School feel that the course is interdisciplinary in ways that demand the simultaneous presence and expertise of more than one instructor.
- e) Guest teaching that is session-specific is acceptable.
- f) A situation where a co-instructor is present, and the professional development of the co-instructor is facilitated by the primary instructor, is an acceptable arrangement.

4.0 Academic credit specification

4.1 Definitions

Azim Premji University will use a system of academic credits to quantify and recognise learning achievement at every level of higher education specified in this Framework.

Credit – academic credit is awarded to a student on successfully completing the study and assessment requirements of a course in a programme through any of the accepted modes.

The credit-based system of programme/course design is expected to provide the University and students with a great deal of flexibility in organizing and certifying learning. This also enables the faculty to design courses in a way that ensures consistency and uniformity of standards across qualifications at similar levels of difficulty.

A credit has been defined in this framework using the following criteria depending on the nature of the academic work that includes taught courses, laboratory work, field work, projects and independent study.

4.2 Specifications

Keeping in mind that the quantum of self-directed learning is variable between students, the formal specification of a credit under various conditions is done below in terms of hours of guided learning involved. These norms govern only formal instruction and guidance provided to student groups or class, not the support provided to students individually or through tutorials for groups of students. The definitions of academic credit in this section pertain to full time study for qualifications in mode M1.

In the case of taught courses in Mode M1

A student accrues 1 credit on completing a course of study that involves 15 hours of guided learning in an academic term of up to 15 weeks of duration. Guided Study includes classroom instruction and in-class assessment activities.

In UG programmes, a 5-credit taught course will additionally include around 30 hours of academic support sessions and /or office consultation hours over the semester.

Example: A 4-credit course may have 4 hours of classroom instruction per week over 15 weeks in a semester. In addition, the instructor may set aside up to 4 hours for in class assessment. (in-class assignments, mid-term, or end-term examinations, etc.).

4.2.1 In the case of courses based on work in the laboratory or studio

A student accrues 1 credit from laboratory/studio work on completing a course of study that involves at least 30 hours of work in the laboratory/studio over a term of up to 15 weeks of duration.

Example: It is expected that courses that have laboratory work in most programmes will have a “hybrid structure” that includes both a taught component and a laboratory work component.

A 3-credit course with a laboratory component equivalent to 1 credit may have 2 hours of classroom instruction and 2 hours of laboratory work in a week.

4.2.2 In the case of field work

A student accrues 1 credit from field work on completing a course that involves, (i) at least one week of field work involving at least five days of full-time work per week in a field setting that includes mentoring or guidance amounting to 4 hours and (ii) submission of a report or journal or other related written work that is reviewed and certified by a mentor or instructor.

1 credit of fieldwork in the B.Ed. programme will be equivalent to 8 working days in the field.

Example: A 3-credit field work course will involve (i) 3 weeks of full-time work in a field setting (excluding travel time) of at least 5 days a week including Mentoring (before, during and after field work) equivalent to 12 hours of interaction with mentors or instructors and (ii) the preparation of a written report or journal of not less than 3000 words

4.2.3 In a course of independent study

A student accrues 1 credit from independent study on completing 40 hours of study including self-study and writing of at least 36 hours duration and also mentoring and assessment by a faculty member of 4 hours over a semester.

Example: A 3-credit independent study may have the following requirements over a 15-week semester (i) A self-study component that requires 108 hours of study or research including writing of an extended essay of 6000 words or a research report (ii) Mentoring and assessment time with an instructor of 12 hours

4.2.4 Other credited work

All other forms of credited work (workshops, support, and remedial courses), and courses to be taught in a shorter duration (e.g. A two credit course taught in 8 weeks with 4 hrs. of classes per week) will be approved by the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee after review.

4.2.5 Credits awarded in programmes in Modes M2 and M3

A student enrolled in a programme of study in modes M2 or M3 will be awarded one credit on completion of guided learning of fifteen (15) hours over an academic term not shorter than four (4) weeks and not longer than fifteen (15) weeks. Guided learning in the context of programmes in mode M2 and M3 may include asynchronous audio or video recordings of instructional content specifically approved for the course by the academic council, of not more than 30% (i.e. 4.5 hours for every credit) of the total guided learning hours.

5.0 Pedagogy and student support

5.1 Pedagogy

The instructor will have the liberty to identify and use the pedagogical approach that is best suited to a particular course. However, the University expects instructors/faculty to adhere to broad guidelines that pertain to the pedagogical and curricular vision of the programme. The following sections outline some of the wider considerations pertinent to the development of specific pedagogical approaches and a view of the support and mentoring that students will receive in the University.

The programmes in the University aim to (i) promote excellence in learning appropriate to the diverse contexts that students may come from (ii) ensure that they reflect the university's social purpose and (iii) nurture students who are capable of making sensitive ethical choices; and are

socially engaged and capable of skillful action. This demands that the university identify methods and curricula that promote the development of such learners.

Such a reflective practitioner is not just capable of exercising skill of a high order but also has the sensibilities and dispositions that help him or her towards appropriate choices and actions that support personal and social well-being. These capacities for understanding and action are also constituted by an affective sensibility that is central to a moral imagination. These sensibilities are not so much a product of explicit instruction. However, the curriculum can make significant contributions to eliciting interest and curiosity in the student for exploring these issues. In addition, we expect the education at the University to be an important beginning or continuation, not the final stage, of a process of autonomous exploration of self, relationships and the world by the student.

The following points summarise the concerns of the university in developing appropriate pedagogy:

1. Faculty must ensure that classroom processes address issues of inclusion and diversity; students are likely to be from diverse cultural, linguistic, socio-economic and intellectual backgrounds. While a pedagogy that is able to completely accommodate this diversity is difficult to accomplish, awareness on the part of the faculty of the need to develop pluralistic approaches will go a long way in smoothening the students' class-room experience.
2. We must explore cooperative and peer-supported activities as part of the process of empowering students to take charge of their own learning.
3. The curricular content could be presented in ways that invite questioning and reflection, not as a body of ready knowledge to be assimilated or reproduced.
4. Therefore, the emphasis must be on active and critical engagement with current and dominant beliefs and explanations. This approach will require faculty to be facilitators of questioning and not authorities of knowledge. In addition, this brings the demand that faculty encourage students to view them as fellow travellers in an intellectual journey.
5. Pedagogy must include a plurality of approaches that have attended to questions relevant to the curriculum.
6. The classroom practices must exemplify the concern we have that our students should be able to engage each other in dialogue as responsible citizens in a constitutional democracy. In an age when public spaces for dialogue and the scope of peaceful public reasoning are, arguably, shrinking or often under threat, our students must be able to see the importance of critical dialogue and acceptance of diversity as bulwarks of democracy.

5.2 Student Support

Students differ widely in their need for support through the learning process. In addition, as outlined below, learning is not an activity radically separated from the rest of the student's life in the University. Peer social interaction, interaction with teachers, family circumstances and factors of personality and temperament do empower and constrain students in their passage through University. We believe that sensitivity on the part of faculty and the University in general to these factors can greatly enhance the students' capabilities and therefore the effectiveness of the University's programmes.

5.2.1 Academic Support

The University will explore ways of creating systems for academic support that include, in addition to classroom instruction, (i) tutorial support in small groups (ii) organizing peer support groups (iii) academic mentoring by faculty and (iv) other interventions directed at specific capabilities or skills (v) Teaching for students with different abilities

5.2.2 Other forms of support

The curriculum and the pedagogical approaches adopted should nurture independence of thinking and autonomy of exploration in the student. However, students in the University are at the cusp of a long period of responsible adult roles in society. Often, they are buffeted by uncertainties and personal challenges that necessitate support. The students' capacity for focused effort is often impaired by emotional turmoil. It then becomes necessary for the faculty to be sensitive to these needs and not consider them to be distractions from the formal process of instruction. It is important to create systems and protocols for providing this support to the greatest extent possible. This could take the form of direct engagement of the faculty with students and also the creation of parallel systems of advice, counselling and support by qualified professionals. The University will also have facilities for advice and support for entering employment or further studies.

Many young people who enter higher education often do so at a time of emotional change and turmoil. This period is also one of turbulence associated with matters of identity and intimacy for the young adult. Emotional turmoil and illness attract quite a bit of stigma and adverse labelling in our milieu. This is very unfortunate. Azim Premji University, as reiterated in its Vision, is a caring community. Developing the capacity to provide students with sensitive support through this period of maturation is an important element of such care. The University will endeavour to create facilities for advice, mentoring and support that help students understand and traverse these challenging periods successfully.

5.3 Academic Accommodation

Azim Premji University is committed to providing a teaching and learning environment suitable for learning for all students. The university provides reasonable accommodation for students with disabilities and students in severe mental health, medical or family crisis. Academic accommodation does not alter the intended learning objectives in any course. Academic accommodation refers to adjustments within the learning spaces, within and outside the classroom, availability of course content and in the assessment design. This means that academic accommodation provides some students with alternative pathways to achieve the shared learning goals of a course.

Academic accommodations will be provided in consultation with the program coordinators and faculties in the following areas:

1. Physical infrastructure and technology – modifications that allow for the physical presence, participation and engagement of students within the learning environment. Examples include classrooms which have enough room to allow for wheelchairs to move around, speakers which allow for speech to text software for hearing impaired students, video and

audio recording and field practice sites that have been chosen based on accessibility and suitability so all students can equally participate.

2. Course content – modifications that allow students to appropriately access, retain and respond to course content. Examples include getting good notes for in-class material, specialized presentation formats (visual, tactile, audio and multisensory) and alternative response modes.
3. Assessments – modifications that allow for the assessment of learning objectives for the course. Examples include deadline extensions, extended time on assessment tasks, alternative assessment formats, typing, assistive devices, separate quiet room with no distractions or noise.
4. Duration – Academic accommodation may grant extensions beyond the intended programme duration.

The details of the academic accommodation are provided in the guideline document maintained by the Office of Academic Accommodations.

6.0 Assessment and Grading

6.1 Introduction and Principles

Assessment, as used in this document, pertains to assessment of student learning, an important element of the curriculum, based on the teaching and learning that happen in a course conducted in a classroom, laboratory or field location. In the context of the curriculum, assessment is the process of appraisal, evaluation or judgment of student learning in view of the objectives set by the curriculum and the courses that comprise it. Assessment as a process cannot be separated in any meaningful way from teaching and learning, the other processes to which it is intimately connected. Assessment, defined in this manner, has been used for diverse purposes including to:

- Provide dynamic feedback to the student about her own learning.
- Allow student peer groups to evaluate their understanding of the curricular material.
- Provide 'real-time' feedback to the instructor in the classroom through student responses and allow the instructor to reflect such feedback to students.
- Allow instructors to judge summative outcomes at various points in a course or programme.
- Feed forward, through the grading process to create summary reports or measures that serve evaluative objectives of parties external to the teaching-learning process, such as employers, or other educational institutions.
- Allow preparation of comparative measures that rank order students at the end of a learning process.

6.2 Grading -Introduction

Grading, in this framework, is a subsidiary outcome of the assessment process, used as a concise statement of assessment outcomes, often in a summative mode. While grading can have important feedback value to the instructor and the student, it is in its use as a retrospective summary of learning outcomes, often to signal competence, or to feed into further summative measures such as grade point averages that grading systems have become most prominent.

In spite of the diversity of uses and assessment methods available in theory to the instructor and student, higher education systems in the country expend too much energy and resources in devising

grading and examination systems and arguably pay too little attention to the benefits of assessment as a process intrinsic to teaching learning. The policies outlined in this document recommend that Azim Premji University's assessment processes move towards formative assessment processes that contribute to learning and also help faculty provide valuable feedback to students in the learning situation.

6.3 Objectives of the University's practices of assessment

The university's assessment practices will be significantly oriented towards formative contributions to teaching and learning. They will aim to:

- a) Provide meaningful, dynamic and constructive feedback to the instructor and student about the teaching-learning process.
- b) Focus on the student's own accomplishments in learning relative to curricular goals and standards and less on comparative or competitive rank ordering.
- c) Help students and instructors build a culture of learning where students develop a sense of active partnership in the process and responsibility for their accomplishments.
- d) Contribute to a reliable and consistent system of grading that allows the University to report summary measures of student learning achievement.

6.4 Guidelines for assessment

While assessment for learning can in principle be completely separated from grading, that is prohibitive in terms of time and effort and perhaps it is too impractical to attempt such a separation. The University therefore takes a pragmatic view and, through the system envisaged in this FOSQ, provides a set of guidelines for assessment and a set of systems for grading that aim to integrate grading within broader practices of assessment. Instructors and designers of programmes and courses are urged to devise assessment processes that are always responsive to and mindful of overall objectives.

- a) It is recommended that programme documents contain a section that outlines the overall approach to assessment and grading relevant to the programme.
- b) Every component of the curriculum such as courses, field work or practicum that is assigned credit must have a defined assessment process associated with it.
- c) The document that specifies the syllabus or nature of the field work/practicum should specify the various modes of assessment to be used, and the criteria and processes within each mode. For example (the list is not exhaustive), a course might use feedback from instructors and/or the peer group related to many different kinds of work by the student –
 - (i) presentations and displays, in class or online
 - (ii) student-led entries and discussions in online learning management systems and blogs therein
 - (iii) written assignments
 - (iv) essays and term papers
 - (v) closed or open book mid- or end- of term assignments
 - (vi) portfolios and journals prepared by students.
- d) Some of the above assessment practices may be linked to the grading framework for the course.
- e) The University does not use comparative grading (norm-referenced grading systems; please refer to section 6.5). This requires instructors to prepare criteria and standards for assessment of student understanding and work.

- f) Instructors are required to prepare and announce assessment rubrics appropriate to each form of assessment, particularly when the assessment activity is linked to grading. In addition, this is all the more important when different modes of assessment are used in a course. All assessed and graded assignments must receive timely and meaningful feedback from instructors.
- g) In view of the increased possibility of (mis)use of AI in assignments, the instructors are recommended to design the assessments in a way that they are not vulnerable to misuse of AI assisted tools.
- h) Grading schemes mentioned in the approved course document may be modified by instructors. However, all such changes should be announced within a week from the beginning of the course.
- i) To be effective, feedback has to be dialogic, timely and comprehensible to the student. Instructors intending to encourage peer feedback will have to make effort to build students' ability to provide constructive feedback to each other.

6.5 Guidelines for Grading

The University's grading system follows from the principles of assessment that have been laid down and will adhere to the following principles and guidelines when implemented within various programmes and courses. A course is the smallest unit of study to which a grade is assigned and whose grade is formally certified. Course designers and instructors must refer to the document *Course_design_by_objectives* while specifying grading practices for courses. Some of the salient principles and considerations are listed below.

- a) The University has a grading system for courses that assigns letter grades to students' work that meets certain criteria or standards of quality. The process of grading involves the specification of intended learning outcomes (ILO) and objectives and judgment of the degree to which students achieve these objectives. In this approach, a grade a student attains is not a direct result of comparisons between student performances or ranking student performance on a scale.
- b) The success and efficacy of a 'criterion referenced grading' system depends on the careful definition of standards and criteria that can be used to assess students' work. Schools and programme coordinators are required to evaluate the consistency and clarity of rubrics and the care with which assessment and grading frameworks are designed so that all the different learning outcomes can be assessed successfully.
- c) Course designers and instructors will have the liberty to define assessment tasks within courses that may be graded and also components that may not be graded but just required to be completed.
- d) A grade is a summary indicator of the instructor's assessment of the quality of the student's work as manifested in the assessment task that is graded. A student will be able to obtain the credits associated with a course only upon being assessed and awarded an overall course grade not below E (ref Section 6.6).
- e) The instructors may allot marks indicating the evaluation based on a rubric of the students' work in a task. The marks obtained in individual assessment tasks (converted to percentage value) will be indicated in the grades table in the LMS and weighted to arrive at the final course grade.

- f) All graded credits will be accounted for in the calculation of summary measures such as Grade Point Averages.
- g) The grading system adopted for a course or activity must be transparent and must correspond to the declared learning objectives in the course. The grading scheme and the rubric for evaluation must be announced by the instructor not later than a week from the beginning of instruction and must be published in the course page in the learning management system.
- h) The University will adopt a system of letter grades, and numerical scores linked to each grade for courses that can be, when required, consolidated into overall grade points and grade point averages. The calculation of grade point averages suffers from the conceptual weakness alluded to above; however, the use of GPAs is widespread in higher education.
From the University's perspective, the letter grade awarded for courses will be the authoritative report of student performance.
- i) The combined weightage of assessments (in a course) for class participation, attendance and group work may not exceed 40% of the total without prior approval from the CPC.
- j) The weightage of an individual assessment (in a course) cannot exceed 35% of the total without prior approval from the CPC
- k) The University will define the minimum cumulative grade point averages that are required for progression to subsequent semesters and satisfactory completion of the respective programmes and will notify the same through this FOSQ.
- l) Students will have the right to request the instructor to explain the basis of the grades assigned to them. The instructor's decision on grades awarded shall be final and binding. However, if any student suspects impropriety in the award of grades, s/he shall be at liberty to appeal first to the Programme coordinator and if necessary, to the School Director for redressal. The School Director may set up appropriate procedures for examining and settling such complaints.
- m) An effective system of assessment and grading requires students to adhere to the University's standards for academic integrity in letter and in spirit.

6.6 Grading system & grade descriptions

- a) The University will use a ten-point scale for grading and calculation of grade point averages.
- b) The following table lists the description of the quality of the students' work associated with each grade for a course. Instructors are required to specify the description associated with various levels of learning or performance by the student for each criterion assessed.
- c) Criterion Referenced grading systems involve assessment by the instructors of the performance of students in specific tasks designed to evaluate the achievement of intended learning outcomes. The result of every such assessment may be weighted by the percentage share of the task in the overall grade and a measure of overall performance arrived at. Students must be familiarised with the manner in which the result of component assessment is converted into overall course grade.
- d) The effectiveness of a criterion referenced grading system depends on the care with which objectives, assessment tasks, criteria for assessment and the levels of attainment are linked coherently and reliably. Thus, the design of the assessment task in relation to the intended learning objective is a crucial step.
- e) In some courses the instructors may use Sufficient (S grade) / Unsatisfactory (U grade)

options for course grading. In the event of a 'Sufficient' outcome, the student will be awarded the credits, and the course will be listed in the transcript. The S grade will not impact the CGPA. The decision to award an S/U grade will be taken by the Programme Coordinator and the School Director. The nuances of how the student should apply for S/U grading, the number of times a student can opt for this etc. are given in the Academic Regulations documents

- f) **As mentioned above, the descriptions of student attainment in the following table pertain to overall course level performance. Instructors are required to expand on these descriptions using grading rubrics as appropriate to the content of a particular syllabus and the work that is graded in a particular course through assignments.**

GRADE & SCORE	PERCENTAGE RANGE	DESCRIPTION OF ATTAINMENT
O 10 (POINTS)	95 – 100%	Outstanding This grade is awarded for consistently exceptional work that indicates consistent engagement of high quality throughout the entire course; quality of work at this level is creative, original, thorough, well-researched and reasoned, and well-communicated. The student demonstrates both content-specific and general critical abilities and has engaged with all reading material and extended his/her understanding beyond them. Laboratory/Practical work: The work indicates an outstanding degree of practical skill and excellent dexterity and the ability to conceptualise and execute practical implementations of the ideas involved in the laboratory under guidance (where applicable). There is inventiveness and creative problem solving in the practical realm that is exceptional.
A 9 (POINTS)	90 – 94.99%	Excellent The quality of work attained at this level is often original, and always well-argued, insightful and well-communicated. It indicates that the student has critically grasped the main ideas and engaged with all the instructional material and often gone beyond them. Laboratory/Practical work: The work indicates a high degree of practical skill and excellent dexterity and the ability to conceptualise and execute practical implementations of the ideas involved in the laboratory under guidance (where applicable)

A- 8 (POINTS)	80 – 89.99%	Very Good Awarded for overall performance in the course that indicates consistent engagement with the syllabus; answers in assignments are well-argued and well-communicated. While there is room for improvement, the work presented in the assignments is complete and well-rounded. The work indicates full grasp of all the required readings in the course or theme and a good understanding of the main ideas and perspectives. Laboratory/Practical work: The work indicates a high degree of practical skill and superior dexterity throughout the course and the ability to translate and execute practical implementations of the ideas involved in the laboratory under guidance (where applicable)
B 7 (POINTS)	70 – 79.99%	Good Awarded for performance in the course that indicates good engagement with ideas, questions or perspective; answers presented are well-structured and has a discernible argument and presentation of evidence in support; While the language could use improvement, the work demonstrates understanding of competing perspectives; Laboratory/Practical work: the work indicates a high level of practical skill and the dexterity to translate instructions in the laboratory (where appropriate)
C 6 (POINTS)	60 – 69.99%	Satisfactory Performance in the course that indicates a satisfactory understanding of concepts. Answers in assignments and tests are reasonably structured with discernible line of argument and presentation of justification and evidence. Language needs improvement but is consistent. Laboratory/Practical work: in the laboratory the student is reasonably skilled and displays an ability to understand instructions with a good level of dexterity.
D 5 (POINTS)	50 – 59.99%	Adequate Indicative of sufficient conceptual and theoretical understanding in the course. The work presented generally has clear lines of argument with evidence but not consistently. Claims are made but often not substantiated; however, the student makes an effort to go beyond statements of preference in response to questions. Laboratory/Practical work: In the laboratory, the student is able to set up and execute practical work with assistance and seems to have the ability and motivation to develop further

		skill.
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E 4 (POINTS)	40 – 49.99%	Acceptable The student's work in the course meets the standards of acceptability but can be significantly improved. There is adequate understanding of concepts and theories but not in entirety. Answers in assignments are procedurally adequate; oral and written work is understandable but inconsistent; able to present the bare ideas in an acceptable manner. Laboratory/Practical work: in the practical realm this work is not skilled but able to repeat and present a practical setup from other demonstrated work; there is adequate ability to follow instructions.
U	LESS THAN 40%	Unsatisfactory Overall work in the course that does not indicate sufficient understanding or skill; there is insufficient effort and also lack of attention to detail; incomplete command over the evidence and argument. Laboratory/Practical work: a lack of practical skill and an inability or unwillingness to work at improving procedural competence in the laboratory
S		Sufficient The work has been assessed and found adequate to pass without any change in the grade points. Students will accrue the credits for the course.
I		Incomplete The work has not been assessed, and no grade has been assigned; the instructor may indicate additional work to be done or requirements to be satisfied before grading can be completed

6.7 CGPA Computation

6.7.1 For UG and PG Programmes

The letter grade for each course will be converted to a grade point by multiplying its numerical score by the number of credits obtained for the course. Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) may be calculated after each semester, and at the end of the programme, which shall be reflected on the final grade card, along with the letter grade and associated credits for each course. The CGPA will be on a 10-point scale, corresponding to the letter scales described above.

6.7.2 For Diploma Programmes for working professionals:

Calculation of GPA is same as UG and PG Programmes (6.7.1)

- Students may be assigned I in case of incomplete/pending submissions.
- U grade will result in repeating the course in the next cycle when the same course is offered.
- At the end of each Certificate programme, the University will issue a grade statement

stating the grades in the courses and a Grade Point Average (GPA) for that certificate programme.

6.8 Minimum Grades, Reassessment, Attendance

6.8.1 Incomplete Study

A student may temporarily be awarded 'I', indicating that grading is not complete in a course. "I" will be awarded only if a student is unable to complete assessment and grading related requirements for one of the following two extenuating circumstances. The verification of these circumstances will be made by the respective Programme Office.

- a) Owing to illness that is medically certified
- b) Family emergency or bereavement

In case of 'I' in any course, the student and the faculty will discuss the pending work required to complete the course. The student will be given an opportunity to complete the prescribed pending requirements within a maximum of two weeks from the end of the semester and the faculty to finish grading in the next week. If the student does not complete the requirements within the specified time period, the faculty will award a suitable grade taking into account the non-completion and based on student performance in the completed assessment requirements. No credit will be awarded until the course is completed and a passing grade received. No transcripts for the semester will be issued till the student completes the requirements of all courses in the semester. Since an I is not a grade, no reference to it will be made in transcripts.

6.8.2 Awards of U Grades, and consequent reassessment or repetition of courses

- a) Students in the following categories are not eligible to be awarded a final satisfactory grade and will be awarded a U in the course, unless specific exceptions are approved under extenuating circumstances. The students will be required to repeat the course when offered next and will not be eligible for reassessment under (c) below.
 - (i) Students who do not clear the threshold for the award of an E grade in the course as declared in the grade boundaries for the course (see section 6.6)
 - (ii) Students who do not meet attendance requirements
 - (iii) Students awarded a U grade for the course due to violations of academic integrity
 - (iv) Students who awarded U in a reassessment (see the next point)
 - (v) Students who do not complete and submit assessment tasks that total at least 65% of the assessment weightage in a course.
- b) Students who get a U under any point other than (i) above will not be eligible for a reassessment, where available, and will need to either repeat the course or find an alternative if the course is not core/compulsory. Any exceptions to this will need to be approved on a case-to-case basis.
- c) All assessment tasks must be completed and submitted by students on time, as stipulated by the instructor. The last assignment of any course must be submitted not later than a week from the end of instruction in a term.
- d) Students who receive a U in a course who are eligible for reassessment will have to appear for comprehensive reassessment to be conducted and graded not later than four weeks from the beginning of the following term. The schedule for reassessment will be

announced by the respective programme office and would include invigilated examinations, written assignments, essays or open book assignments each of not less than 40% weightage. The transcript will be issued only when the reassessment is completed and graded.

- e) In some courses, the comprehensive reassessment may not entail full grading. Instructors may use the S / U option as described in section 6.6. The decision to award the S / U option will be taken by the Programme Coordinators and the School Director
- f) If the course in which a U is awarded has significant laboratory/practical component, the instructor can designate one of the examinations as a practical examination. If a student receives a U in a field-based project, no reassessment will be conducted. The project will have to be repeated in full.
- g) If the final grade, in the case of core/required courses, is again U ('Unsatisfactory') after the reassessment process in (c) above, the following outcomes will apply:
 - The grade U received again on reassessment in the course will appear on the transcript issued for the relevant semester.
 - The student will have to repeat the course when offered next and obtain the credits.
 - In cases where students need to repeat a core course, if the course is no longer in the list of courses offered in the programme, the programme office may offer an alternative, on recommendation from the programme coordinator.

Illustration:

- Students enroll in 4 Core courses in Semester 1. Clears three courses with B grade and gets a U in one course.
- Semester 1 transcript will not be released at this point.
- Appears for reassessment within 4 weeks of Semester 2
 - Option 1: Passes the reassessment with a C grade. The Semester 1 transcript will show all the four courses: 3 B and 1 C (The original U does not appear at all in any transcript)
 - Option 2: Gets U grade again. The U grade will appear in Semester 1 transcript. The student will repeat the course when offered next.
- h) In the case of electives all the above rules for reassessment will apply for obtaining a pass grade in the immediately following semester. If the final grade is a U again after comprehensive reassessment, the student will be given one opportunity to either repeat the course when it is offered next or to replace the course with another elective.
- i) For courses where reassessment is not possible, the student must repeat the course when offered next. **PG and UG Academic Regulations documents detail the eligibility, timeline and list of courses for which reassessment is permissible.**
- j) In the case of Open or Creative Expression (CRX) courses, no reassessment will be conducted. If a U is awarded, that will be included in the transcript. The student receiving a U must choose another open/CRX course in the subsequent semesters.
- k) In case of certificate programmes / Diploma, the reassessment will not be an invigilated examination but online assignments.

6.8.3 Repetition of courses for grade improvement

Repetition of courses for grade improvement is not permitted.

6.8.4 Protocol for records pertaining to assessment and grading

- a) Course instructors will announce the various assessment tasks that will be graded in the course to all the students within a week from the beginning of the semester along with the assessment rubrics. A copy of the grading system will also be filed with the Programme Coordinator at the beginning of the course and can be modified under exceptional circumstances, with prior approval.
- b) For every course, the concerned course instructor shall maintain a record with the list of the enrolled students, the grades or scores obtained on each of the assessment tasks by students and the overall grade awarded to the student at the end of the said course. This shall be reported to the program office and the Programme Coordinator at the end of the course. In case a software platform is being used, the component grades and the final grade shall be available in the software for review or audit and the grades indicated must correspond to the grades entered in the final transcript.
- c) The programme office will maintain an overall summary record of all the grades obtained by every student for all the courses that he or she has enrolled for and maintain the up-to-date record of CGPA for every student.
- d) The programme office will communicate to every student the course-wise grades awarded to the student along with the grade point average, if calculated. A printed Semester Grade Statement will be given to every student. The timelines for communication of grades and release of statements will be announced at the end of each semester.
- e) Every student has the right to seek clarification on the grades awarded to him / her from the concerned course instructor. The course instructor is the final arbiter of the course related clarifications pertaining to assessment and grades. The course instructor will revert with a decision in writing within one week of raising the clarification and changes to the grades, if any, will be communicated to the Programme Office and incorporated in the grade statement. (Please see Section 6.5 for further guidelines).
- f) Students are required to seek clarification and feedback on the assignments within a week of the assignment grade-declaration by the faculty, without waiting until the end of the semester to obtain clarification on all assignments.
- g) The University will not maintain the original or copies of the answer books or assignment papers submitted by the students either in hard or soft copy format. The assignments and test papers, conducted at various times during the semester will be returned to students after being assessed and if applicable, graded by the instructor. Course instructors are required to retain copies of assignments and term papers only for two weeks into the subsequent semester or till grades for the semester are finalized and reported, whichever

is later.

6.8.5 Attendance

- a) Courses and classes, field work, practicum, projects and group work are among core academic activities that are central to studying in the University. Students are expected to be committed to attending and participating in all such activities that are part of the curriculum. Assessment and grading are also designed taking committed student involvement for granted.
- b) Absence from all academic activities (classes, field work or practicum as the case may be) for more than two working days needs prior intimation to the instructor and the programme office. In general, leave of absence will be given for situations that involve the student being unwell or verified instances of urgency related to the family that require the student to be away from the University. Without this, the student will be considered to be absent from the programme without leave and no academic concessions will be permitted. The University may announce regulations governing residences separately.
- c) Instructors shall record attendance by students in all activities formally part of the curriculum including classes, field work, practicum etc. and report the same in the specified format to the programme office. The programme office will maintain consolidated attendance information and frequently review the attendance records, along with faculty/programme coordinators. The students may be required to explain lack of attendance and related matters. Attendance data may be shared with faculty members, programme coordinators, school heads and other administrative staff.
- d) The programme office in consultation with the School heads, will publish specific norms for the minimum level of attendance required to be assessed in a course or across courses in a semester and for continued registration in a programme, along with procedures for recording, reporting, and initiating penalties and appeals.

6.9 Requirements for Graduation and Award of degree

6.9.1 Continuing registration in programmes

- Students registered in a course must obtain at least grade E to obtain all the credits allocated to the course or a Satisfactory grade on reassessment.
- A student receives credits for successful completion of the course. In case of “incomplete” status (I), the pending requirements to obtain a passing grade have to be completed within two weeks from the end of the semester.
- Students who are awarded a U in any core/required course in any semester will be permitted to register in the following semester. However, their enrolment in the courses for which the course in which the student received a U is a prerequisite will be provisional and will be confirmed only if the student passes the reassessment for the prerequisite course. In case the student gets a U in the reassessment, they will be un-registered from the course for which the previous course was a prerequisite.
- If the total number of courses that a student is graded U in a semester exceeds three, then they will not be permitted to register in the subsequent semester.

- However, if a student is eligible for reassessment in any of the failed courses, student can appear for the reassessment and continue the semester on clearing the reassessment examination.

Note:

- In Undergraduate programmes students will be permitted to register in the subsequent semester if they are eligible to take at least two courses as part of the requirements of their specific programme.
- The Registrar and School director can make an exception in specific cases.

6.9.2 Award of degree –postgraduate programmes

To be eligible for the award of the degree a student should meet the following conditions within the stipulated duration in the programme:

- a. Must obtain all the credits assigned to core and/or required courses and
- b. Must accumulate the required total of credits designated for the qualification
- c. No student who successfully graduates can have more than THREE (3) U's (TWO U's in the case of one-year programmes) in the transcripts issued during the programme

6.9.3 Award of degree – undergraduate programme

To be eligible for the award of the degree a student should meet the following conditions within the stipulated duration in the programme:

- a. Must obtain all the credits assigned to required courses and
- b. must accumulate the required total of credits designated for the qualification
- b. No student who successfully graduates can have more than FOUR (4) U's in the case of 3-year undergraduate programmes or FIVE (5) U's in the case of a 4-year undergraduate programme in the transcripts issued during the programme

7.0 Academic Integrity

The University expects unwavering integrity from the students in their academic work. This is important on two counts. Academic integrity is a central value intrinsically important to any learning process founded on trust and cooperation between the learner and teachers. Secondly, the efficacy and effectiveness of any assessment for learning and its fairness are crucially dependent on the student's willingness to adhere to norms. The norms attempt to ensure that the students are indeed presenting evidence and occasion for the instructor to assess their work and provide feedback.

There are many ways in which commitments to academic integrity by students may be compromised in the University. These include production and presentation of work assisted or done by others as one's own, violation of norms proscribing malpractice in tests and examinations, non-participation and lack of contribution by a student in group work where s/he is being assessed, and plagiarism.

While all the above are serious violations of propriety and will be governed by rules that may prescribe punitive action, the following sections lay down norms and procedures for responding to plagiarism.

The University seeks to build awareness of the issue of plagiarism and a climate for prevention

rather than depend mainly on punitive measures in the implementation of these guidelines. Students will be helped to understand and avoid situations that might be construed to be plagiarism. This effort will include workshops or sessions dedicated to creating understanding and building awareness about plagiarism in general and with specific reference to University guidelines, tools and techniques for validation and individual counselling where needed.

7.1 Violations of academic integrity

There are many ways in which academic honesty may be violated. The FOSQ does not purport to identify and detail all such cases and the likely responses to them. However, this section lays down the norms and rules that apply to specific examples of violation that would clearly entail consequences or specific punitive measures. Examples of violations of academic integrity include but are not limited to:

- a. Cheating and/or malpractice in academic activity
- b. Misrepresentation or fabrication of information or evidence
- c. Participation in or facilitation of certain dishonest or detrimental practices with or without benefit to oneself
- d. Plagiarism
- e. Misuse of AI tools in assignments

If detected, the University will apply penalties as mentioned below and also adopt the other steps required. In cases where specific penalties are not listed in this document, the Programme Coordinator, the School Head and the Registrar may impose appropriate penalties after an enquiry.

7.1.1 Cheating or malpractice in academic activity

This could include instances of cheating in examinations or tests such as illicit copying of material from books, documents or other students' work, taking help from others when not allowed to do so, and use of unauthorized devices.

7.1.2 Misrepresentation or fabrication of information

In the course of academic work students are often required to present or access information significant to academic performance. Students are required to represent, cite, quote or otherwise acknowledge such information clearly and honestly. Examples of failure to do so include:

- a. misrepresentation or fabrication of others' views in interviews or surveys,
- b. failure to cite information or views collected from external sources,
- c. deliberate alteration or fabrication of data or information that is improperly generated from experiments, interviews, surveys etc.
- d. deliberate errors introduced into analyses of data or information to support preferred conclusions

7.1.3 Participation in or facilitation of certain dishonest or detrimental practices

Students in the University are often required to work in groups within the student community or work with members of the Foundation or other organisations. This work is an extension of the academic work in the programme. Students are required to be fully mindful of the expected code of academic conduct in these interactions. Examples of the failure to do so might include:

- a. Not contributing to group academic work when expected to do so in a course
- b. Actively encouraging someone's lack of participation in group work
- c. Unjustified absence from field work
- d. Violation of the norms of host organisations during field visits and work
- e. Dishonest accounting of expenditure during field visits or internships

7.2 Plagiarism

Plagiarism is the deliberate presentation of work and/or ideas, as explained below in (a), (b) and (c), as one's own to meet the academic demands of a course or programme in the University. For the purposes of these guidelines, it includes:

- (a) Copying, reproducing, or presenting in one's own work, in part or in full, text, data, graphics, pictures etc., from prior published or unpublished work by others (including other students) in whatever forms they might be available (papers, articles, books, journals, web-resources). Instructors may permit fair use of segments of text, data or clips with proper acknowledgment or citation.
- (b) Recycling or re-submitting own work: the resubmission of past work, in part or in full, that is the same or substantially the same for any other assessment (either in the same course or different) without the express consent of the instructor.
- (c) Getting another person to write an assignment, wholly or partly, on one's behalf. This includes usage of AI to write the contents of an assignment.

7.2.1 Identification and detection

In any taught course, or course of field work, the instructor or faculty coordinator will have the authority to identify, counsel, penalise and report the instance of plagiarism. It is important that there is a consistency of responses between instructors of different courses, for obvious reasons. Any inconsistent response to plagiarism by instructors can produce confusion among students and in extreme cases unequal treatment of individual students. Depending on prior instances of violation, the University may impose further penalties.

7.2.2 Identification: Severity

Severity shall be assessed as Low or High.

- i. Low severity – Examples:
 - a. the use of a sentence or two from sources other than one's own, in an assignment or essay
 - b. the use of graphs or tables without acknowledgement
 - c. The use of a paragraph from one's own prior work without prior consent of the instructor
- ii. High severity – An instance of plagiarism that is assessed to be "High" will be all those not considered "Low" including for example
 - a. Use of sentences that are not one's own in multiple locations in a piece of writing
 - b. Reproducing more than a paragraph from one's own earlier work without citation/acknowledgement.
 - c. Copying of significant amount of another student's work from an assignment in the same course or from an earlier occasion
 - d. Repeated plagiarism on more than one occasion in the course of low severity
 - e. All cases of copying/helping others in an 'in-class' test

The examples above are indicative and not exhaustive and faculty members are encouraged to apply their judgement in assessing severity.

7.3 Reporting

All instances of violations of academic integrity irrespective of severity are to be reported to the Programme Coordinator and the Programme office. The Programme Office will maintain consolidated records.

7.4 Penalties and consequences

If the instructor or any other person responsible for the academic activity detects any instance of violation of academic integrity as detailed above, he or she is required to take the following action/s:

- a. All instances of violation will be reported to the Programme Coordinator and the Programme Office
- b. If the violation happens in a taught course in the University, the instructor will assess if the violation is of low or high severity
- c. In the case of a violation of low severity in the course, the instructor will counsel the student, issue a warning, and may ask the student to repeat the assignment or assign a reduced grade or grade U for the assignment
- d. In the case of a violation of high severity the instructor will assign a grade U for the entire course

7.4.1 Penalties and consequences – Programme Level

Depending on past occurrences, the School in consultation with the Programme Office may impose further penalties as below:

- a. If the student has been involved in any other violation of low severity in the past in any other course, the School, after due process, may assign a grade U for the entire course.
- b. If the student has been involved in any other violation of high severity in the past, or more than one violation of low severity, the School, after an appropriate process, may cancel the registration of the student in the semester or in the entire programme.

7.5 Academic Affairs Committee

The Director of each School will constitute an Academic Affairs Committee (AAC) with members chosen from among (i) the Associate Director (ii) Programme Coordinator, (iii) a faculty member (iv) Manager – Programme Office. All decisions outlined in Section 7.4.1 will be taken by the Director, on recommendation by the AAC. Students have the right to appeal to AAC regarding penalties imposed on account of violations of academic integrity.

8.0 Academic Regulations and interpretations

8.1 Summary of academic norms

Key academic regulations are available in the “Academic Regulations” document developed for UG, PG and Diploma programmes. This summary of academic regulations is based on the authority of the FOSQ that details the rules and regulations that govern academic practice in the various programmes conducted in the Schools. These norms may also be mentioned in student handbooks. In case any of the norms mentioned in programme regulations contradict or contravene the entries in the FOSQ, the latter will prevail. Each such set of Regulations must be approved by the

Programme Office before being released.

8.2 Interpretations

Schools shall write to the Programme Office for clarifications and the Programme Office may approach the Curriculum and Pedagogy Committee for any clarification or interpretation if required.

Laptop and IT Usage Policy

Updated: Apr 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru, Bhopal and Ranchi Campuses

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1 Purpose

1. This document outlines the guidelines for laptop & internet usage on Azim Premji University's IT infrastructure.
2. These guidelines apply to all students using university-provided laptops as well as their personal laptops.
3. These guidelines intend to promote safe and responsible internet usage practices among students.
4. It is essential for students to read, understand, and consistently adhere to these guidelines.

2 Internet Usage Guidelines

1. Internet access is enabled for one laptop or Tablet used by the students on the University campus **only** to facilitate academic pursuits.
2. It is advised that students only use the network to view websites that are necessary for their academic work and do not come under the category of illegal or unlawful activity. The indicative list or categories of Websites that should not be accessed from University IT Infrastructure include but not limited to
 - a. Adult content and sexually explicit sites
 - b. Websites which promote terrorism
 - c. Websites that infringe on Intellectual Property Rights
 - d. Websites which allow unauthorized/ pirated downloads of software/music/films/videos/ albums like Torrenting
 - e. Unsafe sites that could propagate virus/malware.
 - f. Website that allows online games, gambling sites

3. Visiting/accessing/downloading/ uploading/ surfing/ transferring data or information to any of the objectionable/unlawful websites would be treated as Internet misuse and will attract legal action in addition to disciplinary action by the University.

3 Email and Storage Guidelines

1. Email and chat services are enabled for students to use for all associated academic work.
2. For the duration of the university's academic course, storage capacity limits (up to 10GB) will be available. Students are provided up to 1GB of storage in their APU email address as alumni. The account and email ID may become unavailable for use if the above limit is exceeded.
3. Students are advised to exercise caution and not use the University email services in any way which can be treated as:
 - a. Insulting person/group/community/culture/nationality/creed/caste etc
 - b. Promoting /supporting terrorism or communal clash
 - c. Disruptive with immoral/unlawful content (Sexually explicit/implicit messages, abuse, harassment, indecent propositions, cartoons/jokes which may hurt any community's or religion's sentiments)
 - d. Promoting/demoting any commercial /non-commercial activities/products
 - e. Sending University copyrighted or confidential data to unauthorized person.
 - f. Communication which may bring down the reputation of the university or making statements defaming the university.
 - g. Accessing/hacking any other email, sending mails on behalf of them
 - h. Forwarding copies of any other employee's email to their email id
 - i. Mail spoofing or knowingly transmitting viruses or any malicious software through mail.
 - j. Spamming of mailbox by forwarding and/or replying to unsolicited junk mails
 - k. Falsely claiming to be representative of the university
4. Students are permitted to send and receive personal emails using the email service; however, during any IT email audit by the university, these personal emails may be examined.
5. Students are added to specific groups or mailboxes to which the students can send emails. Students are requested to use the "Reply" and "Reply All" features judiciously. f) Access to communication with distribution lists is restricted to a few email IDs only, to prevent unintentional email forwarding or reply-all scenarios.
6. Based on any exigencies of investigating work related to misconduct and misuse of IT resources, the university, as requested by the Registrar or Program Office, reserves the right to access the information stored on a student's laptop, including emails (personal and official). To access the laptop or emails, the university is not required to provide any prior notification to the student, and the rights to access and investigate rest with the university.

4 Laptop Usage Guidelines

4.1 Laptops issued to Undergraduate students.

1. Students who are on 100% financial assistance will be provided with a standard

Windows laptop. This provision is an additional support for their learning, and the university reserves the right to withdraw this support at any point. The laptop is installed with Antivirus software for Malware/Virus protection. Students are expected to take care of the laptop in their custody from physical damage, theft, etc – both on and off campus.

2. **Any damage (accidental or misuse) to the laptop, cost of repair must be borne by the students.**
3. A standby laptop may be provided by the IT Helpdesk based on availability of student spare and discretion of the IT team at that point of time.
4. Admin privileges on laptops are provided to students. However, ONLY Licensed and Legal software to be installed by students.
5. A laptop provided by the University is expected to be used for assisting in academic pursuits ONLY.
6. At the end of the academic life cycle at the University, the students are eligible to retain the laptop for their further Post grad academic pursuits if required.
7. Laptop in AS-IS condition with Windows operating system license may be retained and any other anti-virus software or other software licenses provided by university will be revoked.
8. In case the student withdraws from the UG program, the laptop must be surrendered, and an acknowledgement must be obtained from the IT desk.
9. In case a UG student continues their PG program at the university, they are expected to continue using the university-provided laptop, and no new or additional laptop will be provided during their PG academics.
10. IT Helpdesk may be approached for issues related to the University provided laptop - Hardware, Operating system and Software provided/installed by the University IT team.
11. IT Helpdesk may be approached for issues related to University provided Email-id.
l) Students are responsible for any legal or financial implications arising from the unauthorized or illegal use of university IT infrastructure or internet resources. The university is not responsible in any way for such actions by students.

4.2 Laptops issued to Postgraduate Students

1. Students who are on financial assistance will be provided with a standard Windows laptop. This provision is an additional support for their learning, and the university reserves the right to withdraw this support at any point. The laptop is installed with Antivirus software for Malware/Virus protection. Students are expected to take care of the laptop in their custody from physical damage, theft, etc – both on and off campus.
2. **Any damage (accidental or misuse) to the laptop, cost of repair must be borne by the students.**
3. A standby laptop may be provided by the IT Helpdesk based on availability of student spare and discretion of the IT team at that point of time.
4. Admin privileges on laptops are provided to students. However, ONLY Licensed and Legal software to be installed by students.
5. A laptop provided by the University is expected to be used for assisting in academic pursuits ONLY.
6. At the end of the academic life cycle or discontinuation of the program, students must handover the laptop physically in good working condition to the IT team at the university campus and take no due acknowledgement.
7. In case of any damage, the cost of repair has to be paid by the student before no

- due clearance.
8. If for some reason, students are unable to submit the laptop to the IT team before exiting the campus, No Dues will not be issued. Students must ensure the laptop is submitted in person to IT Team at the campus before collecting the Degree certificates.
 9. IT Helpdesk may be approached for issues related to the University provided laptop - Hardware, Operating system and Software provided/installed by the University IT team.
 10. IT Helpdesk may be approached for issues related to University provided Email-id.
 - k) Students are responsible for any legal or financial implications arising from the unauthorized or illegal use of university IT infrastructure or internet resources. The university is not responsible in any way for such actions by students.

4.3 Guidelines for Personal Laptop Usage

1. Students can bring their personal laptops to use for academic work. The university will provide internet access to one of the students' devices.
2. Laptops or tablets used by students should always have updated patches and should be installed with a standard antivirus package with the latest updates. c) All software applications used on personal laptops should have a valid license, and no unauthorized software downloads or applications should be used.
3. Students must personally manage any hardware or software issues encountered on their laptops, as the IT Helpdesk will not support personal laptops.
4. Students are responsible for any legal or financial implications arising from the unofficial or illegal use of university IT infrastructure or internet resources. The university is not responsible in any way for such actions by students.

5 Miscellaneous

1. Where guidelines are not explicitly stated in this document, the Manager of the IT Helpdesk may take decisions in consultation with the Registrar, consistent with the University's extant policies.
2. All copyrighted information (text, images, icons, programs, videos, audio, etc.) retrieved from computer or network resources must be used in accordance with applicable copyright laws and other relevant regulations.
3. Computers and internet access shall not be used for any illegal or unlawful purpose. d) Students must respect data usage and privacy policies, ensuring that personal and sensitive information is handled securely and only used for authorized purposes. Unauthorized access, sharing, or misuse of data of other students or any university members is strictly prohibited and subject to disciplinary action.
4. For any further queries/clarifications please reach out it-helpdesk@apu.edu.in

Policy on Prevention of Sexual Harassment (PoSH) and Guidelines for Redressal

Updated: May 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru Campus

Azim Premji University is committed to provide a safe work and learning environment based on respect for individual dignity.

Sexual Harassment refers to any unwelcome and unlawful sexually determined behaviour directly or by implication when submission to such conduct creates an unpleasant and offensive work/learning place for any employee/student or is made a condition for a person's employment or enrolment in a programme.

The University will pro-actively build awareness on this issue and offer counselling services with regard to sexual attitudes and behaviour. The University has a sensitive and strong redressal process in cases of sexual harassment in accordance with the law.

1. The University prohibits sexual harassment at the work/learning place and any individual found guilty of such behaviour will be liable for action under this Policy. Wherever sexual harassment occurs, the University will act to stop the harassment, prevent its recurrence, and take appropriate action against those responsible.
2. Sexual Harassment means any behaviour which constitutes **unwelcome** sexual conduct - acts of physical intimacy, oral/textual requests for sexual favours, graphic representations of a sexual nature, other visual, verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature and includes all conduct in the detailed list of behaviours provided in the **Annexure** to this document.
3. Encouragement or assistance (abetment) in an act of sexual harassment will be deemed to be sexual harassment.
4. The Policy and Guidelines apply to all members (Students, Faculty and Staff – both full time and part time) of the University, all persons working for the University but not directly employed by the University and all persons who participate in programmes of the University. It is also applicable to consultants, part-time, temporary, contractual or casual employees, trainees, persons on probation while on an engagement with the University as well as any other third party.
5. The Policy and Guidelines apply to all instances of sexual harassment occurring:

- a. On the premises of the University, irrespective of the persons involved.
 - b. Between or among members of the University, irrespective of the location.
 - c. At the extended workplace e.g. while travelling, at the place of stay and work or venue of work-related events.
6. The University will strive to prevent any acts of this nature by communicating with all members through communication material and awareness programmes.
7. The University has constituted a Prevention of Sexual Harassment (PoSH) Committee in accordance with the law. This Committee will ensure proper and effective implementation of the PoSH Policy.
8. The members of the PoSH Committee for Azim Premji University, Bengaluru Campus are:
 - a. Adil Hossain – adil.hossain@apu.edu.in
 - b. Ajaykumar- ajaykumar.k@apu.edu.in
 - c. Alok Pandurangi- alok.pandurangi@apu.edu.in
 - d. Antara Das- antara.das@apu.edu.in
 - e. Kripa Gowrishankar -kripa.gowrishankar@apu.edu.in
 - f. Madhusudhan Ramesh- madhusudhan.ramesh@apu.edu.in
 - g. Malini Bhattacharjee - malini@apu.edu.in (Presiding Officer)
 - h. Manoj Kumar - manoj.kumar@apu.edu.in
 - i. Meena P- meena.p@apu.edu.in
 - j. Prachi Gupta – Prachi.gupta@apu.edu.in
 - k. Prakash Iyer - prakash.iyer@apu.edu.in
 - l. Ridhi Roy - ridhi.roy@apu.edu.in (Member-Secretary)
 - m. Sarah Talat - sarah.talat@apu.edu.in
 - n. Sunhar- sunhar.u@apu.edu.in
 - o. Subir Dey – subir.dey@apu.edu.in
 - p. V.S. Elizabeth (External Expert)
9. The Committee shall be reconstituted every three years. The Member- Secretary will be responsible to call meetings and, together with the Presiding Officer, identify the investigating team and help conclude the investigations. S/he will also be responsible for maintaining records.
10. The Committee will:
 - a. Spread awareness about the Policy within the University on a regular basis by conducting sensitization workshops for all members.
 - b. Counsel members (faculty, staff and students) on issues of sexual harassment.
 - c. Be authorized to receive complaints of sexual harassment and conduct inquiries on such complaints in the manner prescribed in this Policy.
 - d. Be responsible for assisting victims of sexual harassment and eyewitnesses through the process of inquiry.

- e. Recommend necessary action to protect victims/eyewitnesses who have reported any instance of retaliation or threats of retaliation.
 - f. Ensure that all discussions with the PoSH Committee are kept confidential.
11. Any person to whom this Policy is applicable who believes that she or he has been a victim of sexual harassment may submit a complaint by email to posh@apu.edu.in or directly contact any of the PoSH Committee members who will render all reasonable assistance to the victim to make the complaint in writing.
 12. It may be helpful to make a written record of the date, time and nature of the incident/(s) and the names of any witnesses along with any document or other evidence in support of the complaint.
 13. The complaint must be registered within a period of three months from the date of the incident or, in the case of a series of incidents, within a period of three months from the date of the last incident.
 14. The PoSH Committee may extend this time limit for another three months for reasons given in writing, if it is satisfied that circumstances prevented the complainant from filing within the stipulated period. If there is a compelling reason to accept a complaint beyond this extended period, PoSH committee will do so after filing the rationale behind the decision.
 15. Any person may approach the members of the PoSH Committee to seek information on sexual harassment or to clarify whether or not a particular incident is one of sexual harassment.
 16. An eyewitness to any conduct amounting to or implying sexual harassment may also report the incident in the manner prescribed under this Policy.
 17. Anonymous complaints will not be accepted.
 18. On receiving a complaint, the Committee may do the following:
 - a. **Conciliation:** At the request of the complainant, the Committee will attempt to settle the matter between the complainant and the respondent through conciliation prior to initiating an inquiry. If this is successful, the Committee will forward the settlement arrived at to the Pro-Registrar for implementation and provide copies of the settlement report to the parties involved. If there is any complaint by the complainant that the terms and conditions of the settlement arrived at have not been complied with by the respondent, an inquiry will be instituted.
 - b. **Inquiry:** An inquiry into a complaint of sexual harassment will be completed within a period of 90 days from the date of receipt of the complaint. An inquiry into a complaint will be conducted in a way that ensures confidentiality. In general, the PoSH Committee will adhere to the principles of natural justice including:

- Giving reasonable opportunity to both parties to be heard as well as taking on record any relevant documents.
 - Upon completion of inquiry providing a summary of its findings to both parties.
 - Taking all actions necessary to ensure a fair and equal process including ensuring that neither complainant nor supporting witnesses nor any other person cooperating with the inquiry process is victimized or discriminated in any way.
- c. **Actions pending Inquiry:** During the pendency of an inquiry the PoSH Committee shall have the discretion to make appropriate interim recommendations upon a written request by the complainant to:
- Transfer the complainant or respondent to any other team (or any other class/section in case of students).
 - Grant leave to the complainant of up to three months provided this shall be in addition to the leave s/he would normally be entitled to.
 - Grant such other relief to the complainant as may be necessary.
- d. **Retaliation:** Any kind of retaliation or threat of retaliation by either of the parties concerned is forbidden and strong action will be initiated if such incidents occur.
- e. **Completion of Inquiry:** The Committee on completion of an inquiry shall provide a report of its findings within 10 days from the date of completion to the Pro-Registrar. Necessary action based on the report must be taken within 60 days of the receipt of the report.
- f. After preliminary internal investigation, if the committee feels further investigation and action is required, a case may be reported to the police with the approval of the complainant.
19. **Penalties:** Depending on the gravity of the situation and offence, the PoSH Committee may recommend to the Pro-Registrar one or more of the following illustrative penalties on any individual/s found guilty of sexual harassment.
- a. Written apology
 - b. Warning or reprimand
 - c. Transfer to another team (with or without a change in role)
 - d. Withdrawal of residential facilities/financial support/academic honours
 - e. Suspension/Dismissal/ Rustication/Expulsion
 - f. Where an alleged instance amounts to a cognizable offence under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 or any other applicable law, the University may, in addition to imposing one or more of the above penalties, initiate appropriate proceedings according to law.
20. **Confidentiality:** The identity of the complainant, respondent, witnesses, statements and other evidence obtained in the course of the inquiry process, recommendations of the Committee, or action taken by the Foundation are considered as confidential. These should not be disclosed by any member or discussed within teams or shared on any media. The complainant, respondent, witnesses, Committee members and person/s who action the recommendation are bound by this obligation. Any breach of confidentiality is subject to penalties including but not limited to those mentioned in point 19 above.

21. **Appeal:** If any of the parties to the complaint is/are dissatisfied with actions taken for resolution of a complaint, they can file an appeal with the Registrar, Rishikesh B, within 90 calendar days of the communication of the decision to the parties.
22. In the event of a complaint made against the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Azim Premji Foundation and/or the Vice-Chancellor (VC) of Azim Premji University:
- a. The investigating team for this kind of case will necessarily include the external member of the Committee.
 - b. All roles/powers to be performed by the CEO/VC in the case of other complaints will be performed by a nominee of the Board of Azim Premji Foundation. Currently, the Chief Endowment Officer has been nominated for this purpose. Any further change will be notified by the Board.
 - c. This nominee shall also keep the Chairman of the Board informed of the investigation.
 - d. The final decision on the complaint shall be taken by the Chairman of the Board on the advice of the nominee.
23. **Consensual Relationships:** This section applies to consensual relationships (romantic or sexual) between two members in a reporting relationship.

The University recognises and respects members' rights to privacy and has no stance on consensual relationships among peers. However, in the case of members who have a direct reporting relationship (e.g. Supervisor and Member; Member - teaching/non-teaching, full time/visiting - and Student), the person in an organizational position of relatively higher authority/ seniority has the ability to influence the life and career of the other. Such consensual relationships are discouraged.

If such a consensual relationship exists, the members must report it to the Registrar and People Function. The onus of reporting is with the person in an organizational position of relatively higher authority/ seniority. If the members concerned express an intention to continue in their relationship, one of them must choose to move to a different role so that the reporting relationship ceases to exist.

In cases where the relationship is not reported, necessary action due to violation of code of conduct may be initiated against both parties.

Any relationship with a minor, even when consensual, is prohibited by law.

24. The University will review these guidelines from time to time and communicate changes if any.

ANNEXURE

A. Sexual Harassment means any behaviour which constitutes **unwelcome** sexual conduct including but not limited to the following:

1. Leering
2. Comments about people's bodies/clothes
3. Sexist and insulting graffiti
4. Sexist cartoons, jokes and songs
5. Obscene phone calls/text messages/emails
6. Lewd and threatening letters/emails/text messages
7. Verbal abuse or comments that put down people because of their sex
8. Inappropriate gifts
9. Repeated sexual invitations when the person invited has refused/ignored similar invitations
10. Material that is sexual in nature, sexist, sexually explicit and is displayed in the workplace, circulated, or put in someone's workspace or belongings, or on a computer or fax machine or on the Internet or any other public display system or public place on the premises of the University
11. Graphic descriptions of pornography
12. Displaying pornography on the premises of the University
13. Touching and hugging
14. Pressing or rubbing up against a victim
15. Brushing against sexual parts of the body
16. Insisting that individuals wear revealing clothing
17. Sexually explicit gestures
18. Indecent exposure
19. Sexual sneak attacks
20. Subtle or overt pressure for sexual favours
21. Soliciting or demanding sexual services
22. Sexual or physical contact, such as slapping, kissing or touching
23. Coerced sexual intercourse
24. Sexual assault
25. Any act which constitutes an offence under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 or any other prevalent law

The following acts would also be considered as acts of sexual harassment if the same occur in relation to or in connection with any act of sexual harassment described in this annexure:

1. Implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment in employment
2. Implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in employment
3. Implied or explicit threat about present or future employment

4. Interference in work or creating an intimidating or offensive or hostile work environment
5. Humiliating treatment likely to affect health or safety

B. **Definition of Consent:** Consent in a relationship is when both parties **consciously** and **voluntarily** agree to the activity they want to engage in. It is important to note that consent given at one point can be withdrawn at a later stage. Not expressing views or withholding views should not be mistaken as consent. It is advisable to seek affirmative consent at each stage of a relationship.



The Residences Handbook – 2026

Azim Premji University, Bengaluru

Updated: May 2026

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1. Welcome

A warm welcome to Azim Premji University! Congratulations on joining our community, and we look forward to engaging with you over the coming years. We are pleased to share the Residences Handbook with you and encourage you to read it carefully.

This handbook is meant to help create a learning environment that supports personal growth, well-being, and respectful community living. Resident Mentors and others will discuss its contents with you during orientation and throughout your programme.

We encourage you to revisit the Handbook from time to time, as your understanding and engagement with it will continue to grow.

As students, you play an important role in shaping the culture of student life at the University. Your actions and interactions influence both your own experience and that of future students.

2. Residential Life

Learning at the University happens in many ways — through classrooms and labs, independent study, conversations with teachers and mentors, interactions with peers, organising events, and shared experiences in everyday residential life. This is a co-living space that helps you engage with students and faculty from diverse social, economic, regional, and linguistic backgrounds; and builds a sense of social responsibility through community living.

For the academic year 2026–2027, students will stay in two buildings — Nalanda and Vihara. Residential life offers both structured activities and informal opportunities for learning and growth.

Resident Mentors (RMs) and floor coordinators help facilitate residential experiences and foster a sense of community. Students are encouraged to actively participate and contribute towards creating a safe, caring, and vibrant learning environment that supports academic and personal growth.

3. Location

- The main walk path to Nalanda is through the teak forest, and then past the amphitheatre.
- Vihara is a 15-storeyed building situated opposite Hampi, near Darshini (cafeteria).
- Most academic buildings on campus shut by 6:30 PM. The library will remain open until midnight, unless otherwise notified. Ground floor classrooms in Hampi will be accessible until midnight for group or individual study purposes. To watch movies or for other club activities, please seek approval from Student Affairs 24 hours prior.

4. Vihara Residences

- Students residing at Vihara will occupy rooms from the first to the sixth floor and will live in triple-sharing rooms with attached washrooms.
- A designated common space on the ground floor may be used for studying and discussions.

- Vihara is shared with University guests. Students will have access only to the student side of the building and floors Ground to 6th.
- Students are not permitted to use the stairs or lifts beyond the 6th floor or access the guest section. Accessing guest areas or bringing visitors/non-male residents into the building is a violation of residential norms.

5. Nalanda Residences

Nalanda is a 40-storey building, separated as follows:

- Common floors
 - The ground and first are common floors, housing various common amenities such as general sitting area, discussion tables, and indoor games.
 - Biometric access into the building is located on the ground floor and the first floor.
- Residential floors
 - Floors 2 to 14 house male students
 - Floors 15 to 40 house female students.
 - One wing on the 15th floor is designated for gender neutral students.
- Service floors
 - The basement houses the laundromat, generators and fire safety equipment.
 - The terrace has equipment for hot water, lift maintenance etc. This area is off limits for residents.
- Each residential floor contains twin-sharing rooms, common rooms, a pantry, and shared facilities.
- The ground and first floors are common floors, housing various common amenities such as general sitting areas, discussion tables, and indoor games. Biometric access into the building is located on the ground floor and the first floor.
- Floors 2 to 14 house male students., floors 15 to 40 house female students, one wing on the 15th floor is designated for gender-neutral students.
- The basement houses the laundromat, generators and fire safety equipment.
- The terrace has equipment for hot water, lift maintenance etc. This area is off limits for residents.

6. Room Provisions

- Roommates are allocated randomly by the Residences team. Rooms and roommates will change at the end of each year.
- If your initial allotment was a single room, or if one or more of your roommates have left the university, you may be asked to move to a room with other students, or new roommate(s) may be assigned to your room. These adjustments may take place during the mid-semester or semester breaks, and you will be informed accordingly, keeping in mind that all students residing in Nalanda will be accommodated in twin-sharing rooms and all students residing in Vihara will be accommodated in triple-sharing rooms. Unauthorized switching of rooms or swapping of roommates will be considered a violation.

- Each person in the room will be provided with a cot, a study table and chair, and a lockable cupboard-cum-bookshelf. Mattresses will be provided to you. The cupboard can be locked with your own padlock. A room key will be issued to you at the beginning of the year, and will be collected back at the end of the academic year (you will be charged an amount if you lose the key).
- There is a pantry on one end of each floor in Nalanda that is accessible to students of that floor. The pantry has a water dispenser, an induction stove and a microwave only for light cooking. You are expected to use these responsibly and in a manner that is convenient for all residents of the floor. Vihara has a common pantry on the ground floor.
- Luggage rooms and store rooms are available on each floor in Nalanda. In Vihara, a designated luggage storage space will be available. At the end of the academic year, these facilities may be used to store your luggage until you return.
- There is a laundry service available on the first floor of Nalanda and ground floor of Vihara. You are required to register with the laundry service, and only give your clothes in the bag that is provided to you. Clothes are washed and returned in a dry condition in the same bag, usually five days after they are given. The laundry service is not extended for underclothes and socks.

7. Access Regulations

- Only students residing on campus and members registered and staying in Nalanda or Vihara will have access to the building.
- It is compulsory to use the biometrics system while moving in and out of the building. This is particularly important as every situation that involves your safety and security within the building relies on this system.
- Guests, visitors, parents, guardians and day scholars do not have access to the building beyond the biometrics gates. There will be no exceptions made under any circumstances.
- The residential floors within Nalanda are divided into gender-neutral, female and male sections. You are allowed only on the floors and common rooms that fall under the section that you belong to. Accessing floors not assigned to your section will be considered as cross access.
- The basement and terrace are strictly off limits for students, as is the use of the service elevator.
- Please note that corridors may be accessed by vendors, workers and others for specific reasons. You will be given prior information, unless there is an emergency.
- Cross access - entering floors not assigned to your section, is a violation of residential norms and may result in disciplinary action.
- Construction of other structures on campus will continue. These construction zones will be clearly marked and any changes will be communicated by email. It is of utmost importance that you do not enter any construction zone.

8. University Culture

When you graduate from this University, we hope you will be “educated” in the widest sense — not just knowledgeable and skilled, but also emotionally mature, unafraid to remain curious, and a responsible citizen. Creating this kind of environment requires students and members to work together so everyone can grow and succeed.

Any space where people live and work together is guided by norms, regulations, and rules. Norms are informal expectations shaped by values, customs, and traditions, while rules and regulations are formal expectations enforced within a community. While we reside in a co-living space, it is important we maintain respect and harmony.

The code of conduct, norms, rules, and regulations apply the same to students residing at Vihara and Nalanda. Read it carefully and be aware of the rules on campus.

9. Norms

We expect that you will:

9.1 Well-being and Peer Support

- Work towards your own well-being, and contribute to the well-being of others.
- Talk to someone if something is bothering you, and listen to others when they need support.
- Be mindful of how your peers are feeling, even when they do not speak up.
- Stay active and encourage your peers to do the same.

9.2 Engaging with Diverse Ideas and People

- Engage with different ideas and get to know people.
- Spend time with your peers and teachers and learn from their experiences.
- Read, watch, and listen to things you haven't explored before, and share your experiences with others.
- Talk openly about similarities and differences, and reflect on your own beliefs and values.

9.3 Initiative and Participation

- Take initiative.
- Organise activities and clubs with others.
- Participate in workshops, seminars, and events.

9.4 Respectful Conduct

- Be respectful, kind, and fair to all members of the University community.
- Treat people the way you would like to be treated, and be aware of how your actions affect others.
- Resolve differences through dialogue and negotiation. Even in disagreement, be civil, friendly, and respectful, especially towards security, housekeeping, support staff, and other members of the university.

9.5 Hygiene and Cleanliness

- Ensure you throw waste in the correct dustbins: Wet Waste, Dry Waste, and Sanitary Waste.
- Please do not throw any objects or waste outside the windows, as this may cause inconvenience or safety concerns for others.

- Maintain cleanliness in washrooms, pantries, common rooms, corridors, and your rooms. Cleaning up after individual use is a must.

10. Regulations

As a resident, you are required to follow certain regulations which are important for proper functioning of the residences. These regulations are not just guidelines — you are required to adhere to these and not doing so may invite disciplinary action.

10.1 REST App, Curfew, Biometrics, and Nights Out

- Residents must remain on campus between 11 PM and 5:30 AM.
- Entry and exit must happen only through biometric gates.
- In case you might be arriving late, you are to keep Residences informed via email before 9 PM. Recurring late arrivals will account for violations of the campus norms.
- If you are staying out of the campus for a night or more, it is mandatory to raise a request on the REST app 24 hours prior. This information is shared with your guardians/parents if you are a UG student.
- In case of an emergency, please email Residences and mark your parents/guardians as well if you are a UG student. PG students are also required to raise REST app requests and do not need to mark their parents/guardians.

10.2 WhatsApp, Email, and App Communication

The Residences team will share important communication over email and WhatsApp. It is important for you to not ignore these communications and to actively respond during crisis situations and drills.

10.3 Mid-Semester and Semester Breaks

Students are expected to return home during breaks unless approved to stay back under academic exceptions.

10.4 CCTV Usage

- CCTV cameras are installed in critical areas, including residential corridors and lifts.
- Footage may be reviewed in emergencies or disciplinary situations. However, in case of missing items, footage will not be checked. Kindly be mindful of your belongings and always keep your rooms locked.
- In case you require the University to look into a missing item case, you will be required to file an FIR.
- If someone is found taking someone else's belongings without consent, they will directly be reported to the Disciplinary Committee.

10.5 Vehicle Regulations

- Vehicles are not allowed inside the Nalanda building. In case the vehicle needs to come near Nalanda or Vihara for medical or luggage purposes, please seek prior approval from the security team.
- UG students are discouraged from keeping motorised vehicles.
- Cycles must be parked in designated areas outside the building.

- PG students may keep vehicles only in the designated parking area outside Campus Gate 1.

10.6 Pets Policy

- Pets and animals are not allowed inside the residence building, including fish and insects.
- Campus animals must also not be brought inside residences.

10.7 Cleanliness Regulations

- Students are responsible for cleaning their own rooms.
- Do not ask housekeeping staff to clean inside rooms.
- Maintain hygiene in bathrooms, pantries, corridors, common rooms, and rooms.
- Dispose sanitary pads only in designated bins.
- Keep footwear inside rooms and avoid dirtying corridors. Corridors need to be kept free as they are accessed during emergency evacuations.
- Pantry spaces must be kept clean by residents.
- Heavy cooking, pressure cookers, mixers, and unsafe appliances are not allowed in pantries.
- Segregate waste responsibly into dry and wet waste bins. Do not throw anything out of windows.

10.8 Silent Hours

- Silent hours are from 11 PM to 6 AM. Celebrations, loud music, or events cannot take place during silent hours.
- Common rooms remain open, but residents are expected to maintain silence during these hours.

10.9 Room Regulations

- Unsafe or heavy electrical appliances such as irons, kettles, induction stoves, refrigerators, washing machines, and coolers are not allowed.
- Inflammable items such as candles, diyas, agarbattis, cigarettes, and alcohol are prohibited. In high-rise buildings, these become a safety hazard.
- Electronic devices should generally be limited to laptops and phones.
- Do not paste, paint, or draw on walls. Decorations should be removable without damage.
- Fairy lights and similar lighting are not permitted due to fire risks.
- Do not keep loose items near windows or on windowsills.
- Furniture is tagged to each room, and charges may apply for damages or missing items during asset check.

10.10 Surprise Checks

Resident Mentors or other competent authorities may check your room or belongings (including bags) if there is reason to suspect possession of illicit substances. Periodic surprise checks may be conducted on the floors as part of routine safety and compliance measures. No prior information will be given in these cases.

10.11 Violations and Disciplinary Action

Being complicit in or facilitating any major or severe violation is also considered a major violation. Not responding to official emails or calls for meetings from the RMs will also be considered a violation.

The Student Affairs team is empowered to issue orders of 'suspension pending inquiry' if it is assessed that the offender is likely to cause disruption/disorder, influence witnesses, or potentially destroy or tamper with evidence. The order will involve suspension from the residences with immediate effect.

11. Coordinating Residential Life

11.1 REST App

The MyCampus app contains a facilities help app to raise infrastructure related requests and also contains the REST app that helps you raise stay out requests. You are to download this app and use it.

Web link: <https://catalyst.azimpremjifoundation.org/s/>

11.2 WhatsApp Groups

- All residents are required to join the official WhatsApp community group to receive important updates and emergency communication from the RMs, IMF, or IT teams. Details will be shared during residence check-in.
- Residents must also join the WhatsApp group for their assigned floor, managed by the floor coordinators, for floor-related communication and emergency updates. Joining both groups is mandatory.

11.3 Stakeholders in Residential Life

Members Involved in Coordinating Residential Life :

- Resident Mentors: Resident Mentors (RMs) live full-time at the residences, and coordinate all aspects of the residential experience - positive engagement, cultural activities, wellbeing support, community-building, student support, administration, and enforcing of rules. They do not look into infrastructure or security related issues.
- Floor Coordinators: A group of students are tasked with resolving community problems on the floors - both proactively and by responding to conflict and emergencies.
- Infrastructure Management Function (IMF)/ Facilities team: IMF staff work closely with RMs and students to oversee the provision, maintenance, and security of facilities. Some members of this function will be available at the residences during working hours (9:30 AM to 5:00 PM).
- Security team: Security can be accessed on the ground floor in case of urgent matters including facility related urgencies.
- Medical Team: The first aid room provides first aid and nursing care 24/7.
- You: Being a part of this community you are also responsible to contribute and make the environment a better space for yourself and others around you.

12. Important Contacts

12.1 Resident Mentors

The Resident Mentors are the main coordinators at the residences. They can be contacted by email (residences@apu.edu.in) or by phone (7899919677). Please expect a response time of 24 hours for email. The phone can be contacted between 9 AM and 9 PM, unless it is an emergency. The RMs must not be contacted on their personal phones.

12.2 Facilities Team

In case there are any infrastructure related issues, the IMF/Facilities team can be contacted via the MyCampus app. In case there is no resolution, you can reach out to nalanda.facilityconcerns@apu.edu.in.

12.3 Security Team

The security team can be contacted via email (security@apu.edu.in). For any vehicle entry, write to the security team. For guest entry, please seek permission from the Registrar office and security team with prior notice. Guest visit timings are from 9:30 AM to 5:00 PM.

12.4 General Emergencies

The university-wide emergency number is 9606668855. This number is manned 24/7 and can be contacted for any type of emergency. You can also access the mail room near Gate 2 which also acts as the lost and found location.

12.5 Medical Emergencies

In case of any medical emergency, please immediately contact the Medical Room phone (7022139139). Please do not attempt to treat or start first aid without the guidance of the medical team. The medical room can be contacted via email (medical@apu.edu.in) or via phone 24/7.

12.6 Mental Health Support

In case of mental health emergencies, counselors from Your Dost are available online 24/7 at <https://yourdost.com/>. The conversations team (conversations@apu.edu.in) may be contacted on an appointment basis for offline support.

13. Fire and Safety Protocols

It is of utmost importance that you follow all fire related/safety protocols listed below. Please read the following points very carefully and commit the procedures to memory.

In case you notice a fire or smoke within the building, please follow the steps below:

1. Alert the general emergency number (9606668855), specifying the exact location of the fire (floor number, room number etc.). Information about the size and nature of the fire will be helpful if you are able to provide it.
2. Alert those immediately around you, without causing panic. Some locations have a fire alarm that can be activated with the instructions printed on the alarm.

3. If you are trained to use the extinguishers, use them to put out the fire.
4. Use the closest emergency staircase to exit the building and retreat to the nearest safe assembly area.
5. Only in the event that none of the staircases can be used to go down and exit the building, proceed to the nearest Fire Refuge Area (floors 7,11,16,21,26,31,36).
6. If you are at Vihara, you can use the student fire exit side or the middle staircase to evacuate the building and assemble outside.
7. If you are a floor coordinator, use the floor group to ensure that everybody on the floor is safely out of the building. Report any significant updates to the RMs through the coordinator group.

Please keep the following in mind:

1. There are smoke detectors and sprinkler systems across the building. These are connected to a central fire emergency system, with visual and auditory alarms etc. All buildings are also equipped with fire extinguishers, hydrants, and assembly areas. You are expected to mandatorily take part in fire drills conducted every semester.
2. Familiarize yourself with the buildings and spaces that you commonly use. You should know the location of the nearest staircase, fire extinguishers etc. Each floor of every building has the fire escape route and floor plan displayed clearly.
3. Do not use the lift in an emergency.
4. Do not attempt to douse the fire or use the fire extinguishers unless you have been specifically trained.
5. Do not attempt to move people who are injured or people with special needs, unless you have been trained. Without training, you may cause them further harm. Trained personnel will help them out of the building.

Student Grievance Redressal Policy

Updated: May 2026

Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru

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Introduction

Azim Premji University strives to ensure that students' concerns about issues affecting them are attended to through a wide range of statutory bodies and functions with defined timelines and protocols. These mechanisms are meant to respond to student concerns within a timeframe. They are also revised from time to time. However, sometimes there may be issues that these processes are unable to resolve adequately or there may be challenges in adherence to these processes. The University is setting up a Student Grievance Redressal Committee (SGRC) to address the above.

Definitions

Before we delve into the policy in detail, here are the basic definitions used to differentiate between meanings of terms generally used interchangeably.

Request for Action: A request for action is a formal request made by a student to functions in the university about issues for which remedial responses should be taken up through a Response Protocol (defined below) and a satisfactory resolution of the same can be reached as part of the normal functioning of the relevant function.

For instance, a lightbulb not working in the room is a request for action, to be acted upon by the Facilities team

Complaint: A complaint is a formal expression of dissatisfaction arising due to deviation from the response protocol or expected norms of behaviour in the University, registered with the related function. The function in turn is expected to review the complaint and follow the response protocol by invoking the appropriate protocols that apply to the situation for addressing the issue.

For example, a student may have contacted their course instructor requesting for grades for an assignment. If the course instructor doesn't respond to the student's request, the student can raise a complaint with the Programme Coordinator about the delay in receiving the grade.

Grievance: A grievance is a formal complaint against a listed function of the university for not complying with its own timelines and protocols or with the rules and regulations of the University. A situation when an existing complaint is not resolved within the committed timeline by the internal systems within the function which is supposed to address the complaint/concern, gives rise to a grievance. The internal mechanisms for resolving complaints within student-facing functions of the university are provided in Appendix 1.

Take the example of a student who finds her roommate engaging in activities which are not allowed by the University according to the Code of Conduct. The student complains about the roommate with the resident mentors. If the resident mentors fail to respond with a decision in a timely manner, the student would go with the complaint to Student Affairs. If Student Affairs also fails to respond in a timely manner or refuses to act as per their own protocols, the student would register the complaint to the final authority as mentioned in Appendix A. If the grievance is still not resolved, students can raise it to the SGRC.

The SGRC accepts only grievances (as defined above) and would not take up complaints or requests for action addressed to the various functions of the University. The SGRC would not be an appellate authority meant to take up appeals against the decisions taken by other bodies. Further, the SGRC would not accept appeals against decisions of the faculty regarding grades or of the POSH or disciplinary committees.

Response Protocol: When a request for action or a complaint is raised by a student to any function of the University, a general response protocol has to be followed. This protocol includes an acknowledgment and communication of timelines to be followed for processing the request/complaint, within two working days of receiving the request for action/complaint.

Student Grievance Redressal Committee (SGRC)

The Student Grievance Redressal Committee aims to address student grievances that indicate:

a) lapses or non-compliance with the internal timelines and protocols of the various functions and committees of the University

or

b) any action initiated/ taken that goes against the declared policies of the University.

Scope: The SGRC will register only those complaints which are raised by students currently enrolled in the University. SGRC is not intended to be an appellate authority or platform for appealing against decisions taken by other committees, offices or functions of the University, such as the POSH Committee, Disciplinary Committee, various academic committees, etc. When grievances are received about functions and committees listed in Appendix 1, SGRC's role is limited to verification of responsiveness and compliance with protocols developed by the functions themselves.

For instance, if the placement committee has a policy to not allow students to register for placements after a deadline due to which a student's late application for registration is rejected, the student cannot appeal against the decision of the placement committee with the SGRC.

Basic Principles of the Grievance System

1. **Awareness:** Students should know what is a grievance (as distinct from a request for action or a complaint), and where and how to raise it.
2. **Acknowledgement:** Every grievance should be acknowledged and issued a grievance number within 24 hours of submitting the grievance.
3. **Redressal:** Attempt will be made by the SGRC to resolve grievances within 30 days of receiving the complaint to SGRC and the student will be informed if it takes longer.
4. **Anonymity:** Students will be requested consent for the disclosure of their identity outside of SGRC. The consent will be sought at the time of registering the grievance from students. Disclosure of identity will be made only when it is deemed essential for addressing their grievance"

Functioning of the SGRC

A. Types of grievances handled by SGRC

The SGRC will review only two types of grievances.

a. Issues related to the functioning of existing systems or processes, in committees and functions mentioned in Appendix 1.

In case a student has raised a request for action with a specific function but has not received an appropriate response, the student may then raise the issue with the SGRC. In such instances, the SGRC checks whether the concerned function provided timely responses (responsiveness) and appropriate responses (based on the response protocol). If these response protocols weren't followed or the grievance wasn't addressed in a timely manner, the SGRC would recommend suitable action. If required, the SGRC may conduct a process audit of the relevant protocols.

b. Grievances for which there are no designated bodies would directly fall within the ambit of the SGRC.

There might be grievances raised by students that do not fall in the ambit of any existing bodies or functions of the University. While these grievances are registered by the SGRC, they will be reported to the Registrar to be included in the operations of related functions.

In effect, the SGRC serves two essential functions:

1. It serves to ensure students that they are being heard and to assure them that they can approach an independent committee with their issues and be certain to get a timely and detailed response.
2. It serves as a feedback system for the University.

SGRC would collate information on the type and frequency of issues faced by students and provide feedback to the administration on the responsiveness and compliance to protocols by the various functions in the University.

B. Constitution of SGRC

The SGRC consists of two entities: a) the Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC), headed by a Convener and assisted by a coordinator, and b) an Ombudsperson.

The GRC will consist of 3 members of the University and a student representative.

The details of the SGRC is given below:

SGRC email id: sgrc.blr@apu.edu.in

Members of SGRC :

Member	Role
Mukta Gundi	SGRC coordinator
Santonu Goswami	SGRC coordinator

Kalyani Sekhar	SGRC convenor
S. Giridhar	Ombudsperson

The link for the SGRC policy, composition of the committee and the link for the online grievance registration portal will be published on the university website.

Processes for registration of grievances

Students can record their grievances using the Google form link [Grievance redressal form](#) . Upon receipt, an acknowledgement, along with a grievance number will be shared with students for tracking purposes.

Review and Investigation of cases

When students submit grievances to the SGRC, depending on the grievance, the coordinator would respond in the following ways:

a. When students raise a grievance related to a particular function/position with the function in the University (mentioned in Appendix 1)

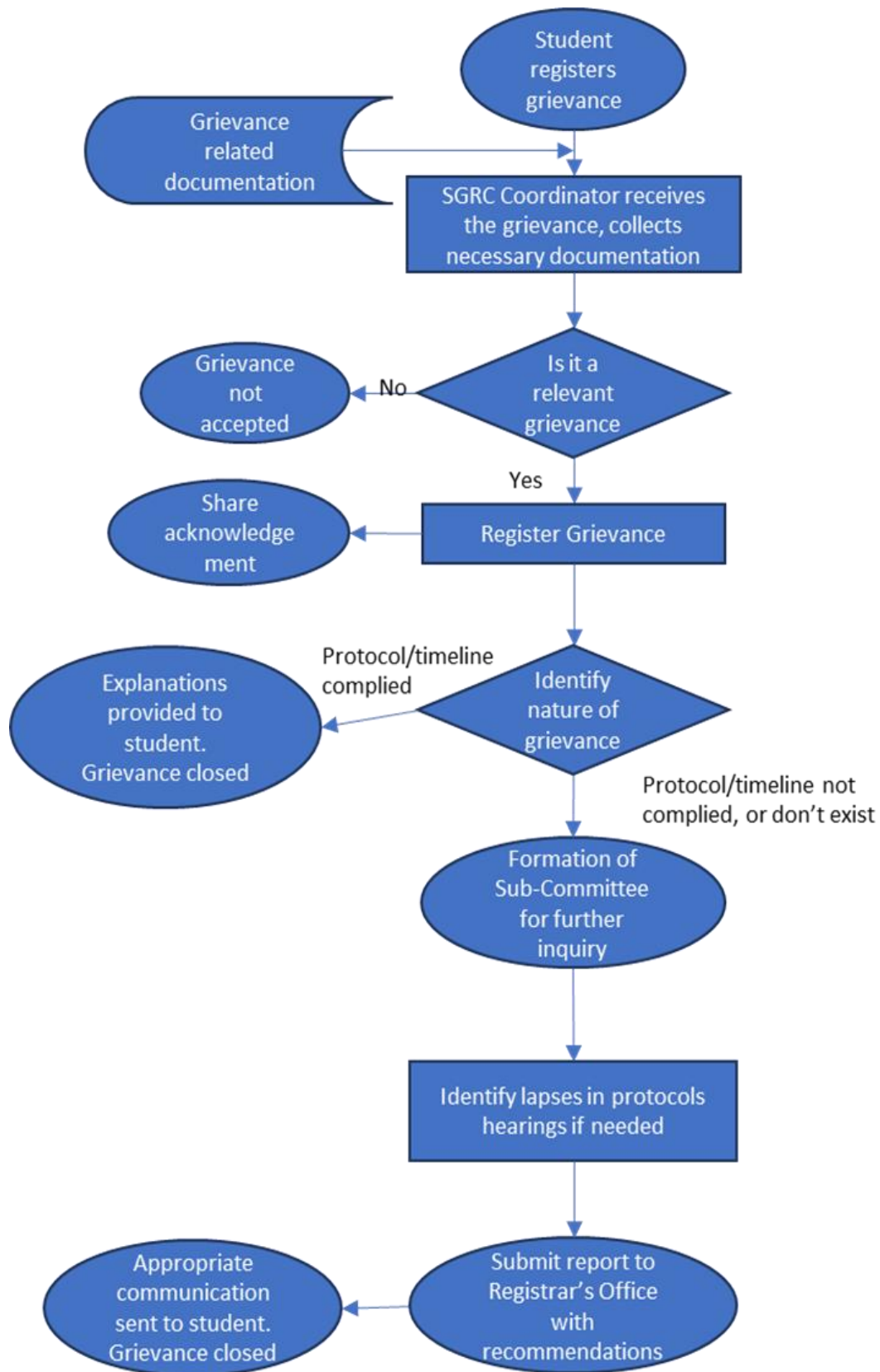
- Cases where timelines or protocols are not being violated:** When a student files a grievance, the coordinator would need to determine whether there has been a violation of existing protocols and timelines or values of the University or not. If the coordinator finds no violation of protocols and timelines without having to thoroughly explore the case, the same can be communicated to students and the case can be closed. Such cases will be closed within 7 working days of accepting a grievance for action.
- Cases which require investigation:** When a grievance is raised in which it is not clear if protocols and timelines were adhered to by the University function may need further discussion or investigations. In such a case, the coordinator will recommend to the Convener for formation of a grievance sub-committee for further investigation. The Convener of the SGRC would look at the grievance and decide to form a sub-committee. In such cases, the sub-committees have to be formed within 14 working days of registering a grievance. The sub-committee explores the issue in detail, reviews the protocols followed, conducts meetings if necessary with the student and the concerned function. Based on this, it determines if protocols were adhered to or not. The findings on the adherence/ violations of the protocols are prepared and submitted to the Convener of the SGRC for review. The sub-committees have to submit their findings to the SGRC within 15 working days of formation of the sub-committee.

The Convener and the GRC review the findings and approve the findings if deemed fit or ask the GRC to investigate further. The final report of the GRC will be submitted to the Registrar for decision and action.

Once the decision or action is taken by the registrar, the GRC coordinator will inform the student of the same.

b. Grievances that are not addressed by existing functions: The coordinator of GRC has to first verify that the grievance raised is valid and that no function handles the issue raised. Such a grievance would be recommended by the coordinator to be taken up for further investigation by the GRC. The GRC and the Convener would decide to either report such a case to the Registrar with a recommendation within 30 working days of receiving the grievance. The students will be informed about the recommendations made by the SGRC.

The flow-chart below provides a pictorial representation of the grievance redressal process described above.



Appeals on the findings of GRC

The GRC will provide its report on grievances and findings together with recommendations, if any, to the Registrar and decisions in regard to the findings of the SGRC are to be taken by the Registrar.

Any student not in agreement to the findings of the SGRC may appeal to the Ombudsperson, provided the student has availed all other remedies provided for students under the existing University processes and regulations. The Ombudsperson shall investigate the issue in consultation with the GRC and submit a recommendation to the University.

Appendix 1: List of functions/schools/offices

Function/School/Office	First point of contact for complaints	Intermediary levels for resolving complaints	Final level of resolving complaints within the function
Student Affairs	Members of Student Affairs studentaffairs@apu.edu.in	Program Manager (Operations) vishnu.vijayakumar@apu.edu.in	Convenor of Student affairs sumithra.unni@apu.edu.in
Student affairs - Residences	Resident Mentors residences@apu.edu.in	Program Manager – Residences ankita.bharadwaj@apu.edu.in	Convenor of Student affairs sumithra.unni@apu.edu.in
Student affairs - Sports and Fitness Committee	Sports Facilitator/Coordinator sfc@apu.edu.in	Student Affairs In-Charge (Sports) manikanta.m@apu.edu.in	Head of Sports in Student Affairs arvind.b@apu.edu.in
Student affairs - Food Committee	Food Committee Members foodcom@apu.edu.in	Student Affairs In-Charge (Food) manikanta.m@apu.edu.in	Head of Food in Student Affairs deepa.e@apu.edu.in
Medical facilities	Members of Health Committee health.wellness@apu.edu.in	Student Affairs In-Charge (Health) zoha.fatima@apu.edu.in	Convenor of Student affairs sumithra.unni@apu.edu.in
Program Office	Programme Office in-charge of respective	Programme Coordinator	Head, PO

	programmes madev.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in maedu.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in sas.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in mecce.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in itep.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in msecs.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in mba.programmeoffice@apu.edu.in	sarbani.sharma@apu.edu.in (PC, MAD) vijitha.rajana@apu.edu.in (PC, MAE) shalini.srinivasan@apu.edu.in , murthy.ovsn@apu.edu.in (PC, SAS) alex.thomas@apu.edu.in (P C, MAEco), sofiya.s@apu.edu.in(PC, MA ECCE) anand.kurien@apu.edu.in (P C, ITEP) santonu.goswami@apu.edu.in (PC, MSc CCS) gopi.sankar@apu.edu.in (PC, MBA in Development)	shameer.cp@apu.edu.in
Student Help Desk	Student Helpdesk studenthelpdesk@apu.edu.in	Member, Student Helpdesk Sushmita Baruah sushmita.baruah@apu.edu.in	Head, Student Helpdesk cheryl.joseph@apu.edu.in
IT Help Desk	IT Help Desk it-helpdesk@apu.edu.in IThelpdesk@apu.edu.in	Member, IT Functions at the University manjunath.ks@apu.edu.in	Head, IT Functions at the University sowmya.swarup@apu.edu.in
Facilities	Members of the Facilities team contacted via the Catalyst app.	Coordinators in-charge of specific sub-functions of IMF chandrakumar.a@azimpremjifoundation.org - Campus facilities victor.raj@azimpremjifoundation.org - Residence facilities	Head, IMF rishikesh@apu.edu.in

Placements Office	Members of the Placements Office studentplacements@apu.edu.in	Lead, Placements Office sudha.hariharan@apu.edu.in	Head, Admissions, Placements and Alumni manikandan.v@apu.edu.in
Alumni Office	Members of the Alumni Office alumnioffice@apu.edu.in	Lead, Alumni Office falguni@apu.edu.in	Head , Admissions, Placements and Alumni manikandan.v@apu.edu.in
Admissions Office	Members of the Admissions Office admissions@apu.edu.in	Lead – Admissions Office sharmistha.sikdar@apu.edu.in	Head, Admissions, Placements and Alumni manikandan.v@apu.edu.in
Library	Library team members library@apu.edu.in	Member, KRC praveena.cs@apu.edu.in	Head, KRC reshmi@apu.edu.in

SUMMARY OF UGC REGULATIONS ON CURBING THE MENACE OF RAGGING IN HIGHER EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS, 2009.

1. **PREAMBLE:** In view of the directions of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in the matter of "University of Kerala v/s. Council, Principals, Colleges and others" in SLP no. 24295 of 2006 dated 16.05.2007 and that dated 8.05.2009 in Civil Appeal number 887 of 2009, and in consideration of the determination of the Central Government and the University Grants Commission to prohibit, prevent and eliminate the scourge of ragging.
2. **OBJECTIVE:** To eliminate ragging in all its forms from universities, deemed universities and other higher educational institutions in the country by prohibiting it under these Regulations, preventing its occurrence and punishing those who indulge in ragging as provided for in these Regulations and the appropriate law in force.
3. **WHAT CONSTITUTES RAGGING:** Ragging constitutes one or more of any of the following acts:
 - a) Any conduct by any student or students whether by words spoken or written or by an act which has the effect of teasing,

treating or handling with rudeness a fresher or any other student.

- b) Indulging in rowdy or indisciplined activities by any student or students which causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship, physical or psychological harm or to raise fear or apprehension thereof in any fresher or any other student.
- c) Asking any student to do any act which such student will not in the ordinary course do and which has the effect of causing or generating a sense of shame, or torment or embarrassment so as to adversely affect the physique or psyche of such fresher or any other student.
- d) Any act by a senior student that prevents, disrupts or disturbs the regular academic activity of any other student or a fresher.
- e) Exploiting the services of a fresher or any other student for completing the academic tasks assigned to an individual or a group of students.
- f) Any act of financial extortion or forceful expenditure burden put on a fresher or any other student by students
- g) Any act of physical abuse including all variants of it: sexual abuse, homosexual assaults, stripping, forcing obscene and lewd acts, gestures, causing bodily harm or any other danger to health or person;
- h) Any act or abuse by spoken words, emails, post, public insults which would also include deriving perverted pleasure, vicarious or sadistic thrill from actively or passively participating in the discomfiture to fresher or any other student.

- i) Any act that affects the mental health and self-confidence of a fresher or any other student with or without an intent to derive a sadistic pleasure or showing off power, authority or superiority by a student over any fresher or any other student.

4. MEASURES FOR PROHIBITION OF RAGGING:

There are a number of such measures at institution level, University Level, District level etc. Some of them that are important for students to know are as follows:

- No institution shall permit or condone any reported incident of ragging in any form; and all institutions shall take all necessary and required measures, including but not limited to the provisions of these Regulations, to achieve the objective of eliminating ragging, within the institution or outside.
- All institutions shall take action in accordance with these Regulations against those found guilty of ragging and/or abetting ragging, actively or passively, or being part of a conspiracy to promote ragging.
- Every public declaration of intent by any institution, in any electronic, audiovisual or print or any other media, for admission of students to any course of study shall expressly provide that ragging is totally prohibited in the institution, and anyone found guilty of ragging and/or abetting ragging, whether actively or passively, or being a part of a conspiracy to promote ragging, is liable to be punished in accordance with these Regulations as well as under the provisions of any penal law for the time being in force.

- The telephone numbers of the Anti-Ragging Helpline and all the important functionaries in the institution, including but not limited to the Head of the institution, faculty members, members of the Anti-Ragging Committees and Anti-Ragging Squads, District and Sub-Divisional authorities, Wardens of hostels, and other functionaries or authorities where relevant, shall be published in the brochure of admission/instruction booklet or the prospectus.
- The application for admission, enrolment or registration must be accompanied by an Anti Ragging affidavit signed by a student in a prescribed format and another Anti Ragging Affidavit signed by a Parent/Guardian. *(Both these Affidavits can be downloaded from the Web)*
- Any distress message received at the Anti-Ragging Helpline shall be simultaneously relayed to the Head of the Institution, the Warden of the Hostels, the Nodal Officer of the affiliating University, if the incident reported has taken place in an institution affiliated to a University, the concerned District authorities and if so required, the District Magistrate, and the Superintendent of Police, and shall also be web enabled so as to be in the public domain simultaneously for the media and citizens to access it.
- On receipt of the recommendation of the Anti Ragging Squad or on receipt of any information concerning any reported incident of ragging, the Head of institution shall immediately determine if a case under the penal laws is made out and if so, either on his own or through a member of the Anti-Ragging

Committee authorised by him in this behalf, proceed to file a First Information Report (FIR), within twenty four hours of receipt of such information or recommendation, with the police and local authorities, under the appropriate penal provisions.

- The Commission shall maintain an appropriate data base to be created out of affidavits, affirmed by each student and his/her parents/guardians and stored electronically by the institution, either on its or through an agency to be designated by it; and such database shall also function as a record of ragging complaints received, and the status of the action taken thereon.
- The Commission shall include a specific condition in the Utilization Certificate, in respect of any financial assistance or grants-in-aid to any institution under any of the general or special schemes of the Commission, that the institution has complied with the anti-ragging measures.
- Any incident of ragging in an institution shall adversely affect its accreditation, ranking or grading by NAAC or by any other authorised accreditation agencies while assessing the institution for accreditation, ranking or grading purposes.
- The Commission may accord priority in financial grants-in-aid to those institutions, otherwise eligible to receive grants under section 12B of the Act, which report a blemishless record in terms of there being no reported incident of ragging.

5. ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION IN THE EVENT OF

RAGGING: The institution shall punish a student found guilty of ragging after following the

procedure and in the manner prescribed here in under:

- The Anti-Ragging Committee of the institution shall take an appropriate decision, in regard to punishment or otherwise, depending on the facts of each incident of ragging and nature and gravity of the incident of ragging established in the recommendations of the Anti-Ragging Squad.
- The Anti-Ragging Committee may, depending on the nature and gravity of the guilt established by the Anti-Ragging Squad, award, to those found guilty, one or more of the following punishments, namely;
 - a) Suspension from attending classes and academic privileges.
 - b) Withholding/ withdrawing scholarship/ fellowship and other benefits.
 - c) Debarring from appearing in any test/ examination or other evaluation process.
 - d) Withholding results.
 - e) Debarring from representing the institution in any regional, national or international meet, tournament, youth festival, etc.
 - f) Suspension/ expulsion from the hostel.
 - g) Cancellation of admission.
 - h) Rustication from the institution for period ranging from one to four semesters.
 - i) Expulsion from the institution and consequent debarring from admission to any other institution for a specified period.

- Provided that where the persons committing or abetting the act of ragging are not identified, the institution shall resort to collective punishment.
- An appeal against the order of punishment by the Anti-Ragging Committee shall lie, (i) in case of an order of an institution, affiliated to or constituent part, of a University, to the Vice-Chancellor of the University; (ii) in case of an order of a University, to its Chancellor. (iii) in case of an institution of national importance created by an Act of Parliament, to the Chairman or Chancellor of the institution, as the case may be.
- Where in the opinion of the appointing authority, a lapse is attributable to any member of the faculty or staff of the institution, in the matter of reporting or taking prompt action to prevent an incident of ragging or who display an apathetic or insensitive attitude towards complaints of ragging, or who fail to take timely steps, whether required under these Regulations or otherwise, to prevent an incident or incidents of ragging, then such authority shall initiate departmental disciplinary action, in accordance with the prescribed procedure of the institution, against such member of the faculty or staff. Provided that where such lapse is attributable to the Head of the institution, the authority designated to appoint such Head shall take such departmental disciplinary action; and such action shall be without prejudice to any action that may be taken under the penal laws for abetment of ragging for failure to take timely steps in the prevention of ragging or punishing any student found guilty of ragging.

INFORMATION EDUCATION COMMUNICATION (IEC)
GUIDELINES FOR COUNCILS, UNIVERSITIES & COLLEGES
Curbing the Menace of Ragging



INFORMATION EDUCATION COMMUNICATION (IEC)

GUIDELINES FOR COUNCILS, UNIVERSITIES & COLLEGES

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www.ugc.ac.in

www.antiragging.in and www.c4yindia.org



www.c4yindia.org



www.antiragging.in



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ABBREVIATIONS

ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police	INC	Indian Nursing Council
AICTE	All India Council of Technical Education	IT	Information Technology
ARC	Anti-Ragging Committee	MCI	Medical Council of India
ASP	Assistant Superintendent of Police	NCRI	National Council for Rural Institutes
BCI	Bar Council of India	NCTE	National Council for Teacher Education
C4Y	Centre for Youth	PCI	Pharmacy Council of India
CCH	Central Council of Homeopathy	RCI	Rehabilitation Council of India
CCIM	Central Council for Indian Medicine	SCHE	State Councils of Higher Education
COA	Council of Architecture	SHO	Station House Officer
DCI	Dental Council of India	SP	Superintendent of Police
DCP	Deputy Commissioner of Police	SPC	Statutory Professional Councils
FAQ	Frequently Asked Question	SSP	Senior Superintendent of Police
ICAR	Indian Council for Agricultural Research	UGC	University Grants Commission
IEC	Information Education Communication		

RAGGING MENACE

Ragging is a disturbing reality in the higher education system of our country. Despite the fact that over the years, ragging has claimed hundreds of innocent lives and has ruined the careers of thousands of bright students, the practice is still perceived by many as a way of 'familiarisation' and an 'initiation into the real world' for young college-going students.

The Ragging is defined as any disorderly conduct, whether by words spoken or written or by an act, has the effect of teasing, treating, or handling with rudeness a fresher or a junior student. Indulging in a rowdy or undisciplined activity that causes or is likely to cause annoyance, hardship, or psychological harm or to raise fear or apprehension thereof in a fresher or junior student. Asking the students to do any act or perform something that such students will not do in the ordinary course and which has the effect of causing or generating a sense of shame or embarrassment so as to adversely affect the physique or psyche of a fresher or junior student. This can lead to adverse effects such as depression, anxiety, and sometimes even suicide.

Punishment Provisions

Any student or group of students found guilty of ragging on campus or off campus shall be liable to one or more of the following punishments:

- Debarring from appearing in any sessional test/ university examination or withholding results
- Suspension from attending classes and academic privileges
- Withdrawing scholarships and other benefits
- Suspension from the college for a period of one month
- Cancellation of admission
- Debarring from representing the institution in any national or international meet, tournament, youth festival, etc
- Suspension/expulsion from the hostel
- Rustication from the institution for periods varying from 1 to 4 semesters or equivalent period
- Expulsion from the institution and consequent debarring from admission to any other institution
- Fine up to twenty five thousand rupees
- Imprisonment for a term which may extend to two years or with fine which may extend to ten thousand rupees or with both
- Collective punishment - When the students committing or abetting the crime of ragging are not identified, the institution shall resort to collective punishment as a deterrent to ensure community pressure on the potential raggers.

Any institution that fails to take adequate steps to prevent ragging or fails to act in accordance with the Regulations or fails to punish perpetrators or incidents of ragging suitably is liable to the penalties and punishments as per the provisions of the Regulations.

www.antiragging.in/assets/pdf/information/english/what_constitutes_ragging.pdf

www.c4yindia.org/Home/AntiRagging

ZERO TOLERANCE POLICY IN INDIA

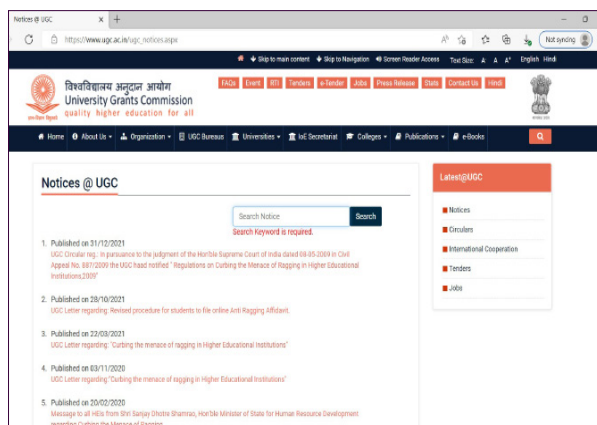
No act of ragging, major or minor, shall go unnoticed. No ragger, male or female, student or non-student, shall go unpunished. No institution that fails to take action against ragging shall be allowed to operate.

The Supreme Court, in its judgement dated 08 May 2009 ordered the implementation of a ragging prevention programme comprising, inter alia, setting up a toll-free anti-ragging helpline/ call center, a database of institutions/ students, and engaging an independent non-government agency as the monitoring agency.

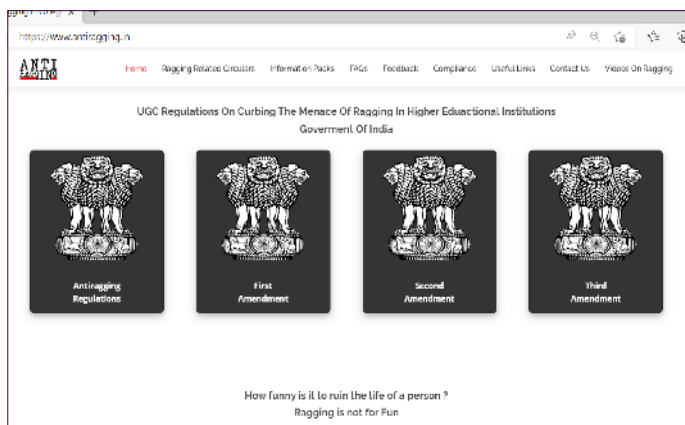
Regulatory provisions and the appropriate law are in force to eliminate ragging in all its forms from the universities, deemed universities and other higher educational institutions in the country by prohibiting, preventing its occurrence and punishing those who indulge in ragging.

UGC Regulations on curbing the menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009

Ragging is a criminal offense and UGC has framed regulations on curbing the menace of ragging in higher educational institutions in order to prohibit, prevent and eliminate the scourge of ragging. In pursuance to the Judgment of the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India dated 08.05.2009 in Civil Appeal No. 887/2009, in exercise of the powers conferred by clause (g) of sub-section (1) of section 26 of the University Grants Commission Act, 1956, the UGC notified "Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009". These regulations are mandatory for all universities/ institutions.



Notices @ UGC
www.ugc.ac.in/ugc_notices.aspx



UGC Regulations
www.antiragging.in/assets/pdf/annexure/Annexure-I.pdf

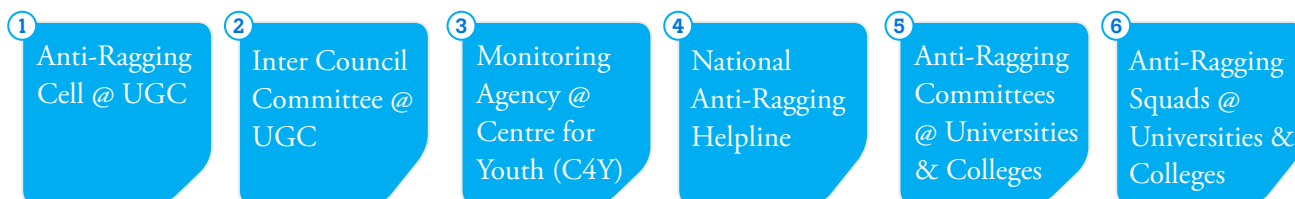
ANTI-RAGGING REGULATORY FRAMEWORK IN INDIA

▶ **Anti-Ragging Monitoring Committee, Ministry of Education, Government of India**

The Anti-Ragging Committee for monitoring measures to prevent ragging in higher educational institutions is constituted in the Ministry of Education, Government of India.

▶ **University Grant Commission (UGC)**

As per the directions of the Government of India, the UGC established the following regulatory framework mechanism to curb the menace of ragging in the country.



▶ **UGC Anti-Raging Cell**

The Anti-Raging Cell within UGC is an instructional mechanism to provide secretarial support for the collection of information, monitoring and to coordinate with the State Level Monitoring Cell and Universities Level Committees for effective implementation of anti-ragging measures. The Cell also coordinates with the Monitoring Agency.

▶ **Inter Council Committee, UGC**

The UGC has constituted an Inter-Council Committee, consisting of representatives of the various Councils and the Monitoring Agency. Such bodies in higher education are to coordinate and monitor the anti-ragging measures in institution across the country and to make recommendations from time to time.

▶ **The National Anti-Ragging Helpline**

The National Anti-Ragging Help Line 24x7 Toll Free number is 1800-180-5522. The support is provided for queries related to ragging, compliant registration, among others.

▶ **Monitoring Agency**

The Centre for Youth (C4Y) is the Monitoring Agency from April 01, 2022 (www.c4yindia.org) to support the National Ragging Prevention Programme in the country. The monitoring agency is working towards:

1. Establishing the National 24x7 Anti-Ragging Helpline
2. Software development (IT) for the operation of the national anti-ragging helpline
3. Development and updating the anti-ragging website (www.antiragging.in) and monitoring agency website (www.c4yindia.org)
4. Building an online reporting mechanism for UGC, councils, universities and colleges
5. Conducting trainings of helpline executives
6. Supervising the performance of the helpline and executives
7. Ensuring efficiency and ease of operations for the national helpline, UGC, colleges, universities, and the students
8. Creating awareness to demote ragging in universities, colleges across India
9. Monitoring of the databases maintained by the commission

▶ **The Councils, Regulatory Bodies**

The 15 councils in India are making collaborative efforts with UGC to address the menace of ragging. They have been issuing directions and monitoring the affiliated universities and colleges for adhering to the regulatory provisions and compliances. They participate in UGC Inter-Council meetings and the Anti-Ragging Monitoring Committee meetings of the Ministry of Education, Government of India for updates and strategies. The councils are:

1. All India Council of Technical Education (AICTE)
2. Bar Council of India (BCI)
3. Council of Architecture (COA)
4. Dental Council of India (DCI)
5. Indian Council for Agricultural Research (ICAR)
6. Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
7. Indian Nursing Council (INC)
8. Mahatma Gandhi National Council of Rural Education (MGNCRE)
9. National Commission for Homoeopathy (NCH)
10. National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM)
11. National Council for Hotel Management & Catering Technology (NCHMCT)
12. National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE)
13. National Medical Commission (NMC)
14. Pharmacy Council of India (PCI)
15. Rehabilitation Council of India (RCI)
16. Sports Authority of India (SAI)
17. Veterinary Council of India (VCI)

▶ **The Anti-Ragging Committee (ARC), Universities and Colleges**

The Anti-Ragging Committee is instituted at each college or university to ensure compliance with the provisions of the regulations as well as the provisions of any law for the time being in force concerning ragging; investigate complaints and also, monitor and oversee the performance of the Anti-Ragging Squad in prevention of ragging in the institution. The Anti-Ragging Committee is responsible for inculcating a culture of Ragging Free Environment on Campus. The Anti-Ragging Committee is involved in designing strategies and action plan for curbing the menace of ragging in the college by adopting an array of activities. The committee is also responsible for conducting awareness programmes from time-to-time on campus.

▶ **Anti-Ragging Squads, Universities and Colleges**

The Anti-Ragging Squad office bearers work under the supervision and guidance of the Anti-Ragging Committee and engage in checking places like hostels, buses, canteens, grounds, classrooms and other places of student congregation to keep a vigil and stop the incidences of ragging, if any, and report them if they happen. The squad role is also to educate the students at large by adopting various means about the menace of ragging and related punishments there to.

► Transparent Complaint Process

Specifically, after registering the complaint, the helpline executives forward it to four Higher Authorities:

University Vice-Chancellor | College Principal | SHO | City SP/SSP/DCP/ASP/ACP | Council

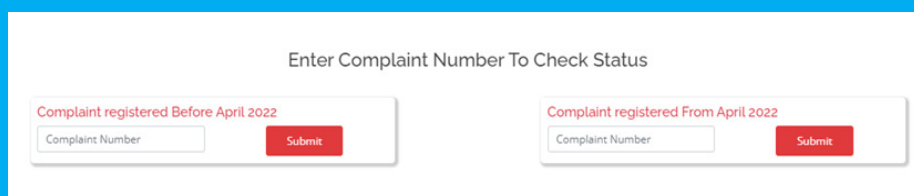
The team at the national helpline undertakes follow-up with the college's Anti-Ragging Committee (ARC) for investigation and ARC report till the satisfaction of the victim/ complainant. The complaint remains active in the helpline until the victim/ complainant is satisfied with the action taken by the authorities. The consent in writing for closing the complaint is taken from the victim/ complainant.

If the case is not resolved to the satisfaction of the victim/ complainant, the national helpline escalates the case to the Monitoring Agency for further action in terms of advice, second opinion, or follow-up by the Monitoring agency itself.

If the complainant is not satisfied with the action taken by the college or the college authorities are not cooperating with the helpline centre, such cases are escalated to the University Grants Commission and the respective council for intervention.

There is an online management system set up in the UGC premises for UGC to act on the complaints that have been escalated to UGC. Any actions in terms of writing a letter, email, phone calls etc. are being logged into the case file of the respective complaint. The case file is also visible to the victim/ complainant - www.ugc.ac.in

The status of the complaint with complete follow-up can be accessed at the link below with specific complaint number:



Enter Complaint Number To Check Status

Complaint registered Before April 2022

Complaint Number

Complaint registered From April 2022

Complaint Number

www.antiragging.in

Note: The helpline NEVER discloses the identity of the victim without their permission and consent.

Ragging Complaints Registration

The students in distress due to ragging-related incidents can contact National Anti-Ragging Helpline 1800-180-5522 (24x7 Toll Free) or e-mail to helpline@antiragging.in.

Or

They may also contact UGC Monitoring Agency i.e. Centre for Youth (C4Y) at antiragging@c4yindia.org or 011-41619005 or 98180 44577 (only in case of emergency).

IMPORTANT LINKS FOR THE STUDENTS, COLLEGES, UNIVERSITIES AND COUNCILS

▶ Students and Parents Undertaking Affidavit

In compliance of the second amendment in UGC Regulations, it is compulsory for each student and every parent to submit an online Anti-Ragging undertaking affidavit every academic year. The universities and colleges are also requested to implement the revised procedure for students to file online Anti-Ragging affidavits. The student will receive an e-mail with her/ his registration number. The student will forward that e-mail to the Nodal officer in her/ his university/college e-mail. (Please note that the student will not receive pdf affidavits and she/ he is not required to print & sign it as it used to be in the earlier case).

Link to fill out the online undertaking affidavit by students and parents:

www.antiragging.in/affidavit_registration_disclaimer.html | www.c4yindia.org/Home/Undertaking

▶ Ragging Complaints Registration

The complaints of ragging are being registered through the following means:

1. Via e-mail: helpline@antiragging.in
2. National Anti-Ragging Help Line: 1800-180-5522. 24x7 Toll Free Number
3. Suo Motto via Social Media platforms, news, reporters, influencers, social workers among others

Links for filling out ragging complaints:

The National Anti-Ragging Helpline website - www.antiragging.in

The Monitoring Agency website - www.c4yindia.org

▶ Universities and Colleges Compliance

The UGC regulation has made it mandatory for the universities and colleges to demote ragging in their campuses and follow the compliances to achieve these objectives. The universities are requested to fill online compliance and also immediately instruct all the colleges under their purview to follow it.

Link for 'confirmation on compliance being followed':

www.antiragging.in/compliance_desclaimer.html | www.c4yindia.org/Home/CollegeCompliance

▶ Colleges and Universities Contact Details

As per the order of the Hon'ble Supreme Court, it is mandatory for the college and university authorities to update their details each year, so that college students can navigate the college or university details while filing the undertaking affidavit.

Link to update college or university details:

www.antiragging.in/compliance_desclaimer.html | <https://www.c4yindia.org/Home/UpdateCollCont>

▶ Councils Reporting

The various councils in India are the statutory bodies for regulating universities and colleges. The measures undertaken by them to curb the menace of ragging in their respected affiliated universities and colleges are to be mandatorily reported.

Link to upload the council's reports:

www.antiragging.in/admin/login.php

HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS IN INDIA (HEIs)

UGC Regulations on 'Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009' are mandatory and all higher education institutions are required to take necessary steps for its implementation including the monitoring mechanism. Any violation of these regulations will be viewed seriously. If any institution fails to take adequate steps to prevent ragging or does not act in accordance with these Regulations or fails to punish perpetrators of incidents of ragging suitably, it will attract punitive action against itself by the UGC.

The requisite mandatory action for curbing the menace of ragging in all Higher Educational Institutions in India:

- Strengthen and augment anti-ragging mechanism by way of adequate publicity through various mediums
- Constitution of Anti-Ragging committee and Anti-Ragging squad
- Establish Anti-Ragging Cell
- Install CCTV cameras at vital points
- Organise anti-ragging interaction, workshops and seminars for the freshers and the senior students
- After the commencement of the academic year organised professional counselling of the students
- Ensure identification of trouble triggers and take appropriate action
- Mention of Anti-Ragging warnings in the institution's E-prospectus and E-information booklets/ brochures
- Conduct surprise inspections of hostels, students, accommodation, canteens, rest cum recreational rooms, toilets, bus stands, and all other strategic locations
- Undertake all other measures that would augur well in preventing/ quelling ragging and any uncalled-for behaviour and the incident.

Website with nodal officers' complete details

Universities/ colleges have to display the email address and contact number of the Nodal Officer of the Anti-Ragging Committee of their university/ college on their website and campus areas like Admission Centre, Departments, Library, Canteen, Hostel, Common facilities, etc.

Admission Form

Universities and colleges are requested to insert a mandatory column in their university/ colleges admission form as per the given format:

Anti-Ragging Undertaking Reference no:	
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AWARENESS MEASURES FOR RAGGING FREE CAMPUSES

- Every public declaration of intent by any institution in electronic, audio-visual, online, social media, print, website, admission prospectus/ booklet or any other media should expressly mention that ragging is totally prohibited in the institution at the time of admission of students in any course.
- The brochure of admission/ instruction booklet or prospectus, whether in print or electronic format, shall prominently print these regulations in full.
- Institutions should display posters in all prominent locations showcasing the provisions of penal law applicable to incidents of ragging.
- At the end of each academic year, the institution should send a letter to the parents/ guardians informing them about the Regulations and any law for the time being enforced prohibiting ragging and its punishments.
- Institutions can issue public notices in the newspapers, update their websites with the nodal officer's complete details.
- Every fresher should be provided with a printed leaflet with all the information to seek help and guidance from all authorities and agencies, and a calendar of events and activities laid down by the institution to facilitate and complement the familiarisation of freshers with the academic environment of the institution.
- Institutions should conduct joint sensitisation and orientation programmes for both freshers and senior students.
- Institutions should constitute Anti-Ragging Committee and Anti-Ragging Squad which will be responsible for spreading awareness and preventing the occurrence of ragging.
- Meeting of all staff, functionaries and agencies before the commencement of the academic session.
- Institutions should launch a publicity campaign against ragging before the commencement of the academic year.
- After the commencement of the academic year, the batch of freshers should be divided into small groups and assigned to the faculty for difficulties and guidance.
- Random anonymous survey should be done among students about ragging, and it should be a regular practice in the institution.

In Nutshell

- Brochure of admission/instruction booklet or the prospectus
- Leaflets
- Posters
- Institution website
- Meetings
- Publicity campaign
- Seminars and workshops
- Professional counselling
- Orientation programmes
- Large scale cultural, sports and other activities

- ▶ UGC designed and distributed four types of posters amongst Universities/ Regulatory Authorities/ Councils/ IITs/ NITs/ other educational institutions for their prominent display. These anti-ragging posters must be displayed at all prominent places like the Admission centre, Departments, Library, canteen, Hostel, Common facilities, etc. These posters are available on UGC website. The size of the posters should be 8x6 feet.
- ▶ UGC developed 05 TVCs of 30 seconds each with different perspectives i.e. Parents, victims, and Offenders.

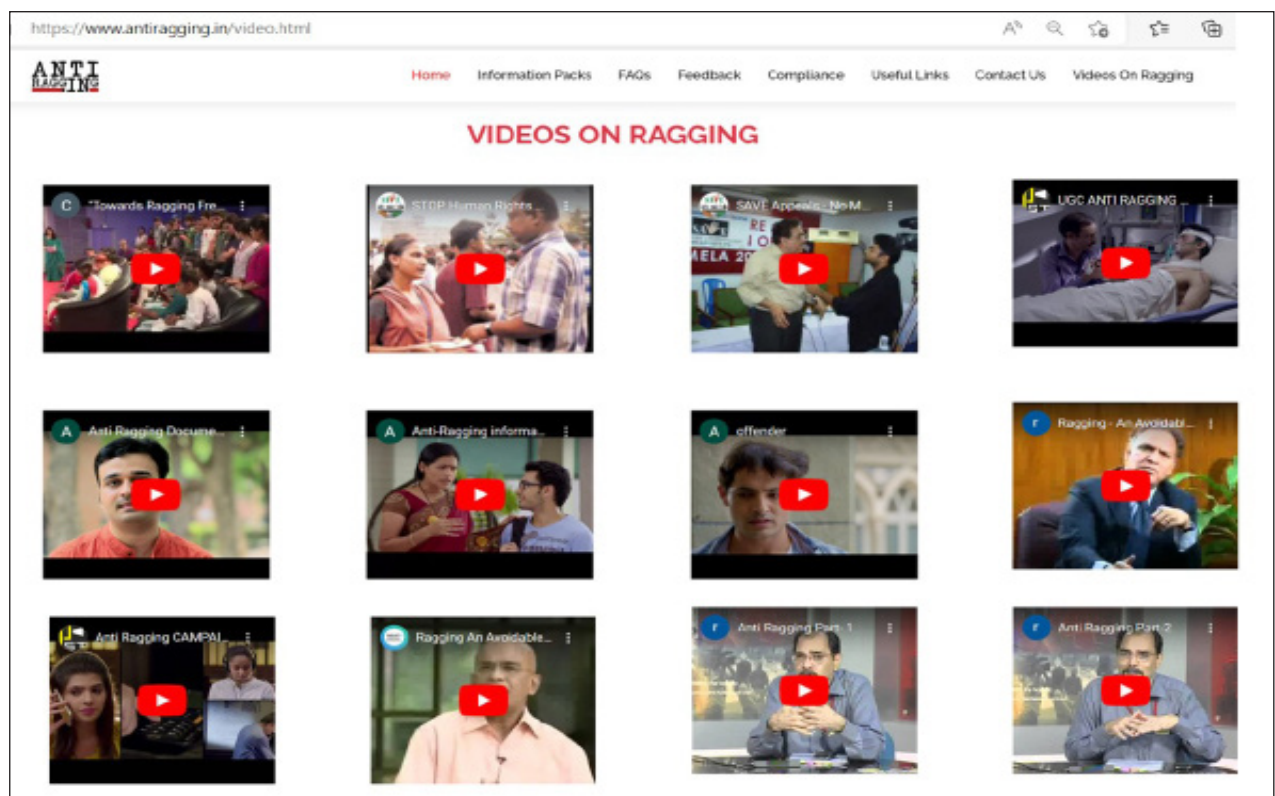
AWARENESS COLLATERALS

Posters



Download: www.ugc.ac.in/pdfnews/4957638_poster-ragging.pdf

Videos



www.antiragging.in/video.html

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

www.antiragging.in/faqs.html | www.c4yindia.org/Home/AntiRagging

REACH OUT

University Grant Commission (UGC)

Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg

New Delhi 110 002

P: 91 11 2360 4446; 2360 4200

E: contact.ugc@nic.in

UGC Anti-Ragging Cell (ARC)

NET Bureau, South Campus of Delhi University,

Benito Jhuarez Marg, New Delhi 110 021

P: 91 11 2411 2087

E: raggingcell@yahoo.in

Monitoring Agency

Centre for Youth (C4Y)

New Delhi 110 068

P: 91 11 4161 9005

E: antiragging@c4yindia.org

National Anti-Ragging Helpline

New Delhi 110 007

P: 1800 180 5522

E: helpline@antiragging.in

NATIONAL RAGGING PREVENTION PROGRAMME

www.ugc.ac.in

www.antiragging.in and www.c4yindia.org